

The

MORADA



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THIRTY-FIVE CENTS.

AUTUMN

NOTES

- HARRY CROSBY** is an advisory editor of transition. He lives in Paris where, with Caresse Crosby, he edits the Black Sun Press. He has published five volumes of verse, *Sonnets For Caresse*, *Red Skeletons*, (illustration by Alastair), *Chariot of the Sun* (introduction by D. H. Lawrence), *Transit of Venus*, and *Mad Queen* and one book of prose, *Shadows of the Sun*. He has contributed to *Blues*, *transition*, *Exchange* (Paris) and *Poetry*.
- PAUL FREDERIC BOWLES** has contributed to *transition* (12 and 13), *Tambour* (4) and *This Quarter* (4). He attended the University of Virginia, lived in Paris several months, and hiked through Switzerland and Germany. He lives in New York.
- FRANCES ANDRE** is a peasant of Luxembourg, who is not a professional writer but a farmer. He has published one slim volume, *Peasant Poems*. Continental critics have hailed him as one of the most authentic forerunners of that proletarian literature which is bound to be realized shortly.
- KENNETH REXROTH** has been published in *Blues*. He lives in San Francisco.
- ARTHUR L. CAMPA** is a fellow at the University of New Mexico. He is collecting the folk-lore of Nueva México.
- WILLIAM CLOSSON EMORY** was born in Honolulu and is now living in Detroit. His work has appeared in *The Saturday Review*, *Poetry*, *transition*, *New Masses*, *Palo Verde*, and in *transition stories*, a volume recently published by Walter V. McKee, containing twenty-three stories from *transition*, selected and edited by Eugene Jolas, and Robert Sage. A volume of his poetry, *be still*, was recently published by the Lotus Press.
- DONAL MCKENZIE** is a membre titulaire of the Société Astronomique de France.
- CATHERINE STUART** has appeared in *Japm: The Poetry Weekly*, *Palo Verde*, *An Anthology of Alabama Poetry 1928*, and is to be included in *Golden Stallion*, an anthology of southwestern poetry to be published shortly by The Southwest Press, Dallas.
- VAN DEUSEN CLARK** is a student in the University of New Mexico.
- CHAS. HENRI FORD** edits *Blues*, a magazine of new rhythms, at Columbus, Mississippi.
- EZRA POUND** needs no blurb from us. With his permission we are using *Kick*, from *Exile* (4) edited by him from Rapallo, Italy. His complete works with the exception of the unfinished *Cantos* have been collected by Boni & Liveright and titled *Personae*.
- PHILIPPE SOUPAULT** is one of the leading French novelists and poets of the directly post-war generation. He is a pure Parisian, and author of many novels and volumes of verse, several of which have been translated into English. He has contributed to *transition* and *Broom*. He was a member of the Dada movement, then founded Surrealisme with André Breton, but he quickly left these groups, still maintaining however, a distinctly experimental taste in all his work.
- GEORGES LINZE**, born in Liege, Belgium in 1900, is the editor of *Anthologie* and the author of seven volumes of verse and prose.
- RALPH CHEYNEY** has contributed to *The Modern Quarterly*, *Masses*, *Liberator*, and *New Masses*. He co-edits *Contemporary Verse*, the second oldest poetry magazine in America, and *Unrest; The Rebel Poets Anthology*. He is the author of *Touch and Go* (Henry Harrison, New York).
- NOEMAN MACLEOD** has contributed to *New Masses* (of which he is contributing editor) *Tambour* 4 (Paris), *Blues*, *Birth Control Review*, *Contemporary Verse*, *Poetry* (Chicago), *The Harp*, *Japm*, *The Frontier*, *Janus*, *Opportunity*, and other magazines. Among Anthologies he numbers Braithwaite's *Anthology of Magazine Verse* for 1928 and 1929, *Anthology of Revolutionary Poetry*, *Unrest* (London), *Golden Stallion*, *Cry For Peace*,

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Grub Street Book of Verse, 1928, and 5 Poets (Henry Harrison, New York).

J. G. SIGMUND in his creative work comes very close to the soil. He has published four volumes of verse, *Pinions*, *Frescoes*, *Land O' Maize Folk*, and *Drowsy Ones*, and one volume of short stories, *Wapsipinicon Tales*. He has contributed to the first two *American Caravans*, *Forge*, *Poetry*, *The Midland* and *The Irish Statesman*. He lives in Iowa.

DEAN B. LYMAN, Jr. has appeared in *Poetry*. A book of his, *The Last Lutanist*, was published by The Yale Series of Younger Poets.

GLENN WARD DRESBACH has contributed to *The Dial* (now extinct), *Poetry*, *Voices*, *Midland* and countless magazines and anthologies. He has published many volumes of verse, the last of which, *Star-dust and Stone*, was issued by the Southwest Press, Dallas. His new book of poems, *The Wind in the Cedars*, will be published in February by Henry Holt and Co., N. Y. He has roamed the desert and mountains of New Mexico from the Burro Mts. to Deming, and from the mining camps around Silver City to the ranches of the Gila River.

C. V. WICKER is associate professor in the English Department of the University of New Mexico.

HAROLD J. SALEMSON writes directly in both languages (French and English). He is critic of American Letters on *Le Mercure de France* and Paris correspondent to *The Morada*. He has appeared in *La Revue Europeenne*, *Les Nouvelles Litteraires*, *Monde*, *Europe*, *Anthologie* (Liege, Belgium), *Poetry*, *transition* (Paris), *The Modern Quarterly*, *Blues*, and *This Quarter*. An article of his was translated to be the first survey of American Letters to appear in Bulgaria. He is translating Witter Bynner into French and expects to finish two novels this year (one in each language). He lives in Paris where he edits *Tambour*, a review publishing American, English and French writers in the original.

MARY FRANCIS SIMPSON has appeared in *Poet Lore*, *Window*, and other magazines. She has attended Cambridge, University of Colorado, and University of New Mexico.

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GEORGES LINZE

COUNTRYSIDE

Summer exists without lightning.

Great calm. Even the motors fit into the landscape. Their noise is a health, an optimism, a calm. What is to be done? Sure that satyrs, unoccupied workmen or bourgeois lying in wait are watching, hidden in bushes.

Is that said? Good people of the city so powerful, so full of past and future fear small truths. Gestures are made, affectations, etiquettes, and life shouts, a geyser, on street-corners, in clouds, walls and bridges.

Jules and Marie cross the landscape, slowly, embraced. They are at the happy age, it seems. Eyes follow them. Birds, too, see them, rapidly deformed. As for insects, blinded by size, they ignore them. The phantom of a dog has been roaming for 3 days. No one has noticed it. Only little animals have suspicious fears.

The phantom of the dog has around itself a zone of apprehension. Jules and Marie.

The birds.

The satyrs.

The animals.

The phantom of the dog. There surely is the idyllic countryside.

But autos pass upon parallel roads, airplanes follow opposite horizons and all unite as if to drag an irresistible net over the country.

The young folks, arms tenderly confused. Jules feels against his hand a breast shaken by walking.

Today nothing else will satisfy the twinned desires.

Here is another day. The identical souls meet on the same path.

What is the matter? The small animals of the fields run along tracks. The phantom of the dog floats over the village and evaporates.

Upon parting, folks remain attached by invisible exchanges. Oh the pretty words, the pretty looks, the pretty caresses sent unknowingly and that turn, a constellation, around lovers.

A woman died. Her life like a discharge overruns the country, clouds, matters, without anything adequate recognizing and understanding it. Solitude. Great calm. To be gotten used to.

Marie has taken the deep road full of stones, among the grass, the hammocks of the spiders. She does not know a man is following her, a prudent wild beast, that he is zigzagging through nearby fields to place his views.

She is enveloped, desired, studied. Does she even know of the rapid attacks reported in papers, torn clothes, struggle, rape, flight or crime.

The man, nearer.

Into him, penetrate the insolent sun, the fullness of the thick harvests, the solitude of the moment in which epochs mix, the forgetfulness of towns, of family homesteads, everything strikes and animates him.

He starts, a living trap. The woman, unthinking, runs away, a terrified thing seemingly chased by a single avid hand. And under their now eternal race, defile the figures of Earth past and to be.

(Translated from the French by Harold J. Salemsen)

C. V. WICKER

VOYAGES

Seven square sails on a gray-white horizon,
Seven white sails on the edge of the sea,
Seven small ships with adventure for cargo,
Seven far ports where I never shall be.

Wake at the dawning in Persia or China,
Spring as the hawser is flung to the shore,
Take sailors' pleasure before the ship's sailing,
For sailors may never return any more.

Here on the home-shore I dream of your roaming,
Dream of romances in seven far lands;
While at the dawning in Persia or China,
Seven white hulls lie arot on the sands.

WILLIAM CLOSSON EMORY

DIMENSION 4

Calmly he sat there in the church. The light had the soft heaviness of eiderdown quilts. It depressed him. Through the dimness of the columned naves he could see the stained glass windows vivid with sunlight. The figures seemed to step out from their heavy, leaded frames and swim about with the flower-drifting fragrance. People came in walking noisily to their pews and speaking in loud rustling whispers. The murmurs made him think of maggots grousing over dead morsels.

Churches were places where people came to be married and where people came to be buried. He wondered how many millions of sitters-in-pews had thought that thought. There was the light streaming down from the red and yellow and green and purple and blue patterns of the windows. The lord is my shepherd. He leadeth me in green pastures like little woolly lambs.

Why was he here in church? He couldn't seem to remember. By his side sat his mother and his wife. Funny how they had gotten here. They should have been several thousand miles away. He gazed incuriously around the church. She was going to be married. That was it. It didn't matter much. Who was it she was going to marry? He wondered vacantly. Four ragged little Negro children straggled into the pew in front of him. Their rolling white eyeballs followed the wonder and magnificence of the decorations. Suffer the little children to come unto me. Now why were they here? A stout, bejeweled Italian woman wheezed in with an odor of garlic and sat down across the way. The church was full of people, this he knew without looking.

The slow notes of the organ began to roll about sensuously. Yes, she was getting married. What of it anyway? The music rose and fell, and bathed him with its heavy langour. He chatted quietly with his wife, sitting there beside him, just as if they had been living together all the time instead of having been separated for four years. The music was about them and they were in a church and somebody was getting married.

Suddenly an uneasiness arrived and seemed to be trying to stifle him. His heart began to bulge and press stiffly against his ribs. It was SHE who was being married. Here he was sitting calmly and disinterestedly watching the lights and the flowers and the windows

and the throng, and things were happening to him. It was SHE, Louise, his sweetheart, that was being married. Couldn't he understand? She that was part of him. She that was all his was being given to someone else. Someone else who would hold the velvet, fragrant whiteness of her body close to him and cover it with kisses. Now he was convinced. A strong hand reached into his body and grasped his heart. His face grew pale. He could feel the blood receding and see the wan and pinched thing that was his face shriveling in the dull cold. He sat there.

The tones of the organ reached up ambitiously and filled the great caves of the church with stiff purplish vibrations. He saw the ragged little Negro children shivering deliciously. He remembered the garlic and the jewels of the stout, Italian woman. Now his thoughts refused to function properly. They became stiff and purple like the vibrating notes of the great organ. His brain became wan and pinched like his face. Somehow he was aware of her brother watching, with a commiserating expression, his suffering. He always wondered what her brother had thought of them. He must have guessed at their relations long years ago.

Now he was no longer conscious of his wife and mother beside him. He could not recollect the people about him. The organ was bursting into the triumphant beats of the wedding march. She was coming up the aisle on the arm of her father, a stern man with dark piercing eyes. He dared not look at her, yet he knew her dress was white. Then he saw her from the corner of his eye. She was wearing a long, white veil. This was rather a joke. Only virgins were supposed to wear veils. At least that was what he had always understood. The air throbbed with music. It was filled with the fragrance of the flowers and her fragrance. He saw her moving to the altar. Figures dressed in black were there mingled with figures in white, the bridesmaids. All that he could see were the soft curves of her form. The music ceased and was replaced by the drone of a man's voice. The minister was speaking. If any man knows reason. God! There was reason enough but he was dumb. She was half-turned towards him. Then she raised her dark, sadly luminous eyes and looked at him. The whole church seemed to rock about him. It was over. She was no longer his. He rose as the church swirled in a kaleidoscopic whirlpool. A horrible and anguished cry burst upon him and yammered at his ears. He did not realize that it was his own self made this cry.

For some time he retched violently and the remainder of his sleep, that night, was restless and fitful.

PHILIPPE SOUPAULT

HOLLOW HOURS

I waited for a sign
but the four thousand seconds sauntered by
and I heard only shadows
all that dies without noise
One had to turn around
and make the necessary gestures
It was not a time for despair
And the time of waiting is not yet all gone by
I have the ants' impatience
I watch the yellow horizon
and the smoke
And now come the hollow hours
the ones that eat silence
and which re-echo the walker's steps
these hours full of wind
these hours of rain
during which one must wait
some more
behind a pane
Till those who have had enough rise up
stand straight
and roar like all the animals of the deluge
till they refuse
protest
swear
shout
till they renounce
at last
to wait forever without a word
and they give the signal
the big signal
THE SIGNAL.

(Translated from the French
by Harold J. Salemsen.)

JAY G. SIGMUND

THE BLASPHEMER

Long and faithfully had the good church folk of the little Wapsipinicon town of Ontarns labored with and prayed over old Andrew Fulton, and at last their prayers were answered; for old Andrew had not only "come out" in the revival meeting, he had been baptized in the Wapsipinicon before all the ice was out of the river that spring, and he had not missed a single Sunday at church services since.

There were certain sceptical ones who had prophesied that Andrew Fulton would not persist in this new life which he had begun to lead. "He'll have to be warmed up again next Winter", said some. Others said he could never control his fiery temper, and the majority of the loafers in the grocery store at Ontarns broadly asserted that here would be a very flagrant case of "backsliding". Andrew would never follow the rigid program of a churchman, they said.

There were grounds for these suspicions. The crochety disposition and the profane tongue of old Andrew were things the neighborhood folk had talked of for years. Everybody called Andrew's wife "Aunt Kate", but no one ever called the irritable old man, "Uncle Andrew". Many and varied were the conjectures as to why Aunt Kate ever married him, anyway. Mild of manner, quiet and devout, the little old lady was the exact opposite of her snarling husband; but if she ever had any fault to find with him, it must have been done within her own soul, for no one remembered hearing her utter a word of complaint.

It seemed marvelous that old Andrew could discipline himself to the extent of bridling his tongue and going so faithfully to church each Sunday; and when Arch Gobel, the carpenter, told the loafers in Turner's grocery that when he built the barn for old Andrew, the old man said grace each meal, the store crowd almost changed their prophecies about old Andrew's "backsliding".

"He talks to his potatoes, eh?" queried Dick Long, the blacksmith.

"Yes", drawled Arch, "and reads the Bible mornings, and you'd better not cuss around him neither. He's as much agin' cussin' as he used to be for it."

Summer came on, and the haying season. Old Andrew had the finest field of giant red clover in the neighborhood. Loud with bees

JAY G. SIGMUND

and fragrant with the rich perfume of summer, the plot of clover was the pride of old Andrew's heart and the envy of his neighbors.

There was not much carpenter work this year, and old Andrew had been able to secure the drawling Arch Gobel as a "hand" thru haying time. The first day Arch mowed the entire field. From early morning until late afternoon the lovely, blossomed waste fell before the droning sickle.

It was Thursday and noontime. Old Andrew, Aunt Kate and Arch Gobel were eating dinner. All through the long forenoon the crop of clover hay had lain beneath a sweltering summer sun. This afternoon two neighbors were coming to help haul in the crop. Aunt Kate bowed her head while Andrew said grace. Arch Gobel inclined his bald head above his plate with a quizzical grin on his thin lips.

"I don't like the looks of them clouds, Andrew," muttered Arch as he reached for the dish of fried side pork which Aunt Kate passed to him.

"I didn't notice it", said old Andrew with a note of something akin to terror in his voice.

"Have some sweet potatoes, Arch?" asked Aunt Kate gently, at the same time pushing back a wisp of grayish hair from her sweaty forehead.

Arch reached for the dish and speared a great yellow potatoe with his fork.

"Why, what's the matter, Andrew?" asked Aunt Kate, "I aint never seen you refuse sweet potatoes before."

Old Andrew did not answer but ate hurriedly, watching Arch and occasionally glancing out the window.

There was a rumbling sound.

"What was that?" asked old Andrew, a look of fear on his face.

"Thunder I guess", answered Arch Gobel, with his mouth full of sweet potato.

If the gaunt carpenter had struck the old farmer a blow there would have been no more of a pained look on the countenance of the white-haired man. He passed his hand over his forehead as if brushing away something which had settled there.

"Well, it's been so sultry", said Aunt Kate. "It's no wonder it's threatenin'."

Old Andrew looked at her and there was anger in the glance. The unconcern of her manner irritated him. Clover down and speak calmly when rain was in the skies!

There was another rumble—this time louder. Old Andrew winced. Then another rumble, more metallic and singing. It was wagon wheels. One of the neighbors and his freckled, barefoot son had come to help haul in the clover. Through the window Andrew could see the fat form of Schultz, the German farmer down the road, and as Schultz reined in his team he pointed to the sky and said something to his son. The boy held out his hand as though to catch rain drops which might be falling.

"It'd be a shame if you'd lose that crop of clover", mumbled Arch Gobel, as he picked his yellow teeth. "It's the best field of clover in the township; bar none."

There was a sharp clap of thunder which followed a livid flash of lightning. The room was growing almost dark. On the roof could be heard the first great drops, falling with their staccato clickings.

Old Andrew groaned. The drops came faster. Aunt Kate watched her husband with a look of anxiety.

Suddenly a torrent of rain seemed to be loosed. The fat farmer and his son had tied their team to the hitching post and now they scampered to the shelter of the barn.

Clap after clap of thunder came, and the roar of the rain grew louder.

Old Andrew suddenly leaped to his feet and rushed through the door. Outside he paused for a moment. Aunt Kate arose and went to his side, but the old farmer ran out into the downpour with his eyes toward the sky and his hands clenched.

Suddenly old Andrew stopped and shaking his fists at the sky he turned his face upward and his white hair hung in long wet strands. For a moment he beat the air impotently; then his voice boomed out:

"If you wanta be a God, be a God; don't be a damned old——!" The last of his vehement tirade was drowned out by a volley of thunder.

In the doorway stood Aunt Kate, her frail body shaken by sobs and her face buried in her white apron.

EZRA POUND

KICK

The inability of contemporary Americans to kick about anything whatsoever is one of the most disgusting phenomena one has to face in dealing with one's contemporary compatriots. The individuals of our nation put up with anything, there is nothing that arouses them to any form of intelligent action or protest. There are not enough vertebra distributed among the whole range of the American people to reconstruct one iethysaurus.

PAUL FREDERIC BOWLES

THE CHURCH

Down the dim aisles
Where nuptials of former days commenced
Down the aisle
They all knew Rimsky-Korsakoff in those days
And they all wanted Mendelssohn's Wedding march
From Lohengrin in those days
There are weeds and cool beds of mint behind the church
And where the buggies used to creak on Sundays
The witchgrass grows, and toads abound
The church Thomas Hood was not a plagiarist
But here we find not exactly a paraphrase
But why not?
And where the cricket used to chirp so shrilly
The toad was squatting and the lizard crept
On that dank hearth and chilly
O fill my glass
Refill it
Hood was
Not an
Import
Ant
Man

GLENN WARD DRESBACH

LEDGE FLOWER

Mirages, contending with space,
Weave fantasy over the face
Of distance for a while.

Here affirmation, alone,
Flames from the cracked lips of stone,
Facing a vast of denial.

MOUNTAIN SUNSET

Who strikes, on vast blue altars
Of each sky-shouldering height,
The flint . . . that sparks be given
Wings in a cloud of light?

Flames run to gold and crimson
In sunset burning high;
Each jeweled smoked-column reaches
Its gem-set arch of sky.

Far, on the molten silver
Poured from the mountain springs,
Sky gardens cloud their petals
Brushed down by a cloud of wings. . .

Mortal, with young hands clinging
Where even silence stirs
The fragrance of light, we follow
What shadowy worshipers?

To kneel before the altars . . .
Are reached? And who replies,
"The heart can turn to nearness
The distance in the eyes."

KENNETH REXROTH

SHE LEFT HIM

We tried very hard to make it what we thought it had ought to be.
Resilient sympathy and the hands.
Concord and the understood.
The green utterly beautiful twilight.

The piston rods rock and plunge, it is very white, there is an unshaded electric globe and one man in grey overalls far down on a gallery watches the slow movement of red and green lights across the board, once in a great while he throws a switch and fresh copper bars gleam for an instant.

The heart beating and beating, one feels it now, the diaphragm slipping over undulant waves as one walks. Abrupt shudder of peristalsis. He knows her lips, all her little nerves, and webs of capillaries. Her capsules of mysterious fluids.

Twilight. A number of people on a wide street. A palm turned upward at a table, the marble cold against the back of the hand. Trout swimming in a window. The gold fillings in teeth.

I get to thinking of him.

When I see him I notice his socks need mending.

Don't throw the scene from side to side.

A weep and a confused headache.

See them coming inexorably, the narrow hoofs of their horses, their voices hoarse with dust. Their robes spectacular in the sunlight, their swords whirling above their heads.

When a man has grown close to a woman. And we were so close.

You had better ask the captain. But his splendor terrifies me. He is all alone on the bridge and the wind presses against him.

Perhaps I've hurt him terribly. If I could only go away I could forget about it. But I see him all the time and when I don't see him I worry about him.

I feel as though something were striking my face with the edge of a hand. Vertically down the center of my face and across my eyes. Someone opened a door in the ceiling and poured something into this room.

Where is the cat. In the corner.

There is an arrow here, pointing up those long stairs. There is sweat on the walls.

The old woman is a long way down the tunnel, it is difficult to see her because of the dust and the imperfect illumination, but she seems to be picking up things and she is in a great hurry.

I believe you can get out to the end of it if you try. Of course it's very frail.

If I only had a little money.

His pride.

He is working across the river. I know he doesn't like his job. There was so much he wanted to do. Perhaps he can never recover a lot of the things I am taking with me. There is a lot I can never recover.

Blue veins beneath the chalky skin, the bones showing through yellow, the hair on the hands frizzled as though it had been singed.

The leaves of the madrones spin in the wind, Ferry boats crawl over the water and disappear behind the islands. As the fog comes in a siren moans, then another.

Why don't you try a little harder, why do you forget the things that were so important. You used to be so careful.

I need money so badly. I could go away. As it is I'm caught out here. It costs so much to live in New York. When I don't see him I wonder how he is getting along, what he is doing now.

Maybe he is in his room reading, maybe he is walking along one of those empty streets where the railroads cross one another, walking and thinking. He needs me so much.

There is a faint odor of burning oil, the hissing and crackling of a long spark, several lids slap shut.

Stretch out your arm and strain your fingers wide apart.

The graph looks like a row of canine teeth, The gold leaf rises and falls charging and discharging.

Don't worry about it. Don't think I mean everything I say. It will be alright.

GUTIERRE DE CETINA (16th Century)

MADRIGAL

Eyes clear, serene!
If it has been
Your sweetness which attracts men's praise;
Why do I see
You dart at me
Glances that still with anger blaze?

If pitying most,
You best do boast
Your beauty to beholders' eyes,
Your fierce looks cease!
Lest they decrease
The loveliness which in you lies.

Torments of hell!
And yet 'tis well;
Your gaze can ever make me blest:
Eyes clear, serene!
In anger e'en,
Still let your glances on me rest.

(Translated from the Spanish by George St. Clair)

CATHERINE STUART

POEM

Yucca buds
Are ladies in silver hoopskirts
Riding like clouds the wind.
Have you ever watched the blush
They wear
When Dawn Boy merges into sky?

HARRY CROSBY

SCORN

you business men with your large desks, with your stenographers and your bell-boys and your private telephones, I say to you these are the four walls of your cage.

you are tame as canaries with your small bird-brains where lurks the evil worm, you are fat from being over-fed, you know not the lean wild sunbirds that arrow down paths of fire.

I despise you, I am too hard to pity you, I would hang you on the gallows of the Stock Exchange, I would flay you with taxes, I would burn you alive with wall Street Journals, I would condemn you to an endless round of bank banquets, I deride you I mock at you I laugh you to scorn.

CALDERON DE LA BARCA (1600-1681)

SONNET

Once Death and Love a bitter quarrel had,
Over their power; for they both could see
That from their arrows neither liberty
Nor life could live secure: thus Love was sad.
But then Love made a woman and was glad,
For there was never woman fair as she.
Then flamed his victory. But Death—ah me!—
Obscured that living sun, and on Love mad,
And over Beauty worked his will. But Love,
Almost admitting his defeat, yet saw
One fair impression Death could not remove.
So Love was crowned the victor by this law:
"Homage to Love both dead and living give,
But Death is only king of those who live".

(Translated from the Spanish by George St. Clair)

FRANCES ANDRE

FROM "PEASANT POEMS"

Wintertime had cloistered people into houses.
One of us beat rye inside his barn,
one took care of his cattle and another was sick,
Each one lived by himself, for himself, ferociously,
and happenings came over all the people,
cloistering, closing them into their homes . . .
For evening came fast, and snow, and wind
over words, over actions on the doorsteps
and each one crouched near the fire, sadly,
beneath the heavy load of winter on the plains.

Spring has come, birds have sung,
light has come to life, the clouds
have travelled, clear and pretty, as after a thunderstorm.
And the one who beat the rye inside his barn,
And the one who was sick, and all the others
who lived all alone, shouted to each other: hello!
from far away, joyously, on their doorsteps.
Everywhere could be heard, at the back of the stables,
the animals calling and bellowing toward the light . . .
And we felt that love was passing through space.

And we all go together, together to the fields,
you and me, and we all, and all our companions,
men and children, and women and old folks,
and horses, and bulls and dogs; all together
we go to the fields where nothing more is mine,
where nothing more is yours, and the wheat has grown
and has become a joy, a song in the light.
We go to the fields, to the fields, all together,
with our companions, with our sweethearts,
our hands among our hands, our hearts among our hearts . . .
We go, and we walk, and we sing and hope
of springtime is in us, our steps and our songs . . .
We all go to work, in the sun, in our fields.

(Translated from the French
/ by Harold J. Salemsen.)

RALPH CHEYNEY

WAGE-SLAVES TO WAR-MAKERS

We have no land for which to fight
Except where Russia cracks the night.
This country is in no way ours.
We break the rocks; you pluck the flowers.
We build the roads on which you speed.
And when we strike for what we need
We learn too well it's you who own
The press, the courts and every stone
Of every structure that we rear.
Say, what invaders shall we fear?
Why should we care out on the job
If you or others drive and rob?

Russia alone for which to fight
Though all the world is ours by right.
Moreover, grimed with soot and mud,
We've lost enough and more of blood.
There's never a skyscraper cranes its head
But is built on the bodies of our dead.
We do not want to have to kill,
For ours a kinder, harder will.
But if you drive us till we do,
It shall be you, it shall be you!

VAN DEUSEN CLARK

METAPHYSICAL

From the dust, trampled by the ages
It came fashioned by the wind
Into intricate lines
But labeled in derision—man,
The last to be created
And left to wonder at all
That came before.

NORMAN MACLEOD

MESA ENCANTADA

for Catherine Stuart.

You hear me but only the words
Cast like foam and as readily lost.
The enchanted mesa is a tombstone thrust
Into the birdlike quality of dawn.
Only for an instant do the streamers rise
And lose themselves in the folding skies.
O I will sink into death more than life
Knowing the love beyond blood,
Beyond knife.
Nothing will cut into marrow of man
As the infinity of ignorance can.

RICHARD JOHNS

DREAMS

Dreams in darkness, clear, concise and rounded,
Seem in a sterner light such trivial things,
And yet some silly dreams, but half remembered,
Shatters the light with claw and wing.
Why should a picture, or a passing face's pain,
A slinking dog, a sudden sense of hell,
Stir such abundance of hysteria and vital doubt
Of life and living? (The body and the mind as well)
Fears, deeply grounded in a lewdly moral war
Of seemliness, desire and eager half-formed dreams,
Stir with a sudden shudder through the mind
And make the body tremble against mental screams.

CHARLES HENRI FORD

SHORT POEM ABOUT A GUNMAN

when a gunman soon will rent again this veil of lethargy
when a gunman with staccato fire or fluid
when a gunman
I shall count again the lavish crimes and felonies
I shall whisper softly (maybe kiss
and kiss too lightly round hard lips of a machinegun)
I shall whisper gunman
gunman yours is much the least:

MARY FRANCES SIMPSON

DANSE MACABRE

Drink of the damp, woody scent of the forest,
Bathe in the rays of the sun's vivid mellow,
Gather the fruits; suck their moist, pungent sweetness,
Dance, all spirits, for death will come soon!

Fling out your tresses, oh aspen and cottonwood,
Dazzle the world with your turbulent color,
Cover the hillsides with scarlet and amber,
Dance, all spirits, for death will come soon!

Dance in the blazing blue fire of heaven,
Clad in a scarf of the evening's purple,
Smoke now arises from piles of leaves crumbling,
Dance, all spirits, for death will come soon!

DEAN B. LYMAN, JR.

ON THE SANDS

The pearl-grey sands ran in a smooth, shining arc to the fringe of the palms. Bright green, so vivid as to seem vaguely sinister, gleamed the masses of broad leaves under the afternoon sun. In contrast to the hot threat of their tropic color lay the vitreous, cold emerald of the open sea, sparkling with a hard light that hinted of a depthless cruelty beneath its clear and brilliant beauty. A scented breeze stirred the torrid air and suggested by its subtle fragrance, burdened with the lure and peril of hibiscus, the imminence of luscious passions and of dire desires. The very sun was tinged with a bloodshot carmine that increased the poignant atmosphere of impending rapture and delirium. The sands alone were level and dispassionate under the cobalt skies.

A woman, relaxed as luxuriantly as a cat, lay half in the shadow of a mat, which her man had propped up for her with a water-rotted stick. Stretched out beside her, leaning on his elbow, a fair-haired man held upon her an unwavering, inscrutable gaze from blue eyes that spoke of tenderness and sternness and secret visions. His intent regard seemed also, however, to withhold an unnameable quality of thought which might be judged to contain, in a mysterious way, the indecipherable essence of his character. But the suspicion of reservations, if the woman had any, was untroubling to her; she was listlessly contented. Languorously she loosened the muscles that governed the golden, almost lemon-colored, limbs on which no man had ever looked without a quickening of the pulse. Her eyelids drooped, and only occasionally did she lift the long, sepia-drenched lashes to send the slumberous gaze of her smouldering, sepia and violet eyes out over the sleeping waters. Of Dakin, her man, she seemed oblivious; but this was merely seeming, for now and then her rounded knee moved unobtrusively to touch the tanned limbs of her lover. The contact was persistent and insinuating, although not directly provocative, as if she had not yet reached the verge of wishing to disturb the temporary quiescence of their desires. Proud confidence in her beauty and tranquil consciousness of her power lurked in every line of her softly slender outstretched form. Dakin's blue eyes never deserted the loveliness of her face. His expression remained for the most part that of profound study, emotionless absorption.

Dakin was white — had been, at least, for his fair skin had become impregnated from head to foot with that peculiar tan, the color

of iced coffee with cream in it, which is the heritage of northern-race people under exposure to the sun. His hair had bleached out almost to white. His limbs, long, slim, and shapely, had a nervous grace of outline that indicated powers of swiftness and endurance rather than of strength. Daily swimming in the lagoon, in competition, after a time successful, with the lifelong aptitude for the sport which Diamara had learned from her mother's amphibious race, had given Dakin's physique an enviable suppleness. This fact was readily apparent, as he had reduced his clothing, once the complicated garb of the average young American, to the simple expedient of the loin cloth. The only mark of an energetic civilization which he had retained was his clean-shaven countenance. All men have their individual prejudices and their personal dislikes, and with Dakin the distaste for bearded slovenliness was apparently the sole remaining vestige of a discarded culture. Kept visible by the ministrations of a time-worn razor, the lines of his face showed him to be youthful, meditative, and broodingly cynical. His visage, although amiable, had nevertheless upon it the subtle seal of the melancholy dreamer, while the humorous tendency of the curve of his lips was balanced by the slight, sardonic lift of his sun-whitened eyebrows. It was a face that revealed numerous capabilities—of laughter, of cruelty, of passion, of tenderness, of dark dreaming; and the blue eyes alone, changeful as their glance could be, might have given an intimation of his enigmatic personality. And now Dakin's gaze was concentrated in a persevering, pensive scrutiny of Diamara's beautiful head.

Diamara had divested herself of her sarong, which she had thrown carelessly across her thighs. Half-caste that she was, the woman had filched the attributes of an utter loveliness from the fusion of two physically fortunate racial strains. Her body had a perfection as intangible as the influence of music; there was poetry, and grace, and moon-madness in her every posture. The golden-yellow of her skin was underlaid with a flush of carmine warmth that deepened and became discernible under exertion. Her long hair, the hue of polished sandalwood, was rippling and silky. But it was with the attractions of her face that Dakin was occupied, for he was counting them over, one by one, with a strange solicitude that went beyond the consideration purely of their loveliness.

The features which Dakin looked upon were supremely lovely. The soft contour of the cheeks was a challenge to the senses. The delicate and decisive modelling of the chin was sheer delight to con-

template. The nose, that feature wherein so often beauty falls short, was exquisitely chiseled and proportioned. But Dakin was concerned mainly with the eyes and the lips.

Diamara's eyes might have been the subject of impassioned rhapsody, for the fashion in which the sepia depths of their irises were suffused with violet produced an effect of melting translucence that had an eloquence addressed to the heart of every natural man. Yet it was over the expression of her eyes that Dakin fell to reverie; he had many times been moved by the call of eyes with that identical expression. At their depths lay an unintentional beckoning which was the absolute essence of seduction. Dakin was sure that no man could have viewed those liquid orbs without the surrection of fervid and unruly longings. What he sought for, but in vain, was the opposing presence of an unalterable loyalty. Dakin wished to find there also that candid straightness of glance which he knew to mean the surety of fair play and trickless dealing; but this wish was not granted. Speculation then entered his mind as to whether or not the crucible of this woman's beauty could have attained the vermillion, burning pitch at which it glowed had it not been tinctured with the dangerous element of inherent infidelity. Perhaps to have known but once the favor and the passion of such a woman was worth the hurt and bitterness of a thousand infidelities. Again, to have been beloved and possessed of such a woman (as he had been these past ten months) was possibly so sufficient a marvel that he had no right to resent the withdrawal of the undeserved privilege. Finally, he had no evidence worthy of the name that Diamara was unfaithful to him; nothing but a half-caught whisper and a little disturbing laughter, trifles whose significance he might well have misconstrued. Still, Diamara's eyes, languishing and thrilling, were not the eyes of the woman who will never play false. Pain clutched at Dakin's heartstrings.

The beachcomber was thirty years old and not wanting in experience, either of women or of the world. Of women he had loved three and Diamara was the third. As far as bodily perfection went, she was more than the peer of her forerunners. In mental development, however—although perhaps not in mental equipment—she was greatly their inferior. This was natural enough, since her environment had been that of a barbaric islander. But in spite of the myriad items in which Diamara differed from the other two, there were similarities now for the first time appearing to Dakin's concrete observation, over which the man's mind was agitated. Diamara's lips, for instance, bore a disquieting resemblance to those of Mary Terhune.

Dakin had married Mary Terhune at Birmingham, Alabama, when he was but twenty-two years old. He remembered her, even now, as a fascinating girl—No! an alluring girl . . . all too alluring! Men had fallen victims in astonishing numbers. Dakin had fallen a victim, too, but he had won her. They had been ecstatically happy for over a year; then had come quarrels over her conduct. Dakin had thought her too friendly with other men, and Mary had resented the implications which she had read into his remonstrances. She had promised, however, in a tearful reconciliation after a furious disagreement, to respect his rights. Rumors of fresh indiscretions had followed, Dakin had overlooked many incidents that hurt him; then, at the last and uncourted, certain proof had come to him of Mary's betrayal of his affections. The strange part was that, during all the misery to which she had wantonly exposed him, Mary had seemed to love him as much as ever. There had been no discernible diminution of her desire for his caresses or his consideration. Now, sprawled on a Pacific Island beach beside a savage woman, Dakin tried unavailingly to recall any abatement of tender passion in Mary Terhune Dakin's last kisses—those that had been from lips shared with other men * * * that had been, moreover, from lips so like to these beneath his gaze. Could these lips, too—Diamara's fervent rose-petals—lavish their wealth at random? Could Diamara, too, give all the semblance of an overmastering love, and yet be false as hell?

Mary Terhune Dakin had fallen asleep one night with the impress of Johnny Dakin's kisses still on her fragrant flower of a mouth, and she had awakened the next morning to find her youthful husband fled. There had been nothing to do but go back to her family. This she had done, never to see Johnny again; and Johnny had never known whether a single regret had preyed upon her mind.

Johnny Dakin had gone out in the world with a hundred or so dollars in his pocket. He had become a drifter, going from town to town across the United States and gravitating by irregular stages toward the Pacific Coast. His longest sojourn had been at Salt Lake City, where he had been detained by Barbara Jennings. James S. Jennings, her husband, was a wealthy Mormon. Dakin, who was then still "Johnny" Dakin, had temporarily prospered in some undertaking, had bought himself a suitable wardrobe, and had made use of a good memory to unearth a family friend. This person, at Johnny's request, had introduced him once more into the social class from which he had long absented himself. Thus Dakin had met Barbara Jennings,

and the second love affair of his life had begun. As he diligently sought among them, recollections of these things leapt to poignant life in the brain of the man on the beach, who had at last, needing now no other name, become merely "Dakin".

Barbara had possessed a pair of eyes like Diamara's, except that there had been less of violet in them; and Barbara had betrayed her husband for Johnny Dakin. Worse yet, she had betrayed Johnny Dakin for another. And her falsities had been all of a piece with Mary Terhune's, for Dakin the beachcomber could not bring to mind a moment in which Barbara Jennings had seemed to tire of Johnny Dakin for another. And her falsities had been all of a piece with Mary luminous fires of ardent affection in her eyes. In their last kiss her traitorous, sweet mouth, so like Diamara's in its drooping softness, had still expressed that hunger of love which had always made him think she might actually draw his soul out through his lips. Dakin, the accepted lover of a savage mistress, cynically remembered that he had never seriously thought of the wrong he was doing James Jennings until he, himself, had been wronged for the second time. For lovers others do not exist!

Mary's lips . . . Barbara's lips . . . Diamara's lips! Such had been the progression. Marriage, forbidden fruit, and primitive love! Yet, looking upon Diamara, Dakin could not persuade himself that it had been a downward route. He simply passed by natural gradations, from the complex to the elemental, purging himself of artificial restraints and hypocritical subtleties. After all, Diamara's lips had been the sweetest; his life with Diamara had come closest to ecstasy. He had asked no more of her than love, and that she had given him without reservation.

Dakin said to himself that he had asked no more of her than love, but his busy, overwrought mind immediately commenced to question the accuracy of this idea. Had he not asked also the continuation of her love? Had he not also tacitly demanded that it should be entirely for him?—exclusive? Yes. Sharing! He would brook no more of that. Somehow, with this savage woman, infidelity loomed as a monstrous eventuality too hateful to be borne. It was as if a primal shame rose in him at the thought, clouding his brain with murderous primal instincts. The situation would be shorn of intellectual complications such as blame, extenuation, or excuse. Mental subtleties would be out of place.

Acquiescence to duplicity would be impossible. The torrid sheen of the palm-leaves might have been the outward, palpable manifesta-

tion of his state of soul. He recognized the presence in his breast of unaccustomed and tropically tempestuous emotions. Or, rather, perhaps, it should be said that he recognized the inward capacity for such emotions, since he had really no evidence against Diamara. In the event of an inescapable disclosure of guilt, he asked himself, whom would he kill? . . . And how many would he kill? But these queries were suspended in the air for lack of a basis in fact; besides, his reaction to the patent evidence of deception would be, in this climate, automatic and impulsive.

Idly, Dakin wondered why, in his two preceding misfortunes, he had slipped away from his betrayers like a hurt hound sneaking off into the woods to nurse his perplexity and his pain. He had in those days, he judged, still nourished a faith in humankind which shrank from disillusionment. He had believed, trusted, idealized; and the blows that had shattered his dreams had found him afraid to act like a man. What he meant by the notion of "acting like a man" was mistily obscure in his mind, but it involved some confused conception of cruelty and violence. Now that he had grown close to the earth again, stripping off religion and culture, the folly of considering others had become lucidly evident. The zest of life was in obeying fundamental instincts, and in this lay the true courage and wisdom. Dakin was amused for a fleeting instant by the reflection that many of his former associates and friends, if admitted to a knowledge of his mental attitude, would have felt, and possibly said in the spirit of their feelings, that the tropics had "sapped the moral fibre of his being". The phrase had a fulsome missionary ring to it, and one of the things which Dakin had most admired about the barbaric life was the absence of missionary cant, in word or in deed. He intended to act at least honestly by Diamara; that is, he intended to treat her exactly as he pleased, without regard for any known convention. His instincts would provide his conventions.

The hot, swift tropic sunset began to splash the sky with lurid strokes of color. Diamara's knee increased almost imperceptibly its soft, intermittent pressure. Once she lifted a lingering glance, partly inquiring and for the rest ambiguous, to Dakin's inscrutable countenance. What she saw there presumably satisfied her, for she again turned her eyes to the sea, then closed them.

The thoughts of the beach idler became concretely fixed on the problem of Diamara's eyes and lips. They possessed, he decided, precisely the same general characteristics as had those of Mary Terhune and those of Barbara Jennings; their intrinsic significance was the same. The eyes expressed languor and passion, tenderness, emo-

tional richness, the love of love. Fidelity was wanting. The lips revealed strength and extraordinary sweetness, powers of allurements, passion, responsiveness, and the hunger and thirst after love. Fidelity alone was wanting. Mary and Barbara, with such same eyes and lips in lesser measure of beauty, had given him everything but constancy. For the third time he had yielded his heart in the utmost yearning to a woman with eyes and lips that **could not** be true; the realization was final. Yet his soul cried agonizingly that he loved these luminous, exquisite, radiant, treacherous windows of passion! . . . loved, worshipped, and adored this tremulous, warm, fragrant, maddening flower of a mouth! Diamara! He almost spoke her name, carried away by the anguish of his longing. Desirable above anything he knew, she lay submissively at hand to his will and his pleasure. Yet he knew again he had loved a woman whose heart was a quicksand of the affections.

The shadows of night were fast gathering. In a few minutes darkness and chill would enclose them. Dakin shivered, and Diamara mistook this for the effect of the air. She turned into Dakin's arms, and the thrill of the contact, as always, submerged his conscious senses. Uncontrollably he pressed against her—ravaged her lips. He withdrew, breathless. This was madness of delight, he thought wildly; it was like the last kiss with Barbara, or with Mary—only more deliriously sweet! He fondled Diamara's throat, and Diamara mistook this for the restrained caress designed to whet the keen knife of longing. She trembled and moaned. Dakin seized her, possessed her, laid waste her mouth with kisses; but at the same time, relentlessly, his sinewy hand quenched at her throat the sweet breath that was still the delicious perfume of his soul's desire. At last, the golden limbs had ceased their convulsive writhings; a tremor shook them, and they were at rest for all eternity. Dakin had guarded his dear, frail love from the abhorrent smirch of treachery.

The sands sent a shimmer of a soiled whiteness up into the darkness. The palms were dusky masses of shadow, without hue, threatening, stealthy. The sea was visible only in venomous flashes of phosphorescence where the cruel ripples broke. A damp, miasmatic breeze stirred the now chilly air. Landerabs scuttled down from the palms on horrid enterprises. The scent of the fever-laden, swampy island undergrowth added menace to the desolation. Occasionally broken by hideous, furtive night-noises, a malevolent silence ominously enveloped the island.

On the sands Dakin was prostrated in heart-broken wretchedness of soul beside the body of his beloved dead.

SPANISH FOLK-POETRY

DECIMA RELIGIOSA

Aunque más reparos des
par' uno y par' otro la'o
Has de llevar vida mía
'Onde la llevó el venao'.

Hombre confiesa tu culpa
Examina tu consencia
Ante Dios y su clemencia
Será tu malisia bruta.
El pecado es una fruta
Que si por tu alma no ves
Te advierto que Dios es juez
Y cuenta te ha de tomar
Aunque más reparos des.

Hable con toda malicia
Es para ti la ironía
Pues válete de María
Teme de Dios su justicia.
No caigas en la avaricia
Y te diga Dios airado:
"Vete de aquí condenado.
A los senos del olvido
Que me tienes ofendido
Por uno y por otro lado."

Un alma al infierno enviáda
De Dios en su gran poder
Y la viene a defender
María siendo su abogada:
"No es bien que se pierda est'alma
Esta devosión tenía
Me resaba cada día
Y esta alma defiende yo."
Y Cristo le repondió;
"La has de llevar vida mía."

DONALD McKENZIE

Que triste va el pecador.
Cuándo Dios da la sentencia,
No le quedá resistencia
Ni le vale defensor
Ni le valen abogados
Porque Dios se ha olvidado
Y al infierno ha de ir a dar
Y esta alma la ha de llevar
'Onde la llevó el venado.

(Transcribed by Arthur L. Campa)

DONAL McKENZIE

SUICIDE

O, men of America,
translucent mosquitoës
scarlet with beauty's blood—
I shall escape
into a black box
and laugh
and LAUGH
through the unbreakable window
of your own invention.

CATHERINE STUART

NEW MEXICO LANDSCAPE

(Painted by Carl Redin)

They are returning * * *
These walls the ancients made * * *
Back to ochre sands,
Sagging under the span of years
Like oxen, heavy and slow.

Crumbling with a word like music
In a harmony of yellow cottonwood
Gnarled with limbs,
While winds go like the days go,
Color of indigo.

Contour of hills and mesa
You have made redolent
With the seep of ages,
Miles slip through atmospheric blues
And purples,
Over sands saturated with sun.

BOOKS RECEIVED

be still by William Closson Emory. The Lotus Press. Detroit.
The Grub Street Book of Verse 1929. Henry Harrison. New York.
One To Make Beauty by Helen Adams Parker. Henry Harrison. New York.
Myself Limited by Henry Harrison. Henry Harrison. New York.
Children of Fire and Shadow by Lucia Trent. Robert Packard & Co. Chicago.
Thirteen Days by Jeanette Marks. Albert & Charles Boni. New York.
An Anthology of Revolutionary Poetry edited by Marcus Graham. New York.
Dipped in Aloes by Benjamin Musser. Bozart Press. Atlanta.
Riding at Anchor by Benjamin Musser. Broder. New York.
The First Japm Anthology. Bozart Press. Atlanta.
Mad Queen by Harry Crosby. Black Sun Press. Paris.
Red Heels by Lexie Dean Robertson. Southwest Press. Dallas.

BOOK REVIEWS HAVE BEEN HELD OVER UNTIL NEXT ISSUE

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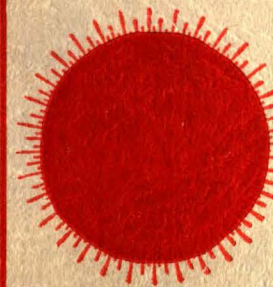
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UNEMPLOYED, a sketch by JOSEPH KALAR
WALDO FRANK by HAROLD J. SALEMSON.

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 HARRY CROSBY

COMMENT

HARRY CROSBY committed suicide in New York City and the world lost one of its finest contemporary poets. The death pact was the only logical culmination of Crosby's philosophy. He was dominated by the Rimbaud psychology, anti-social, an enemy of man protesting against the materialism and the hypocrisy of this Judas Age from the depth of his lyrical pain. A graduate of Harvard and a survivor of the late World War, he was swept along with an overpowering despair after the militarist deluge. Too aristocratic to embrace a proletarian ideology and too fundamentally a lover of truth to enjoy a world of lies, he found the only way out. Jack Conroy has called Crosby "another Cummings with a finer sense of music," and Marcus Graham has named him "a rebel in the literal sense of the word." Crosby's was undoubtedly one of the most beautiful, and at the same time, scathingly denunciatory voices of the time. I rather imagine that "Target for Disgust" will be hurled at a decaying Boston more than once in the times that are to come. It seems to me to be of the utmost importance that ALL of his works be collected in a uniform edition by some reputable publishing house for the complete preservation of his works. Many of his poems are still unpublished, and some of his early work is rather difficult of access, having been published in limited editions. It seems imperative to me that this be done. Perhaps *transition*, to which Crosby was advisory editor, will exert its influence in this direction. Crosby was another Rimbaud, but a more engaging literary personality.

Norman Macleod.

HARRY CROSBY

DESOLATE

the coast is desolate and
 encrusted with salt
the sea has encroached
 far on the land
naked crags
lift themselves from a sea of grey
worn and denuded stumps
 of mountains
standing for untold ages
 above the sea
their shoulders are
lifted high above the
 tree line
 their summits stand
 out gaunt and lonely
 in an unbroken solitude

the season is one of rain
and the old ruined castle
 stands in isolation
the blackening of the walls
 from the smoke of the hearth
the rain-water from the
 roof collecting in the gutters
these are the symbols
 for my loneliness

when you have gone

103°

What is this feverish plucking of the sheets these horizons of fire
these thunder-girls with eyes of lightning who come carrozzading
down the hot cylinders of my brain. They come to torture me with
thirst they squeeze clouds like oranges and drink down the juice
They rub their faces with icebergs They lie naked on frozen snow
My thirst multiplies remultiplies I would give rubies for a drop of
ice-water My tongue is a fire-brand My body is the heat of a hundred
hells My eyes are red coins of burning coal My hair is a forest fire

GUSTAVO BECQUER

There is the roar of a conflagration Is it the echo of the sun? Is it
the thunder of the waves of the sun pounding against the ramparts of
my heart? Am I this ribbon of fire hanging like a pigtail from the
Sun crackling in a hot wind of madness?

GUSTAVO BECQUER

THE SWALLOWS

The dusky swallows will return,
And in thy balcony hang their nests;
Their wings will tap thy window panes,
And playfully call thy guests:
But those who checked their wheeling flight,
Thy beauty and my bliss to learn,
And those who came to know our names,
Those—will not return!

The honeysuckles will return.
And fragrant climb thy garden wall;
And sweeter still, at evening's shade,
Their flowers will open fall:
But those that bent 'neath honied dew,
Whose drops we watched, in nights of yore,
Trembling fall, like day's sad tears,
Those—return no more!

They will come back; in thy dulled ears.
Love's ardent speeches sweet will sound;
Perchance thy heart will quicker beat.
Thus awakened from its sleep profound:
But mute, absorbed, and on their knees,
As one adores his God above.
As I have loved thee—think it not!
Thus they—will never love!

Translated from the Spanish by George St. Clair.

JOSEPH VOGEL

MARIA

I.

The little wife Maria, with red eyes, sits at the plain, coverless table, sipping from a glass of tea. Her forehead perspires, for it is a warm summer day and the three small rooms under the roof seem to be canned with heat.

What is going on in Maria's mind as she sits there gazing at the bare dark-orange wall? Who can tell? Maria is a resigned person, the sort who seems never to have had hopes for a better life, for a better man. She sits there, and her expression is sorrowful. At any moment one expects to see her burst into tears. But Maria seldom cries, even though her eyes are always red.

Of a sudden her body jerks into an attentive, alert pose. She has heard thumps of heavy feet on the stairs outside; then silence. Maria knows what that means. Her husband Yasha is drunk. He is climbing the stairs with difficulty, and now is resting to clear his head for a moment in order to climb a few more stairs in safety.

Maria knows instinctively that her husband is drunk, but fear for something else contracts her heart. What is Yasha doing here at this time of the day? Maria rocks her head from side to side. She knows that her husband has been fired, has lost another job.

The door flies open and Yasha stumbles into the room. He is a giant, with a red face and dull, expressionless eyes. With a large, heavy hand firmly planted on the wall he supports himself, and stares wildly at his little wife. She stares at him too, her fingers clasped around the glass.

"Ah!" Yasha cries, disgusted. He steps like a sober man across several feet of the floor, and drops heavily into a chair. Then he raises his shoulders, which had fallen almost on his knees, and brings them to rest against the back of the chair; he stares dully at his wife, who has followed him with her eyes.

"Yasha!" cries Maria, in a terror-stricken voice, "Yasha, what are you doing here now? You have lost your job again?"

A stupid grin spreads over Yasha's face.

Maria rises from her chair and stands at the table. She knows better than to approach within reach of her husband's hands. She rocks her head and seems about to burst into tears. Her little upturned nose, in which the nostrils are in plain view, sniffs. Her large lips move nervously, at times exposing an upper or lower row of irregular, yellow teeth. One cheek is pock-marked. Many times Yasha exclaimed "Bah!" even in the midst of affection, when he noticed her face in detail. At these outbursts of disgust, a submissive,

JOSEPH VOGEL

pleading look would enter her eyes, and she would withdraw from him and turn away her face.

"Yasha, give me your wages," says Maria, timidly. She knows how useless her words are. She knows that Yasha has squandered his last cent on whisky. Still she repeats her request, as she did many times before, hoping that in this indirect way she will make him realize their circumstances, and that he may awake to at least a bit of responsibility.

Yasha's grin grows wider and sillier.

"Next week, Yasha, we have rent to pay," says Maria in a shaky voice. "Where will we get money? Again we'll be put out on the street. Yasha, what have you done? Why did they fire you? What did you do? Yasha, get another job . . . or we'll be put out on the street again."

Yasha draws his lips together sternly. His eyes flame with anger. Waving his hand from side to side, he roars, "Maria, get away, leave me alone," and after this effort his face sinks into insipidity.

"Oh, oh, oh!" moans Maria, twisting her fingers among each other and pacing about the part of the room farthest away from her husband. "He has lost his job again. Such a good job and he lost it. The drunken pig comes home at this time of the day and sits there grinning at me. Oh, oh, what will we do? Next week we have rent to pay. And what will we eat? Even when he works we have not enough to live on." Turning to him she cries, "Pig, go out and find another job. Do you hear, go out and find another job! We will be kicked out on the street again. We will starve like rats again. Fool, drunken fool, why do you sit there? Where will money come from? Oh, oh, look how he sits there and doesn't move."

Maria speaks boldly, but her eyes are frightened and she watches her husband closely. Sweat runs down her face. Her brown eyes gleam with anger; her voice trembles, filled with hopelessness.

Yasha's chin has sunken on his breast. "Keep quiet," he mumbles. "Leave me alone. Get away from me."

Now that Yasha's eyes are lowered, his wife becomes bolder. She screams, "So you want me to get away from you, eh? You want me to leave you, eh? All right, drunken pig, all right. I'll leave you. And may I drop dead in my tracks if you'll see me again."

She rushes through the rooms, gathers up her shawl and her black, seedy hat with a little drooping feather on one side, meanwhile letting out a stream of wounded words. Although, on this warm summer day, she has not the least use for her shawl and hat, still she gathers them together. This gesture has become habitual; it means that she is taking her belongings with her. When she first threatened to leave him, years ago, she ran about the rooms searching frantically for her possessions. But all she could find to take with her were a shawl and a hat.

"So he wants me to go, he wants me to go," she cries, tears welling in her eyes. "I'll go, you can be sure. I'll go, right now, and may I roast in hell if you'll ever see me again. The pig, after all these years he wants me to leave him." She slams her hat over her head, throws her shawl about her shoulders and runs to the door, throwing it wide open. Standing in the doorway, with a hand on the doorknob, she shouts, "Believe me, I won't go hungry again. I know how to earn a few dollars. And I will, pig, I will. I'm not so old that men won't have me. I won't go hungry again, you can be sure."

Suddenly Yasha's head jerks up and he bellows, "Booh!" Maria jumps in fright, slams the door behind her and runs quickly down the three flights of stairs. She runs quickly, her breast bitter with grief; and her whole being more bitter with a devastating realization that her words were not serious, that she has no place to go, that she is fleeing toward nowhere, and worst of all, that she will return to her rooms and her husband after darkness has fallen.

Yasha sits in his chair, his head cocked to one side, listening to his wife's rapid footsteps on the stairs. As soon as the hall is quiet, he sinks back in his chair dejectedly, and forgets about Maria. He knows that she will return later, that she will take off her hat and shawl and lay them aside in their places as though she just returned from church. And he knows that she will not speak to him, except when a word or two are necessary . . . and those words will be dry and bitter, struggling out from a torn heart.

So he sits in his chair, his head in his hands, a great hunger consuming his body. He does not give a thought to his wife, nor to her tears, nor to her wretchedness. All he is aware of is the gnawing hunger within him, and he knows that there is not even a penny in his pockets.

* * *

The room darkens. It is becoming late. Yasha raises his heavy head slowly and looks about. There is nothing to look at, except the bare walls. He gets up, goes to the sink and fills a glass with water. As he drinks his face twists with disgust, and he spits out the warm liquid. "Bah!" he exclaims, nauseated. "Bah!"

The picture of the saloon on the corner rises in his mind like a mirage. His mouth dries with anticipation. Ah, how thirsty he is, how great the hunger in him is! He looks about for his cap, and unable to see anything clearly, he leaves the room without locking the door—if a robber wants to enter, let him; if he can find anything to steal, then all the luck in the world to him—and steps carefully down the broken stairs in the dark hallway.

II.

Yasha enters the corner saloon and looks sullenly at the men

around him. He makes straight for the bar and leans against it, his elbows on top.

"Ah-ha, look who's here," cries Jimmie, the bartender. "Well, how goes it today, Yasha, still working? Will you have a drink?"

Yasha looks dumbly at him and shakes his head up and down.

"And have you got money to pay?" asks Jimmie, his eyes lighting with amusement.

Yasha shakes his head from side to side.

Jimmie regards him for a moment, his brows raised. Then he fills a small glass with whisky, sets it before Yasha, and without a word moves away to other customers.

Yasha puts his long, thick fingers around the little glass and stares into it. His mind is blank. He had forgotten about his great hunger while on his way to the saloon. Now that hunger rises in him again, fiercely, and he raises the glass swiftly to his lips, striking the edge of the glass against his teeth, and gulps down the whisky. A frown distorts his face; his body shudders; he has to swallow several times before, with smacking of the lips, his features settle again into their normal position.

"Ah!" he groans, as the liquid burns its way into his stomach. "Ah!" and he smacks his tongue against the roof of his mouth.

Yasha turns slowly around, walks over to a chair and sits down. His head falls to one side; a doleful expression comes into his eyes. He feels that there is something to think about, some kind of decision to make, but he cannot remember. An imp prods his brain and stirs up images, but he can make neither head nor tail out of them. Yes, he lost his job that afternoon. He damaged about a case of goods in all—so his boss said—by striking clear through several wooden boxes with his curved iron prong. His boss threatened to have him arrested, put in jail . . . drunken bum . . . get out of here right now . . . here, here's your pay . . . get out. . .

Yasha draws the back of his hand across his lips, drawing them widely apart. His wife left him . . . no more wife . . . later she will come back . . . give her a beating . . . now, no more wife . . . damn, rotten wife . . .

The saloon fills with more men and more noise. Everybody is drinking, everybody is shouting and having a good time. Yasha looks at the men at the bar. No one offers to treat him to a drink. Everybody is happy, everybody has enough money to pay for drinks.

GEORGE JARRBOE

LLOYD OF SARATOGA

1777

Riffraff, prick up your ears,
Bond-slaves, Indians, black men,
Who make up these rebel ranks,
I, your Sergeant, have a hint for you.
Our masters respectfully suggest we advance.
March, comrades. Lively.
There, through the woods, the English gentlefolk
With men weary and dirty like you and me
Fret to hoist us on their whetted iron.
We might as well trudge on;
Nothing's behind but unrewarded labor.
Ahead perhaps Hope smiles, for our children, not us;
Our malformed lives are tools to batter with,
No more.
About to die I dare a dream,
Lifting my spirit like old mummied wine,
That back of the enemy trench
Rears a new state
For us, the lonely and the dregs.
March, comrades.
We heard blatter of "independence"
July last year;
The masters act pleased, boasting a saving in gold
From debts to English merchants they'll not have to pay,
Swilling in hogsheads of blood-purchased rum.
We of the lower orders sneer at this "Declaration," and know
It strikes not sixty seconds from a servant's time,
Invests no tenant with farm,
Pays no Indian for the raped land,
Permits no black man to walk erect—
Keep step. No lagging.
To-day we have a span new flag.
Our masters gave it us.
I like it not, smacking of cent. per cent.,
Smuggling, indentures, and the branding-iron.
The masters rant of "Liberty" for themselves,
Rife with the spirit thereof, not the principle,
Looking on us as ordure far below
Their shining silver buckles.
They need us now, and I fight, and when it's done—

GEORGE JARRBOE

I've only scholarship, no commercial instinct—
I must go back to chains in Williamsburg,
Throwing down the free man's rifle, loaned temporarily,
To make the issue of a scented harlot
Parrot what they can never understand.
Livelier, that lagging rearmost file!
I'm Sergeant Lloyd, I can prove it with my fist.
Get on.
There's nothing, I say, behind;
I dare believe that yonder, long miles on,
A gentle hand puts out from poor men's hopes,
Strikes up the fratricidal musket.
Get on, men.
Now you're ahead of me.
My compliments, comrades.
I cannot rise. Strange, but I find comfort
On the hard earth,
Only the festering brand-mark aches,
Not the seven wounds
Painting a cardinal's robes on my humble corpse.
Pardon, masters, my assuming a fine garment.
That harlot will miss me,
The one schooled brain in her lavish house.
Well, there'll be other wretches
Spite of that gridiron flag shaking so bravely
Lies to the stormy wind.
Once my father had gold and I went to school
With dukes and earls, in England. Now, a bond-slave,
In despised, rebel ranks,
Shoulder to shoulder with peasants and city-scum,
I fight, and lie here, knowing I shall not rise,
Gripping like a boy stuffed with sweatmeats
And hopes of more.
My comrades march, they've cleared the bristling trench
Streaked with bastard daylight;
With backs still bent they press on.
The red-and-silver gentles are all red;
I also in my gaudy robes,
My abdomen a tiny fountain.
They're dying all around me.
Through splintered branches, fluttering leaves,
Past corpses, pillory, hot irons, harlot's scented curls.
My eyes fix on a patch of farthest blue—
Yonder's true morning!
Gods! There she is! the sapphire eyes, the sword
Dripping more than reddest morning,

THE MORADA

Pure lady of Marathon, Mons Sacra, Sempach, Long Marston.
She is not glad I am dying.
Even as she bent to Eunus, Spartacus, John Ball,
She weeps that the goal of my dream is distant—
Earth must be charnel of dregs like me
Each time is firmly laid a stone of the new house.
Good. Sleep well. And bravo, Lloyd!
Through thinning, stinging smokes fall gentle leaves,
A free man's cerement.
Except for the battle it's a fine afternoon,
My couch is restful, and my slavery's passing.
I'm Sergeant Lloyd of the republican army,
Good as any man, strongfisted, ideas in my head.
Fully I live these moments, stand up, salute,
I follow, O goddess,
With bayonet ready,
Your service hard but sweet.
You stride through mansions, overseers, magistrates, huts,
Toward a new house for my people,
Your sword implacable, pointing straight;
Blinding bright through tons of shattering darkness
Is your smile, O Liberty!
I thank you for your arms,
And the matchless pillow, your bosom,
And the beauteous lips that say
I shall sleep in the new house.

PAULINE LEADER

MEMORY OF THE EVENING

In the washed-blue morning
my memory of the evening
is a littered ground where a circus has been;
her sounds and scents seem as stupidly unreal
as folded-up circus atmosphere.

CHARLES YALE HARRISON

IN A DUG-OUT

(Fragment of a War Novel*)

We never become accustomed to the shell-fire. Its terror for us increases with each passing day. The days out on rest ease our harried nerves, but as soon as we are back in the line again we are as fearful and jumpy as the newest recruit. With the first hiss and roar of a shell we become terror-stricken as of old.

We look at each other with anxious, frightened faces.

Our lips tighten.

Our eyes open wide.

We do not talk. What is there to say?

* * *

Talk of the coming offensive continues.

The sector becomes more tumultuous.

The guns rage all night.

We "stand to" long before dawn and wait at the parapets expecting an attack until long after sunrise.

The fatigues are innumerable.

Every night there are wiring parties, sapping parties, carrying parties. We come back exhausted from these trips. We throw ourselves down in the dug-outs for an hour's sleep.

But we do not rest.

There is no time for rest. We stagger around like drunken, forsaken men. Life has become an insane dream.

Sleep, sleep—if only we could sleep.

Our faces become gray. Each face is a different shade of gray. Some are chalk-colored, some with a greenish tint, some yellow. But all of us are pallid with fear and fatigue.

It is three in the morning.

Our section is just back from a wiring party.

The guns are quiet.

Dawn is a short while off

We sit on the damp, earthen floor of the dug-out.

We have one candle between us and around this we sit chewing at the remains of the day's rations.

Suddenly the bombardment begins.

*Generals Die in Bed by Charles Yale Harrison to be published in New York in the Spring of 1930.

The shells begin to hammer the trench above.

The candle-light flickers.

We look at each other apprehensively. We try to talk as though the thing we dread most is not happening.

The sergeant stumbles down the steps and warns us to keep our battle equipment on.

The dug-out is an old German one, it is braced with stout wooden beams. We look anxiously at the ceiling of the hole in which we sit.

The walls of the dug-out tremble with each crashing detonation.

The air outside whistles with the rush of the oncoming shells.

The German gunners are "feeling" for our front line.

The crashing of the shells comes closer and closer. Our ears are attuned to the nuances of a bombardment. We have learned to identify each sound.

They are landing on the parapets and in the trench itself now.

We do not think of the poor sentry, a new arrival, whom we have left on look-out duty.

We crowd closer to the flickering candle.

Upstairs the trench rings with a gigantic crack as each shell lands. An insane god is pounding it with Cyclopean fists, madly, incessantly.

We sit like prehistoric men within the ring of flickering light which the candle casts. We look at each other silently.

A shell shatters itself to fragments near the entrance of the dug-out.

The candle is snuffed out by the concussion.

Another shell noses its shrieking way into the trench near the entrance and explodes. The dug-out is lit by a blinding red flash. Part of the earthen stairway caves in.

In the blackness the ripping and thudding over our heads sounds more malignant, more terrible.

We do not speak.

Each of us feels an icy fear gripping at the heart.

Shell-fire!

With a shaking hand Cleary strikes a match to light the candle. The small flame begins to slowly spread its light. Grotesque, fluttering shadows creep up the trembling walls.

Another crash directly over our heads.

It is dark again.

Fry speaks querulously.

"Gee, you can't even keep the damned thing lit."

At last the flame sputters and flares up.

Broadbent's face is green.

The bombardment swells, howls, roars.

The force of the detonations causes the light of the candle to become a steady, rapid flicker. We look like men seen in an ancient,

unsteady motion-picture.

The fury of the shelling makes me ill at the stomach.

Broadbent gets up and staggers into a corner of our underground room.

He retches.

Fry starts a conversation.

We each say a few words trying to keep the game alive. But we speak in broken sentences. We leave thoughts unfinished. We can think only of one thing—will the beams in the dug-out hold?

We lapse into fearful silences.

We clench our teeth.

It seems as though the fire cannot become more intense. But it becomes a little more rapid—then more rapid. The pounding increases in tempo like the noise in the head of one who is going under an anesthetic. Faster, faster. . . .

The explosions seem as though they are taking place in the dug-out itself. The smoke of the explosives fills the room.

Fry breaks the tension.

"The lousy swine," he says, "why don't they come on over?"

We all speak at once. We punctuate our talk with vile epithets belittling the parentage or sexual habits of the enemy. We seem to get relief in filthy cuss-words.

In that instant a shell hurtles near the opening over our heads and explodes with a snarling roar. Clods of earth and pieces of wooden supports slither down the stairway.

It is dark again.

In the darkness we hear Anderson, the ex-lay preacher. He speaks in his sing-song voice:

"How do you expect to live through this with all your swearing and taking the Lord's name in vain?"

For once we do not heap abuse and ribaldry on his bald head. We do not answer.

We sit in the darkness afraid now to even light the accursed candle. It seems as though the enemy artillerymen have taken a dislike to our candle and are intent on blowing it out.

I look up at the shattered stairway and see a few stars shining in the sky.

At least we are not buried alive!

The metallic roar continues.

Fry speaks:

"If I ever live through this, I'll never swear again, so help me God."

Anderson smiles an evangelical smile.

We feel that we will promise anything to be spared the horror of being buried alive under tons of earth and beams which shiver over our heads with each explosion. Bits of earth from the ceiling

begin to fall. . . .

Suddenly, as quickly as it began, the bombardment stops.

We start to clear up the debris from the bottom of the stairs.

W.

To think we could propitiate a senseless god by abstaining from cussing!

What god is there as mighty as the fury of a bombardment? More terrible than lightning, more cruel, more calculating than an earthquake!

How will we ever be able to go back to peaceful ways again and hear pallid preachers whimper of their puny little gods who can only torment sinners with sulphur, we, who have seen a hell that no god, however cruel, would fashion for his most deadly enemies?

Yes, all of us have prayed during the maniac frenzy of a bombardment.

Who can live through the terrorladen minutes of drumfire and not feel his reason slipping, his manhood dissolving?

Selfish, fear-stricken prayers—prayers for safety, prayers for life, prayers for air, for salvation from the death of being buried alive. . . .

Back home they are praying, too—praying for victory—and that means that we must lie here and rot and tremble forever. . . .

We clear away the debris and go to the top of the broken stairs. It is quiet and cool.

PAUL BOWLES

SERENADE AU CAP

A dull pearl evening presses down flat over all the land
Dimming and darkening it pushes its grey face down wide
All around upon the lavender leaves in the trees
Expressionless all dead grey in the fast twilight
It hugs the hot earth close to its face
Under the towering fir by the pool the soft earth is warm and black
A complete silence wafts down across the wet terraces and moist petals
Wrinkle and fall the little diamond lights by the sea in a long
Curving line glimmer twinkle shiver on the brink of a grey eternity
The pool is still with warm dark water the masses of froth do not move
A dark form impenetrable silent in the fast twilight hugs the hot earth
Close to its face

HAROLD J. SALEMSON

PORTRAIT OF WALDO FRANK

I would like to write some large and supple phrases,
As if I never read the books he wrote,
As if I had read only all the letters
We exchanged, and articles and glosses on his work.
And conversations: someone speaking of him,
While I sat enchanted, listening, trying to imbibe
Impressions of the man. One spoke harshly, one
Inscribed his book of verse to him, his friend.
Another met him in New York. A Frenchman.
Then he wrote an article about him in a small review
In French. He said: **Waldo Frank est juif.**
The words were dry. But all the venom that those words
Have carried, designating other men, was here reduced
To nothing. It was just a statement. Admiration
Swept away all prejudice. A small mind rises
To great heights, confronted by the force such writings bear.

One morning in New York, I made a visit.
My host stood finishing his dressing. He excused himself,
Because he was awaited at a literary lunch
My host was well-known in New York and elsewhere;
He too wrote, and he knew Waldo Frank.
He asked me if I'd met him. I said no. And then
He spoke about him to me. His words were these:
"He is a Messiah of the world of letters.
If you talk to him about his work upon a human plane.
He looks at you and in his eyes appears a look of pity.
Great pity does he feel for ignorance, but thinks:
They know not what they do. . . The look
Remains and soon you feel his words, as if he had spoken them.
He has been mute, but you have heard: 'Poor man,
You do not know my father's business. Have you never
Heard of God?' He is an Atlas, bearing on his back
The weight of all America's, of all the world's
Importance in the literary field." My host continued:
"Do you think that he exaggerates his force?"
I did not answer and the subject changed.

Today I ran my eyes across the letters I've received from him.
He was too busy when I was near enough
And so, we've never met. But we have written to each other,
And he often asks me when I will return, when we will meet.

It almost seems as though some interest in me
Has taken form within him and that he would like to talk with me.
He writes: "It is a fine day warming for spring.
If you were here we'd have a walk and talk
And it would do my parched soul good." And still,
He does not know me. At the best, he's read a few lines
That I wrote. But what are they? The sun
Would ask the stars to keep him company. O irony!

And now I have been reading in a book.
Its author is the greatest, I believe,
Our country has yet had, within that field
Of fiction. And he tells of how, before he had been crowned
By fame, an article appeared about his work.
It gave him courage, helped him persevere,
And shoed away the evil thoughts he harbored.
Then he tells the critic's name. The article
Was signed by Waldo Frank. It's he who saved the other
From despair one day. And if he had done nothing else,
Within that act there is enough to make him known
To all posterity. But he has done much more.
I've read his books. . . .

But now the time has come to stop, for I intended
To write some large and supple phrases, as if I
Had never read the things he wrote, his books . . .
Why did I choose this mask of ignorance?

CATHERINE STUART

ICEBERG LAKE

Bluer than clustered Harebells
carpeting the retreat of glaciers
your waters crack upon mountains of ice.
Down in your depths
the sun is forever a stranger;
You live in a crystal cataclysm
of shifting ice.

HARRY CROSBY

SUN-DEATH (1)

Take Nietzsche "Die at the right time. Die at the right time: so
teacheth Zarathustra."

Take the Gymnosophists, who used to kill themselves in public
in the market-place. Take the widows of India who flung themselves
on the funeral pyres of their husbands. Take the Greeks: Diogenes,
Socrates, Demosthenes, Themistocles, and Sappho, because of her love
for the disdainful Phaon. Take the Romans: Porcia, Arria, Lucretia,
Brutus and Cassius and Cato.

Take Dido. Take Cleopatra. Take Samson. Take the Saints and
Martyrs. Take Jesus Christ. Take the Members of that famous Sui-
cide Club, who drew lots once a year to see whose turn it was to die.
Take Modigliani. Take Van Gogh, example of triumphant individual-
ity, banner waving from the topmost pinnacle, and take his death into
Sun. Go to Van Gogh, you sluggards, consider his ways and be wise.

But to return to Nietzsche "die at the right time." no matter
where you are, in the depths of the coal pit, in the crowded streets
of the city, among the dunes of the desert, in cocktail bars, or in the
perfumed corridors of the Ritz, at the right time, when your entire
life, when your soul and your body, your spirit and your senses are
concentrated, are reduced to a pin-point, the ultimate gold point, the
point of finality, irrevocable as the sun, sun-point, then is the time,
and not until then, and not after then (O horrors of anticlimax
from which there is no recovering) for us to penetrate into the cavern
of the sombre Slave-Girl of Death, to enter upon coition with the
sombre Slave-Girl of Death, to enjoy explosion with the sombre Slave-
Girl of Death, in order to be reborn, in order to become what you
wish to become, tree or flower or star or sun, or even dust and noth-
ingness, for it is stronger to founder in the Black Sea of Nothingness,
like a ship going down with flags, than to crawl like a maldoror into
the malodorous whorehouse of evil and old age.

I recall the Hollow Men

"This is the way the world ends

This is the way the world ends

This is the way the world ends

Not with a bang but a whimper"

and Eliot is right, absolutely right, as regards the majority, as regards
the stupid Philistines, whose lives have always been a whimper, whose

(1) reprinted from **Mad Queen** by Harry Crosby, The Black Sun
Press. Editions Narcisse. Paris.

THE MORADA

lives could never be anything else but a whimper, whose lives must inevitably end with a whimper, they who prefer senility, who prefer putrefaction of the brain, who prefer hypocrisy, sterility, imbecility, (do not confound with madness) importance, to the strength and fury of a Sun-Death dead bodies and dead souls dumped unceremoniously into the world's latrine.

But for the Seekers after Fire and the Seers and the Prophets (hail to you o men of transition) and for the Worshippers of the Sun, life ends not with a whimper, but with a Bang—a violent explosion mechanically perfect ("Imperthnthnthnthnthn") a Sun-Explosion into Sun—while down and down downwards down below with bloodied heaviness sinks the menstuous cloth of the past (protegez-vous contre la syphilis) for the eunuchs and the sabbatarians to feed upon (how can they know the Sun, those dry trees, they of the clammy hands and the fetid breath, with their pro-cathedrals and their diplomacy). Let them dungdevour, let their maggot fingers swarm over the red cloth, while we, having set fire to the powderhouse of our souls, explode suns within suns and cataracts of gold into the frenzied fury of the Sun, into the madness of the Sun, into the hot gold arms and hot gold eyes of the Goddess of the Sun.

NORMAN MACLEOD

EFFIGIES IN BAS-RELIEF

Noise renders no time reflective
and cities gain what mountains never held
and what I knew of quiet
beyond outpouring strength of cedars
gnarled but rugged still
lost in a swelter of chaotic superimpositions.

Now in a golden wasteland,
cathedrals to cover a category of saints.

PROCESSION

Bound with turkeyfeather rope.
The days together
Go with the aspect of finite variety
In a changeful weather
Cast upon the ascending slope.
The sun to tether.

FREDERIC COVER

BLOOD FROM A STONE

Cursing the fate
That held us to a town so dull and pale
That even love grew stale,
Where the small weight
Of ordinary duties was so great
As to distort our wills,
And all our talks
Were filled with hate
And bitterness, we took our little walks
Discussing ills.

"Why?" you would say,
"Why should a host of others have the sea
Day after day
Tumbling upon the sands incessantly
Like a huge beast at play,
Washing away
The jagged edges of the sand, the pain
Of little cutting things of life, while we
Have nothing but a plain?"
You would say
It was not fair, and I'd agree.

Until a day
We paused beside the tracks to watch a train
Approach and speed away
Over the plain.
And the train roared
And the trucks clanged and the wheels screamed;
A thousand faces framed in mystery,
Blurred faces, soared
Across our wakened vision and it seemed
Good to remain.
I looked at you and you looked at me,
We smiled (a little wistfully)
And gazed at the disappearing train.

SOLON R. BARBER

CROSS COUNTRY: The Mexican Land

It is a high and lonely, but somehow insolent land. There is no feeling of surrender. (I saw an American throw a copper five-centavos piece to an ancient, tottering beggar at the side of the railroad tracks one day and she refused it sullenly. She would have broken her back to pick up half a peso . . .)

It is a land born out of the union of fire and force. The sky is clearblue and the overwhelming colour of the land, of the hills, is green but you feel the burned copper and black of heat beneath the soil. Even the mountains are thrown up jaggedly and grotesquely. Sawtooth mountains, fierce and crazy in the distance.

It is a land that has bread, and breeds, angels and saints, brigands and beggars and bastards. Cripples there in the country pueblas, but not so many as in the city. The fire of the campo kills or cures them. It is a land of dark men and passionate women. But the men live on and the women are bred-out early. They do not kill their old. Half the beggars are old. But only the strong survive unmarked by disease and hunger.

It is a land of flowers and birds, this highland of Mexico. Lavender morningglories, delicate as butterflies, cluster about the roots of the maguey plants and line the sides of the canals. White flowers fringe the edges of cornfields and tiny, delicate blueblossoms grow at the base of the hills. Flashes of orangeflowers break the drab grey and tan of the land where it is drier. Every hut has its scarlet and purple climbing about the door and the churchyards are a wilder colorsong, rising, breaking, and falling. The birds sing happiest early in the morning when the dew is on the grass. As the day draws on, they find the shade and chirp sleepily and flutter among the leaves.

Herds of goats and asses and cattle graze all day on the sparse grass in the maguey fields. A peon passes, driving his donkeys, singing a Mexican lovesong. Cordwood, tied in neat bunches over the backs of burros, is carried from house to house in the villages with the women waiting in open doorways. Lonely horsemen watch the sheep on the hills. Corn sprouts from the dry soil. The great sombreros of peones are shaped like the cone of a mountain peak.

It is a land of great distances, of waiting, brooding distances. But everywhere the hills are dotted with squares of white and pink where the stone walls and houses are. Darker adobe huts are the homes of the poor. Almost all of the people are poor. The fortunate rich surround their homes with highstone walls, but the poor beat forever at the gates.

Every town has its church; in some, there are many. Pink domes

SOLON R. BARBER

rise from clumps of green and the crumbling walls of churchyards once guarded the leisure and the reflection of the holy padres. The churches were rich once, but now they are poor, and churchbells yawn voiceless and the bellcords are broken. Stone—stone for the churchyards because it is unyielding, eternal. But now the stone is matched with a law and the peasants count their beads in secret and burn their holy candles behind drawn shutters.

All faces wear the print of the sun. All eyes are guaged for distance. Their muscles are the sinews of the hills and their feet know the beating of the earth's heart.

A train passes, spouting fire from the firebox, steam hissing. And the engineer smiles like a child with a toy. A ragged child comes to the coach windows to sell chokecherries. An aged woman sits by a wall that is older than locomotives. Chokecherries in the hands of children are older than locomotives and stone walls hold the learning and memories of centuries. There is no feeling of surrender, but someone is playing a holy song in the distance. Perhaps they think that, God alone knowing the secret of this land, he will provide. But the gaunt dogs know the lesson of hunger and the peones know the strength of the walls that fence the richer acres.

Sullen, sullen the land—hotly and insolently beautiful. . . .

Down through the green canons, to the sound of tumbling water. Warmer, heavier here, but the mountains still challenge the sky. The foliage is changing. The jungle is creeping in and darkgreen trees, branched wildly, crawl nearly to the tops of the peaks. Women are washing their clothes in the swift, cold streams. The wind already carries the breath of the sea. The Gulf, on the wind, reaches up through the hills and bathes the green hills.

Still high and insolent, but Mexico is breaking down to the sea and her fierce eyes are growing drowsy. . . .

It has been raining, but the cornleaves still droop with sun. It is going to rain: The buzzards are flying low and there is a greymist over the mountainpeaks. The air seems to whisper heavily; it screamed on the highlands. The land is shading off into purple; purple is still the color of the hills.

Early morning, Veracruz. No sleep. The sound of the town, the buzzing of insects, and strange, unrestful dreams all night. Up and out before dawn. The boy rubs sleep from his eyes at the door and takes the heavy wooden planks away from the swinging doors. Out into the dark, the city drenched with tropical rain. No lights. Only one or two sarape-draped men in the streets. Dark and heavy with rain and seamist.

Cafe and pan in the small station cafe. Excellent coffee, but it is the inevitable Mexican sweetbread. They are boarding the train.

Few travelers today. But a charming Spanish girl bids her lover good-bye endlessly. They kiss, cling together. They repeat things over and over.

Out into the sand-dunes which the jungle cannot finally conquer. Everything fragrant with rain. Far in the West, the bluemountains, draped with clouds. The peak of Orizaba is cloud-covered. A wood-smoke smell from the villages. Cocks are crowing among the trees. A pig grunts in a puddle. They are selling flowers to those in the train. A little Indian boy with a saint's face and a broken arm sells bunches of white blossoms. Two buzzards, clean-necked, perch sleepily on the thatch of a hut. An old woman with rheumatism, but no shoes.

Up and always up. The mountains are coming nearer. This is the Cortes road. Four hundred years ago, over this road he marched with his men—to the Valley of Mexico—to the highlands—for God—for Glory and Gold. . . .

Paso del Macho at the base of the mountains. We stop to switch on the electric locomotive that draws the long train over the mountains, and the eastbound train passes here. A long stop. Time to get out and walk and smell the rainsoaked air. The rain has been heavy here too. Piles of ties at the side of the track are black and heavy with water. The smell of bacon from the station restaurant. Women and girls are selling tortas, cafe con leche, cheese, boiled eggs, sandwiches, platanos, melons. Not much trade. The dogs get nothing. A hard life and a gaunt one for dogs and women and girls. The locomotive whistles, the train jerks restlessly, the dogs whine, hungry.

Now the hills are thick with darkgreen brush. We pass through a cut, lined with dense grass and flowers beneath the trees, and turn into the first arroya. The climb begins. . . . The sun is breaking through the clouds, an hour high.

The most beautiful country in the world! As we gain a few hundred feet elevation, we see the great sand coastplain of the eastern fringe of Mexico. Forty or fifty miles away, the waters of the Gulf can be seen, green and grey. We climb through dense brush: Palm fronds, waving hands of green plantains, wild flowers, flowers of all hues. Ferns. I catch the delicate lavender of orchids back among the trees. A little stone town in the hills. Everybody is looking out of windows. The chirping of birds and the echo of crowing cocks. Someone is whistling slowly. "Platanos." We are moving again. White turkeys roosting on a whitestone wall. A marvelous, breathtaking bursting of crimson blossoms at a doorway. . . .

GEORGE ST. CLAIR

ON AGAIN SEEING THE MONA LISA

Strange that some beauty we have seen before
And oft enjoyed, when suddenly again
It strikes our eyes, brings with it sweetest pain,
While mystic beauty grips our hearts once more.
O Master, subtlest of the seers, who bore
Aloft Love's torch of beauty, nor in vain,
Through prejudice and envy and disdain,
Showered on men the treasures of thy lore;
What can I say, as suddenly the sight
Of thy dear Donna pierces like a dart,
Filling my heart with wonder and delight?
How shall I find fit words to praise thy art?
Mutely I bow before thy magic might,
Tears in my eyes, and sweet pain in my heart.

BENJAMIN MUSSER

BRANDED

How truer than truth itself you bravely said:
A love that has no future and no past!
Never was born and never will be dead,
Never will be consummated at last!
We are today, our love is present tense
And always must be, always so has been,
A little thing immeasurably immense,
The soul's divinest offering, and a sin.

How braver than bravery you truly said:
Nothing is gained but loss, and loss is gain!
A love that in its giving food is fed,
Is strengthened in its hopelessness and pain!
We do not pity ourselves, we do not damn
Those who would damn us, children of the dark;
But all our love is, all you are. I am,
Is our brave ineradicable mark.

JOSEPH KALAR

UNEMPLOYED

In the shadow of a poolhall he stands limply. It will soon be night. Twilight now is a soft fall of grey ashes. Look: twilight is a dry fog settling on brothels, falling on blindpigs, falling on poolhalls, cigarstores, cafes. It will soon be night. Darkness creeps stealthily over the papermill, blotting piles of broken lumber, blotting boxcars, piles of sulphite screenings, blotting junkpile, ashpile, coalpile. It will soon be night. Nothing now but dull glow of windows. He looks, his body sagging limply. A cigaret glows between his fingers. He is quite alone. It is a very cold night. The people he wants to see and watch as they walk down the sidewalk are still at home eating supper. He doubts if they will come tonight. It is a very cold night and it looks like rain. The clouds have whispered it, the wind telegraphs, the smoke promises. From the papermill a vile jetting of sulphur dioxide. It settles in a stinking fog. It burns in the nostrils, penetrates, sweeps down allies, settles on vacant lots, fills the street. Now distantly there is a throb, a muffled overture of wheels, pulleys, beaters, grinders, and escaping steam. The nightshift is at work. He is not working.

It had been done quite simply. He remembered walking over the slippery greasy floor, a thin film gliding over his eyes and a quiet calm flowing to his lips; he remembered how tired his legs were from pressing down levers and how they trembled in relaxation; he remembered words walking coldly through thin lips; remembered a small white discharge slip, his laughter by the gate, his sudden fierce anger, his clenched fist.

It was done always so simply. Words walking through thinfat lips and there tomorrow a man stands on streetcorners futile cold and hungry fingers of his loneliness reaching out to touch people hurrying by him with an icy stare, a dry fog settling down upon him o suddenly most surely a little brown dog wagging his tail asking for handpats aching with hunger wincing at thoughts of tomorrows endlessly on parade.

Or Chicago. Waves smashing into splinters of green on the lake-front a cold breeze dancing over the lake the zoom of traffic roar of Levated beating upon him sitting on a parkbench watching lovers disappear into the shrubbery and he sitting there looking stupidly numb with cold. God. Or walking, for instance, over Clark St. bridge odor of roasted coffee not quite overwhelming odor of garbage pulled by puffing tugs, and a policeman dogging his steps. Or W. Madison St. smell of sour sweat thick on the air and canned heat and a man sidling to him touching his shoulder **come with me dearie I will give you something to eat.** God. Or watching the sharkboards hoping and not

JOSEPH KALAR

hoping wishing and not wishing wanting and not wanting, apathy and fear streaming up his legs, depressing his heart, and God how he did want to cry.

Or Cincinnati. And a small jew eyeing him coldly sneering, his eyes walking over frayed edges of his overcoat frayed trousers wrinkled tie walking coldly over his face and hair cut not quite in the latest fashion and God how his soul whimpered and snuffled and crept into the dark kennels of despair to turn crouching hate flowering darkly within him hands longing to grasp the sleek throat throttling until sharkboards wantads breadlines flopjoints crumbled into dust and were one with the dark earth and beauty flowered over all the land.

Or sitting there anywhere now or then or tomorrow slowly a contraction of his Being more and more significant until he was as a flea or a paintpimple on a parkbench or a cockroach crawling repulsively over the pavement and the beautiful girls their legs always a walking away and a drawing away and he so wanting a white hand running gently through his hair.

A freight to Minneapolis. Omaha. Detroit. Cleveland. Seattle. Always boxcars rattling over gleaming rails always parallel the earth always feeling and responding always: the dark cool maternal earth. Always a magnet always calling always crying to him to speed away from his pain futile and hungry and he wanting to smash things and a cold clean wind from the east beating upon him pushing him pushing him pushing pushing right through him beyond him beyond civilization and policemen and scabs and hunger and words walking through thinfat lips beyond a tomorrow that is but the crack of a pistol beginning the march of tomorrows and tomorrows endlessly on parade.

Christ, he mutters suddenly, his fingers grasping a cigaret he has forgotten to puff. He flips the butt into the street, leaves shadows of the poolhall, and walks quickly away, his legs trembling a bit in relaxation.

CHARLES HENRI FORD

Still in the night
a star has fallen,
aping a bright
flower's pollen.

Grieve, now, grieve:
naught can restore,
nothing retrieve
a fallen star.

SIDNEY HUNT

TYPESCRIPT

write with kisses
on the flesh of young sphinxes
soft and occasionally
rough
 hands slip over warm ice
swaying to the hesitating tune
of a thrillme body
 lips in a hurry run
 here and there
fly in noisy bronze to a dream
of sad knees
 polished with
flowers electrically
worked
 rigid
 listen
for death's echo
feel the texture of music
 quicker
slowing to the
comma of
spent
energy

ARTHUR TRUMAN MERRILL

KIRIKI

Indians say that Baja Sierra Madre Mountain
Upthrust from the prickling Caliente Plain
And serrating the floor of the smothering sky
Is the first dying golden eagle's cry
Solidified to stone.
And their ancient shamen say
That on that final judgment day
When the last long-time-alone
Redman shall come to die
Will the old flint-rock mountain
Be resolved again
To a golden eagle's freedom-cry.

RICHARD THOMA

POEM FOR CECILIA

I should like to write you a poem with certain words
like bell and Chartres and magenta—but Alastair says
I am here for the words, not they for me—
so I must wait until they pierce me with their swords
on lonely, greenly magical, moonstone days
and draw, perhaps, from the wounds, brave displays of melody.

Have you ever sat by a fire, watching the flames?
washing your mind in the bright bath of the fire?
Then the words seem to drop away—the poet's lyre
beats madly in the air against closed sesames.

Chartres is such a fire. The rose window soars like a burning heart
and takes away my speech. My thick throat parches in the light
of that great, Gothic splendour—I think of Blake and tigers in the
night
and unknown words I cannot say tear my poor brain apart.

And you are as the flames that burn up all my words—
you are my Chartres—you are that tragic theatre
where poets die in a decor of exploded brains—
while seven ecstatic gramophones play blue refrains—
and there, my secret, sacred words, like burning birds
plunge into the auto-da-fe of your eyes, their dear creator.

DONAL McKENZIE

STOPPED MOMENT

darkly I roam and forever
among your shining moods

delving in mists
of you I gather stars

your words come over slowly
buried under breath

(like splendid nudes
unfolding whitely to the dawn)
your opening unreluctant lips
strike down the frantic flesh
a clanging vortex
of unutterable flame

HAROLD J. SALEMSON

NEW

From an extra-literary point of view, the big year of the eighteenth century was '89. For in '89, the new form of government set in, no more to be dislodged.

Still, the word "révolution," which we are accustomed to link with this date, seems to me the wrong denomination. Overthrowing of a government, yes, but not revolution. A revolution would be such as it was 130 years later in Russia, the replacing of a wornout, out-of-date government, not by its natural successor, but by a more advanced form, perfect in its theories, but for which the mould is not yet ready. In '89, nothing of the sort happened. Corrupted, loathsome monarchy could no longer hope to remain enthroned. The entire eighteenth-century trend of thought and action proved this. One morning the people of Paris replaced it. But this was no revolution, this was evolution. Where monarchy has lived, failed; and died, democracy must naturally step in. And so it did.

However, this is political philosophy. From which I never was more remotely distant in spirit than at the present moment. Just one more word on the subject. No one has yet tried the ridiculous exploit of hooting at the ideas displayed in Plato's *Républic*. This may come. But as yet we have been spared so stupid a sight. Still, there are ideas in this Greek dialog which, if expressed by a contemporary, would appear ludicrous. But could we have expected, even of the most intelligent, advanced, and revolutionary Athenian, that he entertain the idea of abolishing slavery? This is no reproach that we can address the Greeks. It is the result of circumstances which gave them no chance of even conceiving such an idea, let alone believing in it. And it would be just as bad if we were to reproach Danton and Robespierre with not having installed communism. For this reason, I find

(1) A note is impending here upon this word **revolution**, used to right and to left without any definite idea of what it really means. At its origin, the word revolution doubtless meant that a revolution of the orb (cycle) had taken place, that the old order was supplanted by the new, its successor. But through the years the word revolution has come to mean the arbitrary overthrowing of the old idea to replace it by another, whether or not the latter be the natural successor of the first. The real revolutionary order is what I have designated here by the word **evolution**. We might sum it up by saying that the factitious but popular meaning of revolution is **rebellion**; the catholic but archaic meaning, **evolution**. It is in this manner that the words Revolution (rebellion) and Evolution will be opposed in this essay.

HAROLD J. SALEMSON

the Marxists quite wrong in condemning bourgeoisie as such. Whatever they may wish to call it today, I will agree with them. But it is necessary that we realize that the idea of putting the middle-class into power in '89 seemed as outrageous as it does to some for us to wish today to put government in the hands of the proletariat.

I said previously that '89 marked evolution and revolution. The natural new form succeeded the out-of-date existing one.

The same action must take place in the arts. The field is always open for experiment. But we must not confound the two forms of old art: old in age, old in value. Last year's Salon may be out-of-date because of its lack of value. Chances are it will not be much different from what is being done today. But when an old (in age) form of art or literature begins to have little or no more value for us, we must not forget that in its day, it was quite as new as we think we are at present and, for that reason, it remains important.

In politics, one may contend that the **old** form, that which has today no more practical value, is useless, and that our mission is to batter it down. There can be no question as to the truth of such a statement. But even V. F. Calverton, one of America's foremost critics, who has attempted to base literary appreciation almost entirely on a politico-sociological footing, admits that the bourgeoisie novels of the sixteenth century were as astoundingly daring in their day, and therefore remain such, as our first elements of proletarian literature are today.

No one of intelligence will, I believe, demand that the public immediately respond to these drastic experimentations. It is even natural to find distinct animosity among the lay who are called upon to appreciate the new form. Were we able to force this new form upon them, we might call it revolution; but such measures are highly improbable and would be utterly useless. We must therefore resort to the calmer method known as evolution.

The doing-away with an old form arbitrarily is merely a type of dictatorship, a sort of artistic facism. And though such a movement may remain to posterity as an amusing coup-de-main, it means no actual advance in the development of art.

I shall here dare a little classification of the arts, which may help the lucidity of these ideas, if any such be contained herein:

The Cinema;
Architecture;
Literature;
Sculpture;
Painting;
Dancing;
Music.

This arbitrary list (of course, there must be seven), I conceive in the order of "palpability." The cinema is the most tangible of the

arts, a mixture of the ideological implications of literature, the reality of architecture, the rhythmic values of music and dancing. Next we have architecture, devoid perhaps of ideology, but undoubtedly tangible, since it is the art of housing, that art which is the most practical, the most useful and the most earthly.

Literature, though offering a vast field for experiment, maintains a certain inflexibility due to its medium: the word, whose value, having a commercial use, is fixed once and for all.* And, of course, in this line, the phenomenon of Gertrude Stein's work stands out as an apparent denial of the foregoing statement. Look out! That is an error. Miss Stein's art is not literature, or rather not pure literature. It is a decided mixture of literature and music. Miss Stein plays with sound, disregarding the immediate meaning of the verb, thinking only of the musical value of words. It is only in the ultimate significance which issues forth from a Gertrude Stein prose that there can be seen any real literary manifestation. Miss Stein composes; she does not write. And the actual literary importance of her work seems to me doubtful. I said *actual*. In itself her work is not that of a great master, but it eventually gains vast importance through its influence on other writers. For men, and women, who write what might be dry ideology or nude fiction, are seen to alleviate this by a slight musical sense of the word due to their having read Gertrude Stein.

I will not continue demonstrating the classification I made above, for the reader will see the evolution through sculpture, the human form, painting, two-dimensional, dancing, a rhythmic expression devoid of any actual logical form, to music which, needless to say, is pure emotion.

Allow me to bring Miss Stein back into the discussion.

One day Miss Stein appeared on the scene and some discerning minds, though probably not knowing exactly why they did this, heralded her as a genius. Her work was called a revolution. *Que non, que non!*

It would be child's-play to trace Miss Stein's ancestors in literature. We find in all great poets, phrases, words, repetitions, which academic pedants attempt to justify reasonably but which doubtless were often employed merely for their music, their sound-value, and that is a sound value. This tendency is seen to grow as modern times are approached. Romanticism, then free verse, help it, add to it. After Poe and Whitman, after Baudelaire, Rimbaud, Laforgue, what

(2) That the writer is authorized in coining, changing, mingling and combining words, is not deniable. But his new medium, if it is to be the vehicle of a thought, must be identifiable with the existing word-values; these must serve as indices to the author's meaning. If the writing is not a vehicle of idea, the author knows no restriction: he will probably drift into sound and unfortunately produce only a poorer form of music, hopelessly limited by human pronunciation power.

is more natural than that a daring person exploit this movement to its utmost. But that makes no revolution out of this logical descent and ultimate form for which the world, at least the initiates, were ready.

And practically every such seemingly audacious attempt at a new form is merely an evolution of this sort.

If we look into the cinema which, being the most terre-a-terre of arts, although it holds the greatest possibilities, allows these less freely than any of the others, we see another peculiar phenomenon. A certain number of films, from a purely technical viewpoint, stand out as dates in the history of moving-pictures. Since the War, there are roughly *The Cabinet of Dr. Caligari*, *Variety*, *L'Etoile de mer*, and *Lonesome*. (This does not contend to include every great event of the cinema world, but the four films named do carry with them an outline of the motion-picture development.)

Caligari was a revolution. I believe that there had been no art picture previous to this and, although in years to come we may discover a pedigree for it, it seems to have dropped from nowhere. It was a starting-point, the starting-point of what we may call the modern cinema.

Since *Caligari* we have had no new revolution (for the bastard form of the "talkie" can certainly not be considered as an art manifestation). Half-a-dozen or more years after *Caligari*, *Variety* appears. It is called the greatest achievement of the screen, something entirely new. No more fallacious statement was ever mouthed. The only element of *Variety* that had not previously been seen, was the conjunction, the juxtaposition of all preceding cinema developments. New angles, new types of photography had been evolved from the original forms. In one picture, Man Ray developed one conception, interesting but not important enough in itself to constitute a lap in the cinema-construction. Elsewhere another creator perfected another detail, and so on. Then Dupont, who knew all these dispersed efforts, made *Variety*, a date in motion-picture. A date, not because it was an innovation, but because it correlated all the preceding ideas and developments. Dupont felt the mould ready for the "new" form, he felt the need of a summing-up of cinema-evolution and brought to light the point that had been reached. Exactly as in '89 the French Revolution did nothing but sum-up and correlate Voltaire, Rousseau, Beaumarchais, so many similar but detached ideas of the century.

In another field *L'Etoile de mer* accomplished the same thing. Man Ray here brought together the various efforts that had been dispersedly made toward expressing on the motion-picture screen the semi-fantastic world of the subconscious. (I say semi-fantastic here for the same reason that elsewhere I differentiate between evolution and revolution. The entirely fantastic would be an utterly detached interpretation of the subconscious and not the natural type which is

deduced from conscious reality.) Still, this is no denigration of the value of Man Ray's film. I have previously lauded it sufficiently. Summing-up is often taken for innovating, and it has as much, if not even more, importance than innovation.

Paul Fejos' production *Lonesome* did last year what *Variety* had done in the past. It combined all the intervening discoveries and perfectings and added to these a greater nudity and simplicity than had yet been seen, resulting in a final coherence which puts all previous achievements out-of-date. In this addition of simplification and sobriety, *Lonesome* derives directly from Dupont's film.

This digression upon the cinema can serve as a basis for extending the same reasoning to the other arts. Referring back to the tentative classification made earlier in this essay, we will see that the cinema comes first. It gives the least field for arbitrariness in experimentation. Then comes architecture. Unless it is to be dilettantism, an architectural achievement must conform to certain requirements, the main one being its practicality. And, since the architect is dealing with matter and not idea, there is a certain respect of equilibrium which must be maintained.

As for literature, I believe I have sufficiently gone into the possibilities and consequences of experimentation in it. But here we find the lack of restraint and the conception of a fantastic real-irreality beginning to creep in. Sculpture still has some check of the human form felt in its execution, but as soon as we strike painting, there seems to be no more actual control exerted. Here the artist—for it is understood that the reproduction of everyday reality, much more successfully achieved by photography, is to be left to that somewhat mechanical art—here, I say, the artist has free sway over the ingredients of plausibility and imaginative irreality to be injected into his production. He may go headlong into a dream-state and allow his fantasy to be unimpeded. And if he disregards the criticism of those who have not yet heard of the existence of photography, he will be no worse off, and will have achieved as great a result, plausible or not.

Dancing, except for the slight limit of human gesture, motion and rhythm, is handicapped by no catering. And music has absolutely no bounds that it cannot exceed. Pure emotion is as entirely personal matter, the affair of the artist, even if he be attempting to portray mobs in action—collectivity, and I will concede no restraint as permissible to be imposed upon the musical creator.

Whether or not the artists in these various branches ever actually innovate is another matter. It is undoubtedly a thing for personal opinion to some extent, but I do not believe it an entirely individual decision. There are precedents which must not be disregarded and, however pedant they be, historians of the arts are sometimes a help in ascertaining such opinions. That one may be sceptical as to the importance of discerning whether or not a creator actually innovates, I readily admit.

Poor, conservative workmen in every field persist in producing useless out-of-date realizations and, though they are despicable, one bit of thanks is due them. They entertain the crying need for something more advanced and avoid progressiveminded men the trouble of demonstrating the emptiness of the space that they are attempting to fill.

These progressive artists, however, rarely conceive ideas which cannot be traced to precedents. Why should they? When so much has already been done in one direction, why not persevere, in adding that which conditions before our time did not permit conceiving? The man who finds something new is much more rare than we suspect. The innovator is a museum specimen, of which the world is lucky to have one in each epoch (unless we are to argue that an epoch is determined by this very innovator).

But experience must be digested. This is not a matter of choice, it is an ineluctable fact. All education tends toward such a goal. There is a difference between digesting and going beyond, and digesting and standing pat.

If this be reaction, I am afraid I will have to quit the revolutionary camp.

RICHARD JOHNS

SORRY LADY

In the stiff magnificence of death
You lie revealed.
Those eager fingers, light in daring,
Lie like helpless facts
Upon the shroud.

The countenance:
It is the sum of all you dared to dream
Yet never dared to live.
Your mouth, in sorry smile,
Reveals the truth;
The face, in whole, is merely that
Of a simple woman,
Dead in peace.

If you but knew your utter candor now!

MIRIAM ALLEN deFORD

ESCAPE

The imperceptible fingering of time,
With silvery pencil tracing its iron nets,
Has frosted the world. But still the proud sun sets
In fire-eaten clouds over a hidden water;
And still the fragile-petalled roses climb
Age-tempered dwellings; and the night-winds utter
Around them sighings like the vanished chime
Of muted bells on ruined parapets.

On such a haunted evening came a bird
That sang in darkness near a hillbound pool,
All wood-enclosed: the heart played its own fool
To listen to such music in the quiet;
It was as if the winds grew hushed that heard
The mounting melody: another by it
Took up its note; the rose-fragrant night was stirred
By sweetness, as the summer air fell cool.

And till night dimmed, under the soundless moon
That music thrilled, erasing the bonds of time.
The clenching years melted their ancient rime;
Youth that had been made of roses and of singing
Came back with all its dreams at their high noon
Of unfulfillment. The past released its clinging;
There were no memories but of rising June,
Of days for ever arrested at their prime.

Forgotten visions crowded that still air;
Forgotten pulses, beating like a drum,
Urged to old passions hearts long since grown numb.
Wistful the breeze arose: a joyous sorrow,
Sweet-bitter, warned the listener to prepare
For fading of this beauty in a morrow
Accustomed and accursed. All life cried there:
Bird! Sing for ever, lest the morning come!

JACK CONROY

DUSKY ANSWER

"Black boy," I said to him, "why do you niggers
Come all the way from Georgia, take us white men's jobs,
Work for less pay, and stand the gaff they give you?"

It was cold standing in the line that morning;
Stamping feet rang on the iron ground, and the jobless
Shivered like hairless hounds, waiting for the gates to open.

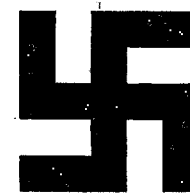
He only glanced out of the tail of his chalk-eye,
Looked at the hole in his worn shoe and snuffled,
Pocketed his bare hands and give this damn fool answer:

"Boss, I know a swamp in Georgia
Where fireflies glimmer thru the trees at dusk—
Not like these 'lectric lights that shine so cold and hard.
And steamboats whistle down bayous in Georgia,
But soft and low—not like these screamin' sirens
That gimlet in your brain.

Woodpeckers drum on hollow trees in Georgia,
But they don't jar like these air hammers
That 'rat-tat' on your mind.

Boss, I got a wife and kids in Georgia;
I miss them all the time like no one knows!"
Something in the droop of his thick blue lip,
Something in the glint of his chalk-eye,
Give me the answer better than his damn fool words:

Something must be rotten down in Georgia!



PAGANY

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BOOKS

REVOLT

be still, by William Closson Emory.
The Lotus Press. Detroit. Unrest,
the Rebel Poets' Anthology for 1929,
Arthur Stockwell, Ltd. London.

be still reveals a fine lean ironic mind
with an aptitude for fine chiselled
phrases and mild sardonic laughter.
The title poem, be still, is excellently
done, as good as anything turned out
in these states during the last five
lean years. CABARET, HOLD THE
THOUGHT, THE MARK OF CAIN,
THEME FOR A BLUES SONG, and
that dearborn independent, more than
compensate for the remaining ple-
thora of handclasps: arty ring-around-
the-rosie stuff, weighed down with
adjectives, gaudy images, and the
Baudlerian word.

UNREST as an attempt to anthologize
the poetry of revolt, is more than
passably successful. The vast horde
of american "little" poets still
warble sweetly of roses, divinely
blind to the incongruity of it, while
factories belch smoke and suffocate
all roses, and in North Carolina
awakened slaves are shot down cal-
lously, beaten, and jailed; and the
frame-up of labor organizers, which
crucified Sacco and Vanzetti, still
flourishes rankly on the dungpiles of
our civilization. In this they are ably
abetted by the bourgeoisie magazines,
and "critics," thus perpetuating an
anemic tradition that is in itself evi-
dence of sterility. The mass of ameri-
can poetry is decades behind the
times. There is a militant minority
that, however confused it may yet be,
shows vitality, and which itself
branches into two wings: the meta-
physical and anarchist, yet vaguely
important, group, ably represented
by BLUES; and the earthly chal-
lenging handful voiced by NEW
MASSES. UNREST is primarily con-
cerned with revolt against capital-
ism—and as such, does deal lustily and
significant blows. Among others,
Spector, Macleod, Cheyney, Gold,
Rorty, Clements, Moyer, Conroy, Por-
ter, Waters, and Musser contribute
significant and excellent poems.

Joseph Kalar

TWO IMPORTANT BOOKS

Laughing Boy by Oliver La Farge.
(Houghton Mifflin Co. Boston.
\$2.50).

Anthology of Revolutionary Poetry
edited by Marcus Graham. (Graham.
Box 3, West Farms Station, New
York, N. Y. \$3.00).

It was Laughing Boy riding from T'o
Tlakai to Tse Lani, and there that
he met his fate in the person of Slim
Girl, a beautiful Navajo maiden. In
spite of precedent, tribal disfavor
and the wrath of his uncle, he mar-
ries Slim Girl and they both leave
the Navajo country to live on the
edge of civilization where Slim Girl
enjoys a mysterious income. For
almost two years they live in a bliss-
ful state of happiness that is almost
ethereal, unreal. He plies his trade
as silversmith, and she learns at last
the difficult art of rug-weaving.
They become comparatively rich and
plan soon to pick up their hard-
earned possessions and leave for the
north country to live in seclusion,
unhampered by white men and all
that their civilization means. Then,
inadvertently, Laughing Boy learns
how Slim Girl earns her living . . .
Slayer of Enemy Gods she had
called him, and he also dispersed the
clouds of impending disaster that
had always hovered above them.
Once again they plan to leave for the
north country, and actually start.
But it all avails for nothing.

All through the book the materials
and psychology are entirely Navajo.
Only a supreme artist could have
written this book, and one who was
thoroughly familiar with his material.
The words, the poetry, the ritual, the
actions are all Navajo. And "in
beauty it is ended." The death
scene will be remembered, once read,
as long as any scene in contemporary
literature. Until you rise with
Laughing Boy to the peace of soul-
satisfying philosophy that is the In-
dian at the end of the book, all is the
suspense of living with him a living
Navajo tragedy: one that will always
remain with you and temper your
reaction to the Indians of the old
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hensive collection of significant poetry of revolutionaries that has ever appeared. Marcus Graham has done a monumental piece of work in this, the result of ten years work in many countries. Nearly all the poems are selected judiciously and the lovers of injustice and the censors that is Boston (or nearly so), may well quail remembering Sacco and Vanzetti. This is such a book as reactionaries may well tremble over. It speaks of justice and anarchy, pacifism and war. It is a clenched fist to strike through the veil of lies and hypocrisies that has settled like a pall upon America, the once land of the free and the home of the brave. This book should convince a vacillating public that we still have brave men who do not cringe before an existing order, though most of them be between the covers of a book.

Norman Macleod

CHIAROSCURO IN PROSE AND POETRY

Children of Fire and Shadow by Lucia Trent. (Robert Packard and Co. Chicago).

Thirteen Days by Jeanette Marks. (Albert and Charles Boni. New York).

Bow of Burning Gold by E. Merrill Root. (Robert Packard and Co. Chicago. \$2.00).

Lucia Trent is doing in this country in a lesser degree what D. H. Lawrence is doing in England: extolling the animal, the human passions of man in a fast decaying society where all is on a mental level and one deranged at that. (Lawrence maintains that only with a harmonious balance of the two sides of man will we avoid ultimate destruction.) These poems in *Children of Fire and Shadow* are frank and beautiful. An outspoken affirmation of love and life.

E. Merrill Root is probably one of the best poets striving to work order out of chaos and beauty from stone and steel. Extremely conscious of the inherent conflicts of stone and sinew, he attempts to find some workable solution for the tangled mess of life in America that is suffocating men to reproduce automatons. "Son of Columbus" is one of the best poems

in the book. I quote from it:
"At last America is won. And
I, what shall I do?—
Who have no Indies now to
seek—yet am Columbus too?"

"I am the child of such as
they; I too am pioneer:
Columbus with no ocean, Boone
with no wild frontier!"

It is of these that he speaks.

Thirteen Days is another of the countless indictments of Massachusetts for the murder of Sacco and Vanzetti: an authentic and pathetic story of the last thirteen days of these two persecuted proletarians whose lives were taken that the world might be made safe for war. All three of these books reviewed above indicate the literature of the future: revolutionary affirmation as contrasted to weak and futile despair.

Norman Macleod

MAD QUEENS IN TRANSIT TRANSIT OF VENUS,

THE MAD QUEEN, both by Harry Crosby. (The Black Sun Press, Editions Narcisse, Paris.)

The Paris expatriates are the envy and despair of the synthetic Bohemians who seek solace from the sordid, workaday world in the picturesque purloins of Greenwich Village—in its rathskellars and attic studios. The

expatriates actually live as the Villagers try to imagine themselves living. Sometimes we darkly suspect the expatriates of affecting billiard-green trousers, like Ezra Pound, or resorting to Windsor ties and long hair; but they are intriguing, nonetheless, and much more interesting than a Village poet who by day is none other than Herman Blotz, an efficient haberdashery clerk.

These two volumes, written by an associate editor of "transition," will serve as a praiseworthy purpose in irritating practical persons who demand "poetry with sense to it—poetry we can understand." "Real folks" will do "a heap o' livin'" before they discover anything intelligible in Crosby's poems; but radicals will applaud "I Curse You, Boston," which is a masterpiece of lyrical vituperation. Whether this jeremiad was inspired by the murder of Sacco and Vanzetti or by the pathetic spectacle of Mencken selling a copy of the "Hatrack" American Mercury on the Boston Commons with the gendarmarie lurking in the shadows, it is richly deserved.

Crosby is a passionate sun-worshipper. The kleigs of the sun emblazon "The Mad Queen" and glow with a softer radiance on "Transit of Venus." Crosby is a Cummings with a deeper gift of music.

Jack Conroy.

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NOTES

HARRY CROSBY, a contributing editor of *The Morada* and an American expatriate living in Paris, committed suicide in New York City on the tenth of December. In his memory we have named this issue the *Harry Crosby Number*. We are publishing a tirade, a poem (both unpublished up until now), reprinting *Sun-Death* from his most recent book (*Mad Queen*, Black Sun Press, Paris) and incorporating a review of his two most recent books. A short article concerning Crosby and his work will be found elsewhere in this same number.

JOSEPH KALAR is a contributing editor of *New Masses* and *The Morada*. He is a young lumberjack who lives in Minnesota.

PAULINE LEADER has published in *Poetry*, *transition*, *Blues*, and *The Survey*. She lives in New York City.

FREDERIC COVER has written some excellent poetry which has appeared in *New Masses* from time to time.

SOLOMON R. BARBER was born in a Utah small town and has lived variously in Mexico City, New York, New Orleans, Havana, Nueva Gerona, Washington, and in Utah and Wyoming. He is editor of *Janus*.

JOSEPH VOGEL has contributed to the last two *American Caravans*, *This Quarter*, *New Masses*, *American Speech*, *Blues* and other periodicals. He has written several novels.

RICHARD THOMA is a young poet who lives in Paris. He has appeared in *Tambour*, *Blues* and other advance guard periodicals.

MIRIAM ALLEN DE FORD has contributed to *Poetry*, *Masses*, *New Masses*, *Nation*, *New Republic* and *Forum*. She is Federated Press correspondent for northern California.

CHARLES YALE HARRISON enlisted in the Canadian Expeditionary Forces when he was eighteen years old, took part in intense fighting in Northern France and Belgium, wounded and gassed, and returned from the war, he did newspaper work, feature writing, short stories, publicity. In a *Dug-Out* is taken from a novel (soon to be published) parts of which have been published in England, Sweden, Germany, Austria, Russia and elsewhere. He has contributed to *Workers Life*, *Rothe Fahne* and is a contributing editor of *New Masses*.

JACK CONROY was the first to introduce Harry Crosby's work to the American magazines. He contributes a review of Crosby's work to the present issue. He has published in *La Revue de L'Univers*, *Poetry* and the *Play*, *New Masses* and others. He is one of the editors of *Unrest*.

NORMAN MACLEOD has recently contributed to *transition* (19), *Pagany*, *Southwest Review* and *Folk Say: A Regional Miscellany*.

GEORGE JARBOE is the pseudonym of a young Irish lawyer.

SIDNEY HUNT, the editor of *Ray* in London, has contributed to *Der Sturm*, *Tambour*, *New Age*, *transition* and others.

A. T. MERRILL is a southern Californian.

GEORGE ST. CLAIR, A.B., M.A., Ph.D., has spent nineteen years in educational work in the Philippine Islands. Wrote, produced and published several plays. Published a verse translation of a Filipino epic poem. Studied in Paris and in Madrid. Professor of English and Head of the Department of English at the University of New Mexico. He is one of the editors of *The Morada* and Director of the University Dramatic Club.

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"Hermits, rebels, ascetics, prophets, forsakers of the world, neither possessed nor possessing:

These I call, for only these shall live and carry on the dance.

"This, then, is your poem. Take it and use it.

Would you have me rescue myself or you with a rhyme, or pour the cup of salvation in a phrase?

Go elsewhere, then; this is not for you."

—James Rorty in *UNREST*.

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GEORGE ST. CLAIR

THE GREATER LOVE

The Major was unusually talkative that evening. A stout, florid-faced, distinguished-looking old man, with abundant, iron-grey hair, he carried his sixty-five years with a sort of jaunty ease that made us younger men look old beside him. Never a taciturn man, on this evening in question speech seemed to well up from him ceaselessly, as does a great spring in a thirsty land.

It was a dead, sultry night, the kind which uninformed people think is the usual thing in Manila. Those who have lived, however, in both this city and in New York, will tell you that sleep is much more quickly wooed on a summer night in the "Pearl of the Orient" than it is in our own steaming metropolis. But this evening the heat was overpowering. Sticky, clammy heat. Wringing, steamy heat that makes even the seasoned Manilan spend his leisure moments languidly damning his *mucha-cho* for not having more cold *cerveza* in the ice box. Conversation was too much like exercise. It both tired and bored one.

The heat, tho, did not seem to affect the Major, for he was at his best, his silvery tongue being well oiled by my Canadian Club, and gently loosened by generous draughts of the famed *Doble Bock* brand of *cerveza*. Nothing came amiss to him that night—passionate denunciations of the "damned Filipinos" (the Major still retained the old army attitude towards the natives); enthusiastic encomiums upon his latest mine, for the Major was an incorrigible prospector (I must be guilty of *tautology* here, since mortal man has never beheld a pessimistic prospector); prophecies of the wonderful future of the Islands if the "damned natives" would just let the Americans manage things for them; scurrilous jests and Boccaccian tales, punctuated and seasoned by an ear-filling profanity—all flowed from him in an endless stream of talk.

Every moment the heat became more oppressive. There was even something ominous about it. Evidently it preluded a storm. Under its influence, coupled

with that of the rare, mellow old whisky, the Major ceased his denunciations and began to reminisce in gentler tones. I feel impelled to interject here the observation, news to some, perhaps, that Manila is the only place under the American flag where one may obtain a constitutional drink. As yet the bootlegger has not crept into that paradise. Happily there is no need of him yet.

"Do you remember," the Major asked me after a somewhat long pause, "that — — typhoon that hit the southern islands in 1904, when the *Leyte* went down with all on board?"

I remembered it well.

"Did I ever tell you of my experience in that cursed *baguio*?"

Now, strangely enough, the Major had never mentioned any such experience to me, a singular circumstance, for I had thought I knew most of his stories almost by heart. Not that he ever told them twice in the same way! No! The Major possessed an infinite variety in this respect.

I must stop here to tell one of his most oft-told tales, because it helps us to understand what kind of man the Major was. It concerned a certain brush of his, during those much-talked-of "Days of the Empire," with a band of *insurrectos*. It was a vivid picture as the Major painted it. A revolver missing fire, a gigantic *boloman* brandishing his murderous blade, the Major sprinting for his life with his coat tails flying in the breeze, and then, just as he could already feel that keen knife sinking in his quivering vitals, a shot from one of his own men, sending the "damned *gugu*" toppling over. A great race. The Major was one of those brave soldiers who are not afraid to confess to fear.

As the Major's stories were always worth listening to, much as one might doubt their absolute truth, I assured him I had never heard this particular tale, idly wondering at the same time why he had kept silence so long about any experience of his. He answered my unspoken query.

"Somehow, I have never been in just the right mood for telling this story. Perhaps because it is one of my most bitter memories. But tonight—and this queer weather brings it all back so vividly. Maybe I ought to have told it before. I guess I've wronged my friend

by keeping silent so long. A damned good friend of mine he was! Say, my throat feels mighty dry. Where the devil is that lazy boy?"

After considerable difficulty, I managed to wake up my sleepy-eyed muchacho long enough to make him open a bottle of *Doble Bock*. Thus fortified, and with a cigar to chew on, the Major began his story. The story will lose by the necessity for blue-penciling the Major's most striking expressions, but, what would you? Art and Life are frequently at variance, in spite of what the expressionists do to the former.

"Well," the Major began, "it was like this. You know that dirty, God-forsaken little fishing village at the mouth of the Bicol river, down in Camarines? Uh—what's its name? Oh, never mind beating your brains over it. The name don't mean anything."

"Three of us started from there one afternoon to go to Daet, over in Camarines Norte. I mean three Americans, because there were six Filipinos, too, our boatmen. One of the other Americans was an engineer in the Bureau of Lands. He was a big, blond giant. We had knocked around a lot together and had become fast friends. I'll bet there's a special heaven for fellows like him. There must be."

"The other one was a little fellow who had come out as a teacher in the Bureau of Education. Say, I don't want to say anything against teachers, because I know you are one yourself, but this fellow was certainly a specimen. He had quit the Bureau, or been fired, I shouldn't wonder, and had turned to itinerant missionarying. You know I haven't anything special against missionaries over here, but I'm not fond of 'em, and I don't think they've got much business monkeying with these people. They better go back to Chicago or New York where they're badly needed. Anyhow, this fellow wasn't very attractive personally. A queer, stunted, dried-up little man he was, with a cold in his head that kept him always sniffing and blowing his nose. Not the kind of fellow you'd pick out for a traveling companion, even if you were hiking alone, and I wasn't, because my friend William was going along with me."

"The sky looked pretty bad, and a rather stiff wind was blowing, but the piloto thought it would be safe enough, and we had to go, anyway. I mean Williams and I had to go. Why the little missionary was going we never cared to ask. He had just sort of attached himself to us. So, with the Filipino sailors carrying our bags, we set off for the boat."

"You've been a supervising teacher, so you know all about those native barotos, with the bamboo outriggers on the sides. You know they're not at all comfortable to sit in, even in the smoothest sea. The missionary—his name was Jones—had a hard time getting himself settled comfortably. He fidgetted around until he almost upset us a couple of times. Williams then cussed him out good and hard, and after that he was quiet."

The Major paused reflectively at this point, and absent-mindedly took a fresh cigar. As he didn't go on at once with his story, but look around as if he were hunting something, I suggested a bottle of *Doble Bock*. The muchacho was more sullen than ever, but was finally persuaded to come to the Major's rescue, tho not without something more than moral suasion.

"Things went along all right for a couple of hours. Then the wind, which had been a favor, suddenly turned and began blowing dead against us. We beat about, tacking back and forth till nearly nightfall, but got nowhere. In vain the piloto swore, and the sailors called on their favorite santos. We had finally to give it up and run for the nearest land. This happened to be a little island, which we reached about an hour after dark."

"There were perhaps a dozen houses on it, fishermen's shacks. You know the kind I mean, those little bamboo huts, roofed with nipa palm leaves. The piloto took us to the largest and best of these. It was a one-roomed affair, with a dirt floor. No furniture in it, except a long, wooden table, and a few dilapidated bamboo chairs."

"What are we going to do for chow?" I asked the piloto. You see we had expected to get to Daet that first day and so had not taken any food along."

"*'Yo tiene, cuidao,'* he said. And cuidao he did, for soon our host's old wife brought in dinner. That is, if you want to call it that. Boiled rice in a huge plato, not a thing more. We all sat around in a circle on the floor, and dipped our fingers into the rice. Fingers had to serve us as forks too."

"That meal was not particularly lively. The little missionary seemed to find his rice especially hard to down, and Williams had a lot of fun at his expense. It ended in his getting pretty sore, but Williams didn't mind that. He was a rough sort of a cuss anyway."

"After we had finished our one-course meal, the piloto came up to me."

"*'Señor, los hombres quien jugar monte.'*"

"Monte! How the devil can we play monte? We haven't any money and no cards either."

"*'Yo tiene cuidao, señor.'* So he dug up a greasy old pack of Spanish cards, and then said he would lend me the money if I would be *banquero*. I think he had an idea the Americans would be easy pickings. Of course I didn't like the idea of playing on money borrowed from a Filipino, but we had a long evening before us with nothing to do, and Williams kept urging me on, and so I finally consented. Jones tried to argue us out of the notion. Got very insistent about it too, but as we just laughed at him, he finally got disgusted at us and went off and lay down on the floor in one corner of the room. I guess he put in a lot of time praying for us."

"The game began with me as banker and dealer. It would take a Rembrandt to describe that scene with his brush. There was Williams and me stripped to our undershirts and pants; the Filipinos grouped around the rickety table, the men grave and impassive at first, the women rather anxious looking, and much more voluble; and, at one end of the table, a small coconut oil lamp, our only light. This threw into sharp relief the faces of the players, but left the greater part of the room in darkness, with strange, eerie shadows flickering in its dim corners. And in one of those corners the little missionary tossed about, doubtless trying to subdue his irritation by praying for us. But I can't paint or describe either.

You'll just have to use your imagination."

"As the game proceeded, while the night wore on, the players lost most of their gravity and impassivity, so there resulted a strange melange of guttural oaths, exclamations of delight or anger, and prayers to the santos."

"The sums bet were small, but their loss meant a lot to those poor islanders. Williams and the piloto played about even, but the rest of them lost steadily. As for me, it looked like I just couldn't lose that night. Little by little the silver came my way, until, when dawn broke, I had corralled all the money on the island. Oh, you mustn't think I had suddenly become rich. The entire amount those islanders had been able to scrape together was just fifteen pesos. Think of it. The whole wealth of an island!"

"But I didn't get away with it. I don't mean that they took it away from us, or anything of that sort, tho they might easily have done so. But they got it back, as you'll soon see."

"With the first faint streaks of dawn, we broke up the game. The sky was heavily overcast, and the wind was still blowing hard, but it had changed direction, so the piloto thought we could make it. And so, after a very distasteful breakfast of cold boiled rice, we started for our boat."

"Then it was that the islanders got back their own. When we got outside the house, we found all the women and children gathered together. Surrounding us, they began begging for an *'aguinaldo.'* And to satisfy them I had to disburse every cent I had won. Not bad for simple, unspoiled islanders, eh?"

The recalling of this long-gone-by episode amused the Major immensely. It seemed to remind him that he was thirsty, so another bottle of the *Doble Bock* had to be brought to him before he would proceed with his tale.

"Well," he finally continued, "we got started at last. Nobody was in a very pleasant mood, the missionary being especially glum and silent. Williams didn't improve matters any by making fun of him. It just seems like those two couldn't get on together at all. A matter of fundamental unlikeness, I guess, and then Williams made it so

plain that he didn't like him. Not at all a lively bunch."

"Then the weather didn't help out any. The wind had stirred up the waves, and when we got outside the shelter of the island we began to get their full force. Right away a couple of the sailors had to start in bailing. You remember how close to the water one is in those little barotos, and how big the waves look when one gazes up at them from the bottom of a small boat. You know there is nothing at all reassuring about them. They assume too much of the proportions of a mountain to be pleasant."

"But things went along fairly well, altho the wind was increasing in force, until about noon. I had noticed that the piloto kept casting uneasy glances at the sky, but he didn't say anything about changing our course, and so I just sat quiet."

"Then it came. With a terrifying howl, the sudden full force of the bagulo hit us. I don't understand yet what prevented us all from being swept into the sea. Two of the sailors were hurled into that raging caldron. They disappeared at once. The mere wisp of a sail we had been carrying and the masts too went like a shot. Great mountains of water poured over us, filling our boat completely. Only our outriggers prevented us from sinking at once."

"So there we were, three Americans and four Filipinos, with nothing between us and death by drowning except a boat full of water and a few bamboo poles which showed signs every minute of being torn from their fastenings by the force of the tremendous waves. That would have meant adios for us, of course."

"We took it in different ways. Williams tried to joke, the little missionary prayed aloud, regardless of anything else, the sailors kept calling on all the santos they knew. As for me, I was scared stiff, but a white skin obliges, you know, and then I had to pretend to be brave and fairly unconcerned so as to keep up the spirits of our sailors."

"I suppose it was a couple of hours we drifted along in this way, with the waves getting ever higher and higher, and the wind increasing in intensity.

It must have been about three o'clock when the outriggers on one side were torn off. Three of the sailors managed to get around to our side, but the fourth one would have drowned but for Williams, who swam over and hauled him over to where the rest of us were miserably hanging on. It was cold too. Ugh. I need a little of that Canadian Club to warm me up. Thanks."

"With the added weight of the sailors pulling us down, we kept sinking lower and lower, until only our faces were above the surface. Jones and the sailors had to quit praying aloud, and even Williams seemed to run out of jokes. We all felt that our end was near. In fact, one of the sailors went soon. He just sank without a word. Shortly afterwards, two more slipped off, leaving only the piloto and us three white men. We didn't have anything to say about their going. We just held on and waited for our turn."

"I suppose this would be the time in the story books for a ship to heave in sight. Well, no ship came our way, wouldn't have seen us if it had, but we did find help of a sort. You've seen those bamboo traps the Filipino fishermen make to catch fish. You know they're a sort of circular fence tied to great big bamboo poles driven down into the bottom of the sea. Well, in our drifting, our water-logged boat struck against one of these. It was a precarious enough refuge, heaven knows, but it was better than our baroto, which threatened to sink at any moment. So each of us desperately caught hold of a post, and there we swung, swaying back and forth with the waves."

"To make things worse, night had fallen. I have no idea how long we stayed there. But even this refuge began to fail us. By the little glimmer of light we had we could see the trap slowly going to pieces before our eyes. Dawn found only the posts left, and it was but a matter of moments till these too were wrenched loose. We were now truly adrift."

"I had been noticing for some time that the missionary's strength seemed to be leaving him, but I was too weak myself to give him any help. But here Williams did a most unexpected thing. Remember he heartily disliked the fellow, evidently despised him, you'd say.

How do you account then for what he did? I don't know. Williams seemed at times to act on impulses that many so-called better men would never even have thought of. As we started on our drifting voyage, he swam over to Jones and tied him to his bamboo poles with pieces of rattan that were floating around. He insisted too that the piloto and I do the same thing. He wouldn't tie himself on tho."

"Much of the next few hours remains a blank to me. I must have fallen into a sort of stupor, for, at the end of what seemed ages, I was aroused by a shout from Williams."

"Hey, Major! Jones! Look! There's land!"

"The wind and waves together had carried us close to shore."

"You fellows cut loose," Williams shouted to us. It's only a few yards to shore, and you can make it."

"The piloto and I, who were closer than the other two, cut loose from our bamboos, and commending ourselves to God, started in. The distance couldn't have been much more than ten yards, but God alone knows how we made it. Completely exhausted, we finally managed to stagger out of reach of the waves, and there we lay, helpless to do anything except to watch the end of our drama."

"While we were getting in to shore, Williams had left his bamboo and swum over to the missionary. It must have been evident to him that Jones didn't have strength enough left to swim, for he started swimming in, pushing him and his bamboo in ahead of him. You can imagine the tax on his strength."

"When I first caught sight of them, they must have been only five or six yards from the shore, really shallow water but for the tremendous waves. They were barely moving. I watched them with my heart in my mouth, and I don't mind admitting I tried to say a prayer for Williams. I saw him untie Jones, give him a strong shove, and then strike out for land himself. I guess he must have figured they were close enough for the little fellow to swim in, and besides he probably felt he didn't have sufficient strength left to keep on shoving him in."

"I was more interested in Williams than in Jones, and so I watched him only at first. I saw him climb feebly out of the water, stagger beyond the

reach of the waves, and then collapse on the sand, all in. He lay on his face on the sand. I have no doubt he said a prayer of thanksgiving for himself as he lay there."

"But almost immediately there came a cry from Jones. Only a couple of yards from shore and the damned little fool was sinking."

"The piloto lay there dead to the world, and as for me, I couldn't have stirred to save my soul. All I could think of was what rotten luck it was to drown so close to land. He was a dead man so far as I was concerned."

"But there was still Williams. That feeble sound, so much like a baby crying to its mother, aroused him. Laboriously he turned over and gazed out to sea. The missionary was just coming up the first time."

"You poor—g-d damned little fool!" Williams yelled to him. 'Hold on! I'm coming.'"

"With what I could see was a superhuman effort, he rushed down to the water, pushed Jones ahead of him, picked him up in his arms, and dragged him, or rather, threw him, to a place of safety. Then, as he started in himself, he fell. The effort had been too much for him. But he still kept crawling in on his hands and knees. 'Thank God! He's safe now,' I heard myself saying. But I spoke too soon. A huge wave came sweeping up the beach, enveloped him in its depths, and, when it receded, carried his body with it."

"I don't want my worst enemy ever to experience what I felt as I lay there and watched my friend drown, helpless to do anything. What's that in the Bible about a man laying down his life for his friend? Well, what about dying to save a man you despise? 'Greater love hath no man than this!'"

The Major's emotion was so evident as he sat there thinking of this hero-friend of his, that I did not venture for some time to ask him what had become of the missionary. But my curiosity was so great that I finally had to put the question.

"What became of him?" he yelled. "Hell! how do I know? And what's more, I don't give a damn! It's of my friend I'm thinking, and of how he died to save a-a-damned insect. This rotten cigar of yours makes my eyes water. Give me a drink. I need it."

MICHAEL MAAS

IMPOSSIBLE DREAM AT NOON DAY

Wheels of traffic cry
here in this stiff garden of tall buildings
tapering stone and iron in airy depths,

black oiled machinery turns with precise madness—

we are lost,
moving mechanical brothers,
moving in oiled unison.

Imagine if you can,
if you dare,
perfectly well-oiled automatons,

ah imagine, some hot blue noon,
the blatant awakening of our static hearts,

if one pale fern frond,
reflecting its image down through glare of light
should spawn in the sterile sponge of the brain.

RICHARD JOHNS

UNDER A TREE

"Why do you linger?" they ask me,
And what can I answer?
There is nothing left to say,
And I must go.

For days, under this tree,
We have rested;
Discussed all living quietly,
And sought out love.

There has been little ease.
We watched the others
Hastening hurriedly past
On quaint adventure.
A place among the runners
That is life:
And not such little moments
Under a tree.

B. A. BOTKIN

FRONTIER

From the wind-warped trees of mothers
Grow tall and straight
The dreaming sons and daughters
Who were born too late

To tame the land or make broken
Bodies whole
But will give to the land and the mothers
Song and a soul.

SLEEP LIKE A WOMAN

Sleep like a woman, breast and thigh,
clings to the sleeper pillowed on
her bosom; melting, he is drawn
down to her softness, cradled by
her body till she breathes through him,
kissing his eyes till they grow dim.

SHERRY MANGAN

OLIVE (SPRING BEING ALL OF A SUDDEN)

Established but of this twilight recognized not wearily
and so serenely spring again returns
beautiful so beautifully unembarrassed
by all the ways we take her name in vain

so spring surprisingly returns again
(and with it loving?) some any twilight now
and so and with it loving (love or lovers
I suppose it's quite the same to spring)

But to me how wholly different and frequently new—
no more lovers but with this new spring newly love
and at last love and loved love
and spring indifferently blessing all

why these days are halcyon

DONAL McKENZIE

ANDANTE CANTABILE Op. 11

Tschaikowsky
you have
bitten into a bitter
tune
The
hopeless
progressions
obstinately

unadvancing
tell me
love is a
flame of re-
flexive fear
And
altho
you play life
to the tune of

cowardice

and sigh into death
the

ultimate

major

i'll bet you

died

hard

RICHARD MILLER

THE MOVING DAY

Grey
thrashing of it

THE MORADA

the moving day
it sweeps with me
it sweeps with me
am i not moving
hurt of all that holds me down
ties me down
to the ache
of shutters
of sad windows
flyfly
flyfly
othegraymovingday,
like wild geese
like wild geese

CLIFFORD GESSLER

"E MAU OHIPA NEHENEHE ANA'E TA TANE I RAVE"

"All the works of Kané are beautiful:"
shall man therefore despise any gift of the gods?
Is it not spoken that even the lizard and the wood bee,
the centipede and the various lowly beetles
shall dwell in the shining presence of Wakea
equally with the swallow that soars into the sky
in the calm that follows the falling of the rain?

It was known to the wise men who made the ancient chants
that the union of flesh is a clean and a beautiful thing:
let it be known to us also.

The conversation of the mind is a rare fragrance;
the communion of the spirit is a gift that comes to but two
here and two there, out of thousands,

How can it be attained without the meeting
of minds, without the intimate touching of bodies?
The road to the Living Water is a secret road,
not to be found by all those who go seeking.
Will the gates of the mind open upon it?
Can it be entered save through the bright gates of flesh?

Perhaps we shall never breathe together the fragrance
of the hala tree that blooms in the garden of Kané,
yet believe me when I repeat the old, old saying
that all the works of Kané are beautiful.

I shall wait for you in the shadow of the hau tree
that stands at the gate of heaven.

RICHARD JOHNS

WITH ALL TO DO

Withdrawn from thunder,
Clear and cool in passion,
Silently he waged his right
Against the world.

(there is one who may draw the simplest people
into calm conditionings of love and hate)

Preferring thus, he lived his tale,
And when at last the night
Spent wearily her dark,
(the turning of a leaf)
The sheaf of papers sounded
Resonant with truth,
For him alone.

DAVID CORNEL DeJONG

DIRGE IN A COLD RAIN

Look on the inward rustle of leaves
that mat the grey bones and
carry them soilward in a tan cortege
while the sinews stamp and
the after-breath snorts in the brain
and the flaked thought-gusts ooze through
each crevice and melt in the fetid heat
that drones through the limbs and laces
the thighs, and see where on catfeet
the things recalled tread on dust
as on scarlet flames and the head
rolls with a thunder in bazan and hands
twine together and cup to a lake
wherein the whole is drowned and
the lips slake the last of wet
before a flat parched hell
and all is well
yes well.

NORMAN MACLEOD

PROLET CHRONICLE

Tom Mooney was railroaded to prison:
Let churchbells ring to the iron clink
Of in God we trust on the silver dollar.
Where the cultivated swards in California
Stretch to postcard calendar skies,
To the Golden Gate and real estate agencies
In the Land of Sunshine, in the ample playground
Of movie stars and Better America Federations,
Let all rich men conspire to keep
A governor's vacation full of fish
And iron men, a man who in successive summers
Has promised to decide upon Tom Mooney's
Innocence (whose innocence of guilt
Is long since proven), but never has,
For starving jobless men in San Francisco
And all of California have asked for his release,
As well as jobs . . .
Tom Mooney rots in prison:
And the churchbells ring to the iron clink
Of in God we trust on the silver dollar.

VALENTIN DE MANOLL

CLICK

On the palpitating path
On the golden road of sea
Leading to the brilliant sky
On the beach of sand disturbed
By the bitter bite of waves
On the sonorous cold pier
Where the lamp of the living burns
On the sealed posts of the quay
On the balcony where eyes await
The craft of flowered sail
The eyes that seek the old philter
In intangible magic-books
On the fog-soiled horizon
On the garlands of the light
Swinging in the pit of the port
On the silence-giving night
On your ghastly face

THE MORADA

On your hands as fragile as withered leaves
On cascades of sobs
On the bench of the narrow way
Where I spy your heart revealed
To the warm breath of the pines
On your favorite caresses
Red and perfumed lips
Oh! on your body proffered and defiled
I have absorbed all—all—all—all.
(Translated from the French by Harold J. Salemsen)

JOSEPH KALAR

INVOCATION TO THE WIND

O sprinting of the wind over land
like a colt galloping swift
pounding over grass neighing
to the sun snorting howdoyoudo
to the clouds with a flying mane—
O wind coming over the lean land
like a fatness of green in spring
or flowers blooming over Mojave
blow blow into all dusty corners
reach cool fingers beyond cobwebs
festooning this dark room where
throats are choked with dust and
beauty shrivels like mushrooms
in dry cellars—blow blow into
factories with windows of dust
and a shuffling of feet tired
in silk stockings and fingers
red at the tips—blow blow into
jails come like a draught of spring
water to faces hungering against
steel bars—blow blow into slums
cleave the darkness festering
in mines coal and iron glide over
pale children bowing in beetfields
blow wind, sprint over the land
like a colt pounding over grass—
rattle the shutters of this dark room
where beauty whimpers softly like a child—
O surely someday we'll fill the fields
with our dancing and laughing and singing,
O wind coming over the lean brown land
like a fatness of green in spring
or flowers creeping over Mojave!

A. S. J. TESSIMOND

Words can make trickier music than music can
words can dance better blues, tangoes than feet can
words can draw men out of publichouses
into a church, brothel, under a tombstone

words can make black white and white black and both neither . . .
words stub the mind with their dull stupid bruising
(a thick heavy thumb on a half-dead insect)
words fall in silences, still pools of silence—
lie floating and turning like waterlogged beerbottles . . .
words are dead-endings, presumptuous colophons,
premature epitaphs

RICHARD THOMA

TO A SUICIDE

Nothing is so rapid as transition,
and black suns die as quickly as gold,
but you can't buy death at the price of a pistol
and a few drinks.

Was it escape you sought?
Comfort?
Death was never concentration.
Death is a mysterious scattering of seeds.
Think of the hunted flowers you will be;
you may even feed cranes,
if you ever die.

For you haven't died yet.
Suicide is arrested motion.
You've stopped going, but the urge is still there,
irrevocably there.
God pity you! Swinging stupidly
between life and death, with snapped nerves,
two of each, scarring and searing your agonized soul.

Was it worth the destruction of a known caress?

You were the poet of chaos, now you are its victim—
Monstrous Humpty Dumpty that all the holy words
will never put together again.
Your heritage is a terror and a strangled cry
and an unlit sky.

CATHERINE STUART

TRIPLE DIVIDE PEAK

They call you "Mother Mountain."
You feed three waters:
Hudson Bay, Mexican Gulf,
And Ocean of the Pacific.
What is it you whisper to your waters
That freezes them in your embrace,
Before you send them rushing
Over boulder-tumbled pathways
To the seas?

EZRA POUND

Dear macleod:

I think in several senses I have already answered your question or at least a part of it. First: in my notes on Unanimisme and Jules Romains which appeared aeons ago in the *Little Review* and in my "Instigations"; Second: in *Exile* in my note on Lenin's use of language.

It is difficult enough to understand what exists without wandering off into attempted analysis of what might exist, even if one saw no impediments to its probable future existence.

I think that degradation of language is bad for everyone whatever their shade of belief. Such degradation is often temporarily useful to scoundrels.

I think honest men should take a great deal of trouble not to contribute personally to the loosening of the meaning of the words, however good their general intentions, and however etc . . . their love of the race and so weiter.

I don't think the loose use of the words "proletarian"; "proletariat" etc. does any good either to that decreasing section of the public or to letters.

The word proletariat properly applies to that part of the population engaged solely in reproduction of the human species. It dates almost from the time when farm implements were divided into three classes.

The minute any individual or group assumes any function other than that of producing more cannon fodder or human beef or human tractors or implements, it ceases to be proletariat (biological reservoir for undifferentiated energy, without self consciousness, without power of self-direction).

I believe that Lincoln Steffens was the first man to study Lenin dispassionately, without bias, as one wd. study Napoleon (today) or Richelieu or Oliver Cromwell to discover his significance; to try to find out what can be learned from the subject; to dissociate the phenomena which are personal to the historic character, the given opportunity or hindrance, from the general principles involved.

I had Steffens' early results by word of mouth before he had printed them and some of my deductions appeared in 1925. Or perhaps it wd. be more exact to say that I selected certain facts from what Steffens had told me, and put them in what had seemed to me, and I think also to Steffens, their proper relation.

In any case I don't see that it has much to do with New Mexico. It appears to me wholly useless to furnish a man (young or middle aged) with a handful of clichés (abstract ideas) "noble principles" and no understanding of what they mean. You wd. not give a freshman medico a dozen bottles of serum for some particular disease and turn him loose to treat either a foreign or a domestic community for all ailments.

THE MORADA

I will write about communism when I have seen some, in the interim I will read the reports of those who have. I don't see how you are to have an "advantée" in social organization in the U. S. A. among a population too grovellingly servile to maintain the status of organism bequeathed it by its forebears; and too slothful of mind even to spend the few hours necessary to learn either the intentions of the starters of the American system or the effect of those aims on the actual instruments of government.

I don't see how a "revolutionary party" or a "labour party" or whatever you want to call it is going to reform ANYTHING until they at least learn what they are setting out to reform.

On the other hand, during the short space of fourteen years in England I have seen ideas that were considered too dangerous to mention in print (in 1916) openly stated in Baldwin's last election manifesto. He was "agin em" and lost.

Also (as I have stated in *Exile*) you are NOT dealing with stasis; "economics" does not deal with stationary objects.

The "ideas" mentioned in the paragraph before the last were not the phrases of oratory or even of mob propaganda or of an organized party. They were the ideas of a small group of men who talked quietly and were trying very hard to think straight, and to get their thought as accurate as a sound operation in mathematics.

As far as this might be supposed to have any bearing on "literature" I see a very definite lack in American literature for 1930. It is all very well to print writing by "farmers, plumbers, teamsters . . ." and excellent that they shd. confine their expression to subjects with which they are familiar, but it is a sign of nothing save obfuscation and laziness on the part of intellectuals "with leanings toward . . ." that they utterly refuse to examine or describe either the actual working conditions of American society or the varieties of humanity actively engaged in maintaining, altering, and degrading that society. There has been one novel dealing with Washington administration. I am not here concerned with its literary value. It was probably as

"good" as it cd. have been under the circumstances.

There is here greater opportunity for the young writer than there is in sentimentalizing over certain stock types of pathetic fiction.

Dostoevsky's pen was not sufficiently incisive to present a Bryan or a Volstead.

Rapallo

JOSEPH KALAR

Dear macleod:

Ezra Pound, I suppose, has the proper philological authority in demanding that the words "proletarian" and "proletariat," be restricted to apply solely "to that part of the population engaged solely in reproduction of the human species," though the distinction here is a fine one and archaic. Webster, a good enough authority under the circumstances, affirms the current usage, and the words have been used to mean, "one of the wage-earning class," years before Ezra Pound was born. I cannot see that we are wrong in talking of "proletarian art"—in the sense that it will have to do with workers,—though there is a question as to what "proletarian art" really is.

Offhand, I would say that the influence of communism on American literature is negligible—if by communism we mean political and economic ideology exclusively. But I do believe that there is among the young writers, a state of mind, however divorced from actual theory, that could very well be called "bolshhevik"—and in terms of esthetics as well.

There are writers to whom the proletarian art of the future is a theory: there will be others to whom theory will be of no great concern, but who will advance and perfect a proletarian art because of the very force of events, because it would be impossible for them to write in any other way, who will be given the guts to perform a difficult task by the evolution of art and capitalism, in brief, just as the age produces a Lenin, so will the age produce the proletarian artist. In America, for instance, Upton Sinclair has courageously ploughed the field for the future

worker's art—the embryonic seeds of which are already sown; it has achieved a very promising beginning in the work of Michael Gold, and its discipline promises fair to dominate the future work of John Dos Passos. The proletarian writer will be in sharp contrast to the literary vermin that swarm over and gnaw at America's literary corpse, who play the scented whore, and for thirty pieces of silver, will do the hootchi-kootchi dance, or wiggle their abdomens in imitation of legendary oriental ladies. He will have none of the facile commercial sophistication of a Van Vechten or Floyd Dell; his sophistication will be masculine, with roots in the soil, born of knowledge, and guided by a lean definite purpose.

Capitalism, gorged with booty, beats on its distended belly the deathchant to its own inevitable dissolution. The leisureclass can afford to sit back and enjoy a pageant of bellydances; it can hire writers to chant swansongs of pleasurable disillusion and masochistic sensuous decay; it breeds countless of sincere writers who bleed at the nose with disillusion and cry in moving anguish that the world is headed for the abyss, that all is dross, that decay alone is beautiful, and that nothing but dark night broods all over the world. Such a collection as the *American Caravan* is an invaluable index to this individualistic despair, demonstrating admirably that when a civilization reaches the peak of its ascendancy, artists, barometers of civilization, begin to chant swansongs and are absorbed appallingly with thoughts of death, madness, disintegration. It might be of value to ask why this should be so: why, at a time when the fat songbirds of prosperity warble in every newspaper and magazine, and the United States is the richest nation in all the world, its sincere artists are sapped by despair, and why, when a country is at the lowlevel of its upward climb to prosperity and world domination, its literature is so often optimistic and sentimental? The world war marked a turning point, an explosion in a gorged belly; it made of the United States, as yet timidly and cautiously venturing on a course of imperialism, an openly, brutally, callously imperialistic nation, and in literature, it scattered consternation and bewilder-

ment, commercialism under the guise of art, and creative sterility.

Dada, gorgeously and purposely imbecilic, was spawned at this time, the spiritual delirium tremens of high-strung nerves, the shuddering anticlimax, the aftermath of a completed coition with death: recovery was slow, convalescence was a time for a searching into and a sober dissection of a civilization that was sprawled like a corpse and already giving off odors of putrescence. War was a devastating disillusion, romanticism in its old form received a deathblow, and the falsity and futility of the old literary illusions was made patent.

A mind in bewilderment reaches out feverish hands to grasp whatever straws are at hand: Dada was a straw, and after Dada, mysticism. Actually, mysticism is an evasion of reality, and an evasion of reality can result only in impotence. Other writers, beginning from the ground up, became immersed in the proletarian movement that exploded into fruition in Russia and stirred and rattled its chains in all parts of the world, and only in the proletarian movement is there sanity, purpose, or direction. Others, like Ezra Pound, retreated into classicist isolation, absorbed in color and music and words to the exclusion of life and reality, turning out creations of undoubted beauty, but literariously beauty, drowned in their own perfume, in other words, they made art serve the purpose of black spectacles, effectively shutting out the distracting and irritating spectacle of a swinish servile humanity hellbent on its own destruction. Still others, like old ladies knitting socks against time and death and despair, make of James Joyce a sublimated crossword puzzle, and of words, a pitiful parlorgame. Whatever validity revolutionizing the word may possibly have—aside from bewildering the "common reader" so cordially damned, is made futile by the fact that the new word must be translated by quite ordinary thought processes, which in turn are conditioned by the old stale word and that the new word has no meaning, even for the group now its most enthusiastic defenders, until it has been mentally rewritten as the old word.

"New forms without a new content seem as worthless to me as walnut shells whose meat the little bugs have gnawed

away," says Michael Gold, and, it might be added, new forms without a new content are comparable to powdering and rougeing the face of an aged harlot.

Ezra Pound has affirmed the vitality of the new art and thought which, quite conceivably, may be called "proletarian" as far back as 1927, in a footnote (*Exile* No. 1) saying "apart from Mr. Mencken and the New Masses, American thought is entirely covered by the Harding memorial stamp!" And in the letter under consideration, in the third from the last paragraph, he has partially stated our aims. It is significant, however, that while Ezra Pound fulminates eloquently on the bane of passports and idiotic beauracracy—his own literary writings are quite free of any "political" significance, or examination, which may also be "a sign of nothing save obfuscation and laziness."

The world war made the emancipation of the proletariat more than a beautiful dream in the minds of a few romanticists, it made it imperative, and the resultant theory was shorn considerably of rhetorical sentimental gestures; in literature it definitely made the old Christian Socialist literature seem ministerial, a sobbing to an old tune, a slumming expedition into stinking slums. The new literature must be more direct: it can be made more direct by an avoidance of generalities: the new literature must be pinned down to specific instances. Pathetics, tears, the messiah attitude, sentimental deification of the proletariat, must be taboo. Our literature must be a literature of aspiration, of anger, of a healthy disgust with the old stale codes of conduct, a denial of "spiritual constipation," complacency, conformity, the mob-mind: it must be a literature of examination, curiosity, facts. We need not be dishonest. Art with its roots in the proletarian movement must be honest. Our portraits of the proletarian must be so drawn that they will be recognized by the proletarian as a portrait of himself and not as a portrait of a medieval saint: if we show his swinish apathy, it will be only to arouse him: we must show him as he is, a hard drinker, a being with common lusts and common ambitions, cruelty, brutality, ignorance, cowardice, but we shall also show his inherent fineness and sanity,

his moments of dreaming, and his splendid moments of revolt.

JAY LEYDA

Ruth,

Come and crunch snow that is dry blue and has ice over it and down into it for a sixteenth of an inch. And look at a sky that is hard dry and blue. And pass a barn that is red that once was a very much brighter red but now it is beautiful and almost black against the snow. Crossing rottenly a side of the barn is a sign for SCRAP TOBACCO and it will be here when you walk by here in the summer or in the spring if there will be for you and me a spring or a summer. But there will be many springs and summers and winters for us only we will not walk by here again. There are many roads leading from us and we will take a new one every morning. And we will not want dry blue snow always. We will want slush sometimes and mud and dust, and suns with no snow to reflect them into our eyeballs so that we are to each other red blurred beings that have met here on this road with a purpose. We want no purpose. We fly we float and we want no purpose floating and no end to air.

For we are living and more than living and the snow's surface that cracks knows it. It gives way. We will take great steps and someone who follows will wonder. We will pass a tree that had apples and will have more apples and another, nuts and another, leaves, and another that died last week and the owner will not know about it until next spring when there will be no leaves on it. The low hills are lower with the snow and the snow makes the far hills farther. You will be nearer than when we walked in the summer and the ground was easy to walk upon. Now we attack the snow and it gives way. Maybe we will not attack the snow. Maybe it will give way because we do not notice that it is resisting with its ice our feet that do not stumble even over bushes.

The air is so clear.

PAGANY

A NATIVE QUARTERLY

Volume One
Number Two

SPRING
1930

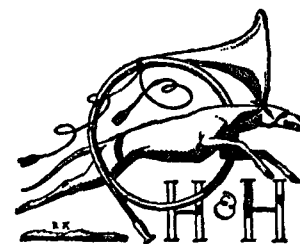
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donal mckenzie

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criticism

poetry

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5

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PAGANY

A NATIVE QUARTERLY

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Number One

WINTER
1931

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fernand jouan is the editor of La Revue Mosane. Engis, Belgium.

anthonie donker is the pseudonym of one of the more important Holland poets.

samuel putnam, editor of the European Caravan, is now the editor of THE NEW REVIEW, an international cahier of the arts.

frantisek halas is the editor of the advance guard review KVART published in Prag.

vitezlav nezval is also connected with KVART.

bob brown is working on the reading machine he described in last transition.

He is now compiling an anthology of Readies for the Machine which will be published soon by the Roving Eye Press. He invites contributions, suggestions and criticisms in care of The National City Bank of New York, 41 Boulevard Haussmann. Paris, France. He is at present living in Nice.

robert mc almon's poetry and prose has appeared in Exile, transition, The Hound & Horn and elsewhere. He is at present in Albuquerque, New Mex.

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john c. rogers

heart of virginia

my grandfather a rebel driving great numbers of hogs and horses across the blue ridge to the james and loving only his wife his children horses strong drink and saying to his friends at the store on the porch of his farmhouse on horseback over the plowed fields or by the fireplace and logs spitting out sparks i remember one time... with tobacco staining his white beard his breath sweet with the odor of picnietwist or homegrown that i helped twist browning my fingers from leaves softened by the dew of night. o tenants o migratory workers you loved him this lusty man with only his horse his wife and a farm that grew into weeds he grew like a great white oak splitting the loam giving away food money harness to his workers... his children hating his generous gifts to poor whites... to negroes living in a board shack and walking the red clay barefoot wanting only a little love a barrel of flour... but my grandfather gave until even in his old age nights before death cursing by god o by god stumbling to the outhouse noone-stoppinghim and weeds in the graveyard in the orchard the workers cut away the weeds and the lilac... under a wild growth a rebel resting no more his horse thrilling to the sound of hounds no voice calling go-long Dixie o the flesh decaying and breath of kine smelling of grass of garlic i could not weep at his burial some say i am hard having no tears for the dead i gave him a silent love o tenants o migratory workers nothing so great as our silent sorrow or nights on a mountain dark with the deep silence roaring in our ears.

o hot days in the orchards with children and women of workers not minding the tall ladders climbing or wind blowing clothes against strong thighs or over the sorting table bending and under the overalls seeing the curve the rise the fall of full breasts o i wondered at the frank talk and jokes watching the muscles moving under the homespun apples pressed into barrels rain and the smell of horseflesh... laurel snapping into our faces the rocks or earth rolling in the valley poplars reaching for the sun o the johnny-cakes spread with sorghum the hominy grits the cool damp leaves at the

john c. rogers

ice house bottom and watermelons long after season . . . my feet over the red clay gathering roots for tea smelling the loam the pine my hands searching the hollow log at a trails end o the slow words the love of a tenant farmer's daughter the going away the interim my grandfather wise knowing no class loving the strong limbs the lips as red-berries glowing o my life in the city and books that i read o the worker's daughter crossing the hill as a wild bear walks and bushes parting . . . not hiding not ashamed of this clean body o hot nights on a strawtick dreaming o the banjo in a wind-whipped shack o the brogans stamping the thin smoke rising over the still-house and hauling culls by moonlight . . . o i wanted to go to the city taking my daughter of earth listen you of the lorgnettes breeder of pinknosed chows this is a wife of man strong as the grass in spring judge her as horses are judged you of the limousines . . . breeder of children who spring from thighs wide as the ragged mountains mother of workers born and bearing in the stink and stigma of toil so i would sing from the housetops over the city the serpentine wall of the college over the weedgrown and vacant plantation into the ears of all.

i remember nights in Virginia knarled hands empty resting on a porch rail watching the stars come out or the creak of a wagon wheel turning . . . us resting and him asking ain't there nothin else only this poorness and rat-dung in the flour or rain falling into our home only the three of us the old man his daughter and me or maybe some lousy kids coughing or scratching for bugs . . . christ ain't there nothin else her head resting on my knees and the old man asking and painting the scabs on his feet with iodine . . . me feeling a gulp in my throat knowing two beds for ten people in a leaky shack me blinking at the moonlight on her hair guessing maybe someday she'll go to town with her mom all painted up coming back with maybe new shoes or a dollar bill o my god i hope to christ there is something else remembering books i had read . . . o workers of the South unloading bananas steel o dusky stevedores far from the farm o ragged workers hauling clean bales of cotton or leaning over a deck-rail counting the dolphins plunging after a flatboat's wake listen to me i have left cutting cordwood or apples falling an old crosscut saw gummed up with rosin with weeds and yellow-jackets scratching the fuzz off peaches . . . i could'nt face the old man with his christ ain't there nothin else so i came back to the city not through tho not finished but getting to-gether all of us a girl with windblown hair and strong loins her old man

joseph kalar

with scabs on his feet his buggy children and even a wife blowing out gas-jets or asking fifty-cents god ain't there no more to life than this . . . o i know there is the books i read say so even a jobless man on the corner speaking even Virginia even the South all of us knowing there is but scared of the word not since 1776 you're damnrightthere is marching again all of us over the land our land smelling of loam of pine of cosmetics of oil tryenstopus.

joseph kalar

bank

Be proud be proud whimpers
the bank be proud with
compound interest and
mortgages on farms lean
and not so lean . .

O blueprint under eyes
manifestly curves pillars
burglaralarms O eyes
warm with wine of massive
granite . . .

Addingmachines, ledgers,
president with black cigar,
and bookkeeper scanning
stockexchange reports have
a beauty too . .

Be proud be proud workmen
glance at surplus fund
deposits receipts with eyes
warm as eyes gliding over
what must not be said . . .
Be proud be proud whimpers
the bank be proud to a bum
with crooked legs and cinders
in his eyes be proud to a bum
diffidently picking at his nose
and with blunt nails,
scratching at his ear.

paul frederic bowles

eight

i

The lemontrees line the harbor and the sharktooth is
buried in the sand.
The noonday shore glitters and sailors enter the squalid
cafés.
The whistle of a steamboat beyond the promontory is an
ague
and the redhaired woman eats a tangerine.
The yellow pennant shakes in the seawind and the butcher
on the sidestreet eats his lunch.
The swans in the park croak
and barnacles are scraped from the ship's side.
The narrow streets shudder with heat and the cactus on the
hillside hides the scorpion.
The mechanical piano vomits a melody. In the patio the
fountain dribbles.

ii

Stretch, cape, sixteen miles away, and stop the larger tropic
waves.
The octopus is languid in the aquarium and the lizards run
along the gravel by the roses.
The beggar dozes by the quay and horses stamp hungrily in the
square.
The day lunges into the hot afternoon and the wind shrills
angrily across the beach.
The lighthouse stands a white obelisk
and urchins bathe by the causeway at the edge of the town.
The girl sobs in the courtyard
and two raging cats rack the air with cries.
The wheels on the cobblestones make a presto
and from the hill the mountainrange is topped with snow.
And in the lazy valley there is no village.

eugene jolas

frontier

I.

There is an ache in the rilling vale. One by one the trains cry
through the frontier station. Crows flutter over the white slab, over
the star-acres, over the gulch of the glow-foam. There is no paren-
thesis. Only the steam-words and the blue sister dusk. Only an
evening garden rotting with vegetative misery, only the measure of
a fever child. From far off echoes the stertorous ringing of a loco-
motive.

II.

It is a land of mines and mills. It is a land of fear-death and
pestilence. But why are we so lonely-dark? Through soot-night
walks a woman, and silver magnet songs sink from out of her hands.
Roartone of shafts. There is a clingelangeling of crucifixions. The
eons pass by with clocks and sleepers. And children wander in the
pale-street, in the comet of the flicker-spider's gnosticisms.

III.

There is a lalling of black visions. Words slide and sligger
through the hunted morgue of sleep. The taverns cry with wooden
tongues. O ritournelle of the unspoken logos! O sound and stam-
mer, gishgush of the larvae! When the lights are turned out, there
will be a reptile in the sky, and a low moon and a sinister morass
of shoulders. Hold tight---the beams are cracking, world-woe-lute of
homesickness!

IV.

It's old music spilled over the cloud-hearts. A death head
spins day-dreams, an old fiacre clipperclappers on the white road,
the carrousel whines between walls of ivy. But brood-thunder crush-
es the rattling lungs. The beggar's organ worms its way through
the crowd. Pale girls dance in the smoke of the hall near the pine-
forest. Celestial acres sleep and wait for starlight free from enigmas.

V.

The wounded earth sinks into itself. It is an abyss of daynight.
The grass bleeds under the shillering scythe, a flamebird flutters
against the pitch mountain, moaning-women fade into a mooncry.
No panpipes drillshrill in the blazeshout. The roofs fall in. Night-
mares sicker torches. It will be east and west, it will be hunting
horns, it will be a night of litanies terrible with crying.

donal mckenzie

garda

fish-belly bright fling
slithering the clouds
among lunacies of
moon
light.
 seriously
silly moons hurl
the poised beauty
- twilight-
 tipling down
gutters of hysteria
the blueness
the bellying lake shatters
to the insistent
wind spumes over the washed
shingle
while the sands sing soft
like summer nights -

but the church high white
smiles
 like a corpse running
falling to pieces
down from sopra

robert mcalmon

new york harbour

The lumber barge had stood in the harbor for several days and I couldn't get to shore even if it was only a mile away, because the captain wouldn't let me lower the boat. He said it leaked. There was no place to land anyway as firms owning the various storehouses and docks would not permit a boat to land on their property.

It would be hot in the city at best, with not much to do but tramp about the streets, since everybody I knew was out of town for the summer. One day had gone by with fair rapidity, because

robert mcalmon

I'd taken out all my bedclothes and washed them since steersmen of the barge for years back had slept on them, from their looks, with never a thought of cleanness. The second day had gone by too, because the night before bed bugs wouldn't let me sleep, even when I'd killed a hundred of them, so I was sleepy. After having taken the mattress of my cot and ridding it of innumerable bunches of bugs, and bug's eggs, and sprinkling it with gasoline, I let it stay out in the sun all morning. Also I put newspapers on the bunk that I would put the mattress back upon. So in the afternoon, when I'd made up my bunk, I was sleepy and felt sure the bed bugs wouldn't bother me if I took a nap. They didn't either, for that nap, though they were back in numbers before long, more indefatigably persistent about annoying me than I was about getting rid of them since it meant such constant work.

The captain was a little sandy-haired Virginian of Scotch extraction, and though he said he had no education, he was rather well informed, but he didn't talk much. A quiet, ironic, little man he was, with a romantic strain in him since he read wild-west stories all day, and acted romantically gallant towards his wife, in the evening, when we all sat in back of the bargecabin. I couldn't understand his sentiment of affection for her. She was a narrow-shouldered, waspish person, given to moods and sullen temperament. Generally she didn't accompany him on his barge trips, but this time she was doing the cooking for the three of us, and drawing salary because of that. But she refused to serve meals on time, and if he happened to have gone to town in a motor boat that came along to pick him up — we both couldn't be gone from the barge at one time — she wouldn't feed me any dinner at all. However she wasn't cross, just crabbedly sickly perhaps, for she was as kind as could be to a little black rat terrier and her puppy that were on the barge with us. In the evenings I'd race up and down the deck having the black dog race after me, barking excitedly and snapping playfully at my heels. The puppy, a lumpy awkward ball, would do his best to follow, but he got tangled up with himself all the time, and if I should suddenly turn and bark at him, he'd turn tail and catapult back to the captain's wife, and then look at me shamefacedly out of his bead-bright eyes, once he knew all was well... So I accepted the captain's wife as a woman with not a bad heart, but so longfaced, sallow, drab, and sinewy in her skin-iness was she that it was hard to understand his affection. Now and then she'd make a curtly humorous remark. So I concluded

robert mcalmon

that beneath her Virginia Mountain manner of silence, and austerity, was whimsicality of a sort to attract him.

This night had followed an eventless day, with no flairs between the captain and his missis about her not taking enough trouble with the meals, and no kick on either of their parts because I didn't keep enough wood chopped.

After contemplating the statue of Liberty for a time, and reflecting on the strict limitations that there are in the concept "Liberty", I sat down upon a hatch cover near the captain and his wife, a little uncomfortable because they signified nothing to me as persons, and I supposed I meant as little to them, so I thought perhaps they'd rather be alone. But the ocean seemed to have cut me off from all kinds of experience, I knew anything about. There was no turbulence within it tonight, only in me the consciousness of the turbulence that was a continuing quality in New York, the habitation of turbulent masses of men and machinery.

Soon the captain got up, and walking along the side of the barge, began to see what was going by on the belly of the outgoing tide. He took the boathook, and leaned over the side of the barge to spear large pieces of wood to dry and use for fire-wood. Many strange things go by on the outgoing tide, intent perhaps, as I have been intent, upon merely "getting away" to taste the solitude upon the restless loneliness of ocean expanse.

"A box of whisky or I'm a sucker", the skipper said suddenly with more excitement than I'd seen him manifest before, as he pointed at a four-fifths submerged box. "The bootleggers bring whisky in to the three mile limit line and throw it overboard in boxes, to be picked up by watchers in boats, and the watchers missed that one". He was jumping around, having found that by no straining could he touch the box with his boathook. It went by, well out of reach of us on the barge, and he talked about it for the next three days declaring that he'd have jumped overboard and got it, had he been sure it was whisky.

Still, tonight, he did not let his brooding on that prevent his keeping a lookout for other valuable matter that the tide might drive past.

"I've seen as many as three dead men go by in one night!" he commented, and I listened, not skeptically or otherwise. The skipper was a great liar but for all that there was no reason to believe that he mightn't deceive one by telling the truth occasionally, when one didn't expect it.

robert mcalmon

"Dead men", I wondered. Were they generally bloated, did they float face down, where'd they come from, did their folks know they were drowned, how did their drowning come about? Any number of questions drifted through my mind giving identity to very impersonal dead men who go by on the surface of an outgoing tide.

"I haven't seen any dead men go by myself, but there are a good many of those - I suppose they're dead men potentially - which go by every night", I said after a while.

The skipper looked with wary interest where I pointed. He wasn't going to be caught napping: not he. At first he didn't believe they were what I told him, but as many more came by, and nearer the barge, he saw more distinctly. Some of them were inflated, others not, though of course they'd all served their day.

"There's lots of them used at beaches on a holiday", he said cryptically at last.

"The unrest, the wish to go to sea attacks some very early in life", I suggested.

The captain's wife had heard us talking, and her curiosity got the better of her, though she wasn't so indiscreet as to ask a question in front of me. Finally, however, standing up, looking overboard, she saw what it was we spoke of. An enigmatic expression, partly sarcastic, partly a repressed smile, some light of recognition, showed on her face. A look was exchanged by her and the captain, and she, turning away, walked into the cabin.

It was becoming dusk and hard to distinguish whether the last animal corpse that went by was a cat, a dog, a pig, or whatnot. You can't tell what salt water will do to an animal's corpse, or can't know how long these corpses are driven back and forth by incoming and outgoing tides.

Night cupped the horizon, which dimming in the darkness was a meticulously curved arm cradling the ocean, and the opacity of distance upon unending ocean water changed into an opacity of violet gray. I stood for a time to look at the high buildings in the Wall street district of New York, and to feel the quality of their severity, as they pointed up in the sky towards the outcoming stars. Squares, and checkerboard designs of lights, in oblongs extending upward, appeared before me as the city lights were on. Electric signboards were glimmering blueyellow in the sky, but I could see them only as slatches of light generally, unable to discern the wordings of the lettered ones, or the illustrations of the pictorial ones. How thin, straight, and directly, skyscrapers stand against

norman macleod

dusk of early night, when there are lights inside them. Even the ones with but few lights stood out at first, but as the night deepened, they all became dim, vaporous, and unreal as a mirage.

It was useless standing by the side of the barge any longer, looking into the water, all black now, and not even to be seen except that my mind remembered that it was there. Besides the skipper had advised my going to bed as I'd have to get up early and chop wood before the heat of the day, as we'd probably be picked up by a towboat tomorrow afternoon, and there'd be little time to chop wood on the way down to Norfolk.

Anyway, I knew I'd have to spend at least a half hour killing bedbugs, and putting gasoline around the bed slabs, as I'd let a night go by without doing that. Gasoline is a less offensive odour to sleep with than the oily odour of bedbugs, which itch as well as smell. I detested, also, crushing a bedbug when it was full of my own blood. So it was up to me to use gasoline in plenty...

"Your wife recognized some of those young dead men too, I noticed", I remarked to the captain as I went up the stairs of the barge cabin to my bunkroom. The captain looked a bit as though such things had not ought to be mentioned, but vouchsafed a half grin.

norman macleod

wise like Lenin

Pain possessive the mountains crust
a tragic immobility
of seething earth and rock
enclosed within the slowly changing
surface that belies
the close proximity that forces mass
on mass.

Here upon this milling red milieu
of stark antagonistic peoples we believe
that order comes from chaos
and contrive
to change the semblance of a world
harmonious with sun and stars
and uniform necessities
and men that lag with old archaic orders
call us fools and years from now
will call us wise,
like Lenin...

vítězslav nezval

from headings

sea necktie

The beautiful suicide woman
rubbing her hips pluming by steam
her soul
a necktie forlorn in the sea.

a tea house

Under the diminutive lantern
the silken China
in harmony with the seasons
changes her embroidery
The little birds are ripping off a false stitch
and all the women of China are asleep
in sunflowered pavilions
without little feet
without breasts
without a dream.

the solitude

When in the evening without a lamp
the phosphorescent swamp lures me
I go and pull down curtains of mine
and the eyes staring at the clock
I am waiting for you, melancholy,
for you, oh evil-eyes of an invisible bird.

the nest

And when he returned
into her little room
he found a sleeping bird of paradise in ruins
all the rest turned to the dust.

(Translated by Arnošt Vaněček)

louis zukofsky

from **two dedications**
D. R.

Comrade Diego Rivera -
His murals speak:
Executives of industry,

Rich stone heads
Conferring at tables,
We peasants and

Workers, our faces
Becoming us more
Than frescoes of saints,

Marshal to say:
We are the
Heads over industry.

Our children, (backs
Pretty as ladybugs,
Red upon gold

Soil) now humbled
On stumps, grow
Up on soil

Turning black thru
Our efforts - water,
Our biceps, unspared.

Our mates, their mothers,
Shall know them -
Unflattered by dynamos -

Controlled among wheels
And controlling the
Glancing of belts

richard johns

Against pulleys. Holidays -
There'll be many -
Will find friends

Rangers among palm
Leaf and tiger
Paw.

Sunday; the
Miner's lantern unlit,
Coal beneath sun.

richard johns

there can be no truce

Let fly your falcons,
set the moat
against my foray -
Hide deep within your battlements
and gird the walls with watchers
to spy against my coming.
I warn you now
(believing you redoubtable)
it would be dangerous
for you to show yourself
to me, besieger,
for I could do no less than strike you dead
if I should see the scorn and pity
of your eyes
look down upon me
from the guarded fortress
of your face.

samuel putnam

sonnet to creation

(for maxwell bodenheim)

sling continents mould mountains gut earth
haul high to a rattrap stopgap doom of womb
gut earth rut earth wombgirth for a tomb
and worms for the blindman's mickleworth o' mirth
shape rapes rape shapes bore high to a birth
spermworm wriggle to a BOOM
deciduous sweeproom from a broom whom
pertinaceous violets, lull with dearth

look low blow high high to a hymen ho!
nequaquam mori - - - - - applerind and but
there is a core God looked and it was good
peel to a penance be jaunty suck woe slow
sloughedserpentleavings if we could we would
stainedglass and glory heighho! high low!
glut the slut and say that God's in rut

bob brown

writing readies

The modern-minded are now writing readies, scripts with optical eyetickling interest to be read on a reading machine. There is a stationary reading machine already in use in America. In Detroit a simple, portable electrically-driven device as compact, practical and cheap as a kodak is being perfected to present a continuous line of type in motion before the reader's eye. When this machine is in use more words per second will be available to the reading eye, and writing will be livelier, fuller, more readable and writeable.

In an anthology of readie scripts, specially written to be read on the reading machine, thirty modern-minded writers offer snappy evidences of speeding-up for the new medium. See for yourself.

bob brown

Here are extracts:

Kay Boyle in "Change of Life": "- accordion sat in lap heaving sighing - accordion whinnying gasping sat crying on his knee --- give me nigger I'll dance the legs off him - Maman asked water he went on playing -- Maman asked Doctor he opened up accordion like big weeping baby - "

Samuel Putnam in "Dirty Nigger": "-Lord's-work-must-be-done-women-folks-need-lookin-after-men'll hafter--- Fire-some-place-big-fire-she-Mose-fighting-Granny-Ness'-dog-howling-breasts-somebody-Mose-pushing-back-up-going-up-up---"

Don McKenzie "Madmorning in Russia": "Pinsky leaned forward gently mirrorface winced sweetly // Pinsky leaned harder into ecstacy but face clenched difficult bliss it quivered little Pinsky leaning harder in sweet orgasm of pain the body the OTHER'S body writhed lasciviously and Pinsky shoved ruthlessly HARDER til bleeding sun descended sky while sheep cropped lilies under moonlight."

J. Jones "Biografica - A Erthwhorl Stori": "erly spring sunred morn junglmist green monkey green liana tailswing drop green egg yellosplash green log brown monkey tenfoot drop feet hands brown monkeys shoulders jaba grins together upscrambl love where safe leafs, logs krokodiles warm snOOze snoot hornbills. on mountens of moon neath everlast flowers, bats lows leopard's chilsleep."

Filippo Tommaso Marinetti "Olfactory Poetry": "Eyes shut nostrils open to wind with my striding body the ultra elastic ultra-vibrant skein of perfumeodors It is she this fragrant highly nimble ovoidal volume of cool pinkmilky perfumes with above 3,6,9 spirals of extract of vanilla."

George Kent "Peach Pie": "...in the black hot stove coal balls twitter... egg balls... likerish hot balls... twitter... tongues lick the hot... lickerish... lick off the pitch... lick off the cold... lick em pink... lick em rose red... um... mum... um... mum... rose balls in black hot stove... my love rolls the flesh... flesh yaller dough... rolls em sings... raw peach pie into ripe pitch oven..."

A. Lincoln Gillespie Jr. "Readievices": "clausending, inclosures, tereate passtress (supplant Underlines) ----- when Writer wishes Slowintake, marvellous Bacfrade SPACES for omission of notquiteextlySuperWords, Emphsilences CAP-ITALS (entire syllable or word) limn accumajminor- punct-points of now-unistreaming phrases-formerly-lines"

bob brown

Rose Brown "Dis": "then-Elaine-delicate-browneyed-french-babysweet-clinging-lipsandfingers - then-the-tooth-empty=cashier-must-smile-toothless cashierugh=Paul-didnt mind-his-mark-upon-her-youcansee-shes-minenow putting-his-dis-upon-her-disillusioned-discouraged-dissembling-disfigured-disabled-living-womans-life-by-mans-maxims="

Richard Johns "Summer Sun": "*babies are red - babies are blue* - I want - I want - WHAT - a baby - little babe - no -- want baby-maker - want heat - want Will - stream-line Will - half-wit Will - want hands - arms - hair - here and there - want - above all want him - virgin teacher wants idiot boy - saw him swim - at the brim- hid she did - saw him swim - saw him float - dared to gloat - can't slep now - rub breast - where's rest -"

Norman MacLeod: "Ready: revelation": "i-will-repeat-Red-orgiastical-with padres-calling-one girl-to-another-in-midnight-confessional-and-little-enough-th-seeds-spring-into-being-go-farther-and-upon phallus-of-mind-it-be-nothing-wonder-at-men come-out-of cities barren-with-sooty-dreams-women-in-lost-favor-----shut-this-woman-slut-".

Walter Lowenfels writes: p I t b n h y s o
r h e t y o t r
i t e t a p u o
n h t l h r a
t i e e e c y
e n f r l n o p
d k f i s u a o
e t n l b e
o t c h e a d o m
n h t a s n u
i n y w t a
p s o w w r b
a f h i a i f o
g g o t y t a u
e i t r h e l t
s v a i l l
e p z i a i s
s e o k n n
e g o
this w

frantisek halas

Hilaire Hiler "H-A-N-G-O V-E-R": -could he-have-alastdrink?.....?-the-man-saidyes-but-*en-vitesse*-Didnt-light-lights-suell kind-of-oriental-incense-or-something-damn-chair-almost-fell-start-darknoise-----"

Nancy Cunard "Dlink" "I / thought-basket no dlink one-time/ Poem plenny dreg-leg cork hat Middle ME (poem)/ dark stuff Flash-gold verdigrease/ Blandy put plenny pins in thought-pudding Plick goodman-other tf..oo/"

H. L. Mencken says the idea is superb.

Vachel Lindsay likes it.

Upton Sinclair approves of it.

Dentists write asking the price of the machine. They want it to give further entertainment to patients in the chair. Stenographers suggest its use for rapidly reading short-hand. Poets say the readie lines may be broken up with great dippers, stars, milky ways and great bears of words.

It's fresh....refreshing.

All the arts have been modernized; we have movies, talkies; radio and television. Readies are modernizing reading and writing, being printed on translucent tape in miniature type they are readable through a magnifying glass at the rate of two hundred thousand words an hour, and a thousand readie rolls don't weigh as much as an ordinary novel. They offer the coming creative writer a brand-new medium, fresh, refreshing.

františek halas

europe

You all who still do know to weep smile now
over the falling leaves signed with the bloody marks of time
exchange the luxury of your doubts against a hope

I'll tell you something gloom
under the yellow heart of black sun
revealed itself a speck resembling the map of Europe

Among the belching of sonorous guns
the full-blooded text of the Psalms circled upward out of the towns
and inside their bowels lay a tiny child of Nowadays gnawn by rats

frantisek halas

Only with the swishing of iron sounded the laughter of men
resisting like the thistles full of pride
and Europe growing into the dangerous age vomited the ancient History

In the month of roses and crimes sparkled the crown of her face
after the suckling of the Death dugs of her breasts have been burned
down to the dust

the blackened ruins of love

Soaked with blood of foolish adventures
feeling ashamed before the flashing beauty of the soldiers dead
the headless birds

she constantly looked back

recollecting the image of roseate days
when she used to lose on her roads her lunatic bards
like the signs to show her the way to return

But Death pecked them up and the roads are bordered only with the
howling of screech-owls
frail lace-pattern of wrinkles covered the shield of her charm
the crape of shades fell on the world

Now she is running wild and waving the words like thyrsus
choking with bitter memory,
and powders her face with thirsty loam

We love the night like a torso of the dark Venus speckled by gold
with a moderate ail we share with her all love
within the tide of voice the ebb of passion is setting in

The darkness is a fir torn by the flash
falling with a murmur of the morning flock of birds
the battery of poetry explodes

Crash by a stamping foot the charnel flowers peeping out of the soil
like the knuckles of skeletons
cry the bread cry the plays
loving her vanity which is more than our hearts

(Translated by Arnošt Vaněček)

kay boyle

a statement

for El Greco and William Carlos Williams

Toledo shines out like no other city.
And Poe has risen
With his variable ways, and his jaw set at an angle.
Toledo, with no name carved to it saying: here lies.
Toledo, with the face of no man at the window.

(Rending the old hairs of his beard
in his fingers
Stands the past in the wilderness
Lifting his staff to the heavens in
wrath
And moaning for the taste of old men
in their graves
Who have been left, like these mount-
ains of Monte Carlo,
Dead as old shoes, with the name
mountain an affront to them.

The grass of them has drawn its sabers
The stones in the heat quiver like fists
upon them
Amassing a city taller, deeper.
It is into their shadow that I would go
With my soul quaking, and my lungs made
granite
To withstand the assault of them.
Not as a cloud nosing them out, nor to
break the stalk of one glacial flower,
Nor to sing a word that would lure them to
ripening hills,
Maturing
Their lean dry paps to udders of plenty.)

kay boyle

Toledo shines out like no other city
For its infernal clouds and the green of its pastures
That would bring a plague on whatever cattle or stock
 grazed on them,
For the unshed rain that menaces it. Toledo is the
 last town left standing
On the frontier, on the edge,
Before going over.

(As in wartime, all ways led to Washington.

 The streets of that city, laid out for
 the eye of a bird,
 A few hills, a few red chasms, and a
 wild park containing
 The cages of coyotes, and buffalo in
 their matted capes of darky wool;
 A few peacocks tailing the mild Southern
 air. The woods
 In that part spring from under the stone
 roots of a statue
 Who has hung her head and there grieves
 endlessly
 For Mrs. Henry Adams, marking the sorrow
 that sent him wandering -
 "Strangely unlike the prayers I prayed
 to you!" -
 Mutely, across two generations.

There are the lawns of the White House,
 A May-pole of eggs dyed primal colours, rolled
 by the children of Washington
While the President's Lady lifts her lorgnette and
 watches from the window.
The First Lady of the Land should stem from Southern soil,
Comprising all that grace and humour, that arch of neck
 and craft of bosom
For which Lord Washington unbuckled sword and scabbard,
Laid off his boots and waistcoat - that Southern elegance
 that chimed with music-boxes,

kay boyle

Sweet corn, and indolence, that "ah" that "sah", that
 honey-suckled tongue;
Those long sweet rosy corset strings, those strings of
 stays lovely enough
To bind a lady's hair, carried as if a cargo of silken
 eiderdown transformed to glass;
And Washington, with his red jowls and fine calves
 highly turned
Reduced to the dust that flies under the carriage
 wheels in the deep pool
Of Mount Vernon's shadow. And did he really place
 that firm behind
On this brocaded seat, and did that garter delicately
 clasp his limb?
And was this square of lace fashioned of orioles
 pressed to the veins, the pores,
The black festoons of hair that sprang in his proud
 nostril
Beneath his British bone?)

 Toledo is the challenge.
The challenge of one man flung to the heavens,
And they are the black possessed fury blowing on.
Like Poe, with his arms crossed boldly
To conceal his shabby ruffle.

Poe should be carved in stone facing
Four ways in Washington:
 With his cloak worn inside out and
 his cat beside him;
 With his arrogance, with his eyes
 broken,
Facing the White House, the Treasury,
 the Mint, and the House of Representatives.
Poe, a ham-actor - Poe, a rebuke to West
 Point -
A rebuke to truth - for he never spoke it -
Accosting every passer-by with his hat ex-
 tended
Like a poor man; with his arms crossed on
 his tired bosom;

kay boyle

With his fists shaking; with his hands
covering his face and the tears on it;
With his smile twisted up like a ram's horn;
There, like no other Southerner -
(Could corn-meal melt in that mouth, or
molasses run?
Could any Southern sun ignite that heart?)

As in wartime, they all turned to Washington: Poe,
Whitman, asking a place to keep soul and body together
In the Government offices - in the Customs - "I should be
glad," wrote Poe, "if you would take an opportunity
Of saying to Mr. Rob Tyler that if he can look over matters
And get me the inspectorship I will join the Washingtonians
forthwith."

("Don't say a word about the cloak turned
inside out
Or other peccadilloes of that nature.")

"I think it would be a feather in Mr. Tyler's cap to save
from the perils of Mint Julep....
A young man of whom all the world thinks so well and who
thinks
So remarkably well of himself!"

Poe, you have disarmed me. Your
courage has taken my strength from me.
Poe, you have broken me.
There is no spirit left to me, because of you.

Don't say a word about the Mint Juleps,
Don't say a word about being sick on the floor.
Please say I'm sorry about the Don's mustaches,
The port wine, the coffee, and the barber-shop's score.
Don't let them know my wife has hemorrhages.
She strained her throat at singing was what I said -
Don't say a word about the house being buggy.
Please apologize for all the silly things I said.

kay boyle

Washington, you would have stepped the minuét gustily with
any woman;
Your head in its wig would have swooned for any mouth.
Toledo has made all other cities barren.
Toledo has made the Cross burgeon and bloom.
Someday, I'll be there again
By hook or crook, skittling back to you,
Down Louis the Thirteenth's hallway,
To the response and triumph of the heavens.

It is set there among all the pictures of
men's faces
The Crucifixion, with the clouds like
boulders
Knuckling Christ's head. Had you not
spoken
These things would not have been so: not
the root dug white and clear
With the smell of the earth on it,
But a slow fire in the underbrush and no
shadow of respite cast
Upon the flame that has taken my timber
as fuel.

(You have laid waste the pastures that
stretch beyond me
For I would return into the excavations
exhorting you
To speak of what lies in our stones:
Toledo, from the brush of a dead man;
Forbears, from the speech of a living.)

*Another crime
inscribed by
Ezra Pound
del. 11.10.1915*

f. c. weiskopf

Das Kapitel "Ein Sterbefall" ist das zweite Kapitel einer noch unvollendeten grösseren Erzählung "Wandernde Felder". Sie spielt in Karpathorussland, der östlichsten tschechoslowakischen Provinz; in einem Gebirgsland von ausserordentlicher Armut.

Fast alljährlich spült der Frühjahrsregen die kleinen Felder der Verchovina-Bauern (Verchovina heisst die karpathorussische Hochebene) von den Hängen hinab. Die Felder "wandern" heisst es dann, und der Bauer schleppt nach der Regenzeit seinen Acker buchstäblich auf dem Rücken wieder auf den alten Platz zurück.

Baumschwamm, Baumrinde, Hanfstengel sind Nahrungsmittel; Kartoffel Leckerbissen; Fleisch und Zucker seit dem Krieg unbekannt; ein Bottich Salzwasser oder zwei Pfund Viehsalz kosten einen Tag Holzhacken. Der Hunger fordert immer wieder Handerte und Tausende von Opfern: Kranke, Irre, Tote. Es gibt fast keine Familie, in der nicht ein Wasserkopf oder Zwerg wäre...

Ab und zu schickt das Rote Kreuz ein paar Waggon Lebensmittel; viel häufiger aber sendet die Regierung Gendarmen... denn der Bauer ist nur hungrig und arm, weil der Graf Schönborn noch immer Herr über alle Wälder, Sägewerke und grossen Mühlen ist.

ein sterbefall

Der Tag ging zu Ende.

Man merkte das kaum — so düster war es auch vorher gewesen und so langsam versickerte das wenige Tageslicht im aufgeweichten Boden.

Das Dorf lag unter dem Schleier des Regens stumm, farblos, ohne Bewegung dawie ausgestorben.

Stille, Farblosigkeit und Regen waren erfüllt von unruhiger Erwartung. Sie warteten auf den völligen Einbruch der Dunkelheit, auf das Aufflammen von Licht, auf einen Windstoss, eine Veränderung.

Auch die Menschen warteten.

Die Frauen und Kinder verstreut in den einzelnen Hütten: die Männer alle zusammen in der grössten Hütte des Dorfes, — im "Haus" des Iwan Borkanuk, oben, nicht weit vom Waldrand.

Sie sitzen in der sogenannten "grossen Stube".

Die "grosse Stube" bei Borkanuks sieht nicht viel anders aus als die Stuben in den übrigen Hütten des Dorfes. Die gleichen kahlen

f. c. weiskopf

Wände mit den niedrigen Fenstern, der gleiche hartgestampfte Lehm Fussboden, die gleichen grob gezimmerten Bänke, Pritschen und Tische. Nur zwei grosse, eisenbeschlagene Truhen und ein paar buntbemalte Tonteller auf einem hohen Bord zeigen, dass Iwan Borkanuk nicht so arm ist wie die anderen Bauern. — Und ist die "grosse Stube" hier nicht der einzige Wohnraum der Hütte! Es gibt noch eine "kleine Stube", jenseits des fensterlosen Vorraums, und zwei Kammern! Auch ist das Vieh nicht unter demselben Dach mit den Menschen.

Sie sitzen auf den Bänken, auf den Truhen, auf dem Boden; sie kauen geräuschvoll an steinharten Kräuter- und Maisfladen, an getrocknetem Baumschwamm und erfüllen den Raum mit lautem Geschrei.

Sie streiten darüber, ob es einen Vampir oder ein anderer Geist war, der dem Iwan Borkanuk heute früh begegnet ist.

Der milchige Qualm des vielen, seit dem frühen Morgen gerauchten Kartoffelkrauts steht dick und schwer wie Herbstnebel über den Bauernschädeln mit den verfilzten Haarwuscheln, die vorigjährigen Vogelnestern gleichen.

"Es kann kein Vampir gewesen sein!" sagt Vasil Stifus in einem Ton, der keinen Widerspruch duldet (ganz so wie die Juden unten in der Stadt, wenn sie die Schweinepreise drücken). "Er hat ja nicht gewiehert!"

"Muss er auch nicht!" widerspricht ihm ebenso unfehlbar Mikula Rác, mit dem er schon seit Jahren einen Streit wegen zweier verschwundener Hühner hat. "Fällt ihm gar nicht ein, immer zu wiehern...!"

"Oho!"

"Gar nichts 'oho!' in Herehovisce..."

Und trotz aller Bemühungen des anderen, ihn zu unterbrechen, erzählt er in aller Breite und Ausführlichkeit die Geschichte von dem Herehoviscer Bauern, dem abends auf dem Heimweg von der Hochzeit seiner Grossnichte, ein Vampir auf den Rücken gesprungen ist:

"Der hat auch nicht gewiehert! Wär' auch ein Blödsinn — hat ja ausgesehen wie ein junger Stier! Aber angefühlt hat er sich dabei wie ein Fisch, so glitschig und klebrig..."

"Stier oder Pferd, das ist schon gleich; ein Tier muss es sein!"

Ein paar andere pflichten bei:

"Ja, ja, ein Tier muss es schon sein!"

Aber Rác überschreit sie:

"Unsinn! Was redet ihr da? In Sinevir..."

"Ach was, in Sinevir... Du mit deinen ewigen Geschichten von anderswo..."

"Willst du vielleicht sagen, dass sie nicht wahr sind? Was? Sagd as noch einmal...!"

Die gesträubten Bärte vorgereckt, beginnen sie wüst aufeinander und auf ihre Mütter loszuschimpfen. Die Gesichter werden blaurot und der Speichel fliesst in die Bärte.

Bis endlich jemand dazwischenfährt:

"Haltet das Maul, Bauern, gottverdammte! Man hört ja gar nichts! Eben ist einer hinausgegangen - nachschau'n..."

Von Zeit zu Zeit geht immer einer "nachschau'n". Schwerfällig räkelt er sich hoch und geht hinaus in den dunklen Vorraum, wo man ihn - sobald es still geworden ist - eine Weile heruntappen und dann eine Tür aufstossen hört:

"Na-a, Grossvater?!"

Es ist jedesmal dieselbe Frage, die dort draussen gestellt wird und auch die Antwort ist immer die gleiche:

"Dass dich... Was fragst du? Hältst es wohl nicht mehr aus, was?! Brauchst ja nicht zu warten, du..."

Die Tür fliegt knallend zu und zerquetscht die letzten Worte. Schnell, als müssten sie Versäumtes nachholen, bevor noch der Hinausgegangene zurück ist, beginnen die Bauern weiterzuschimpfen und werden erst wieder still, wenn der nächste nachsehen geht, ob drüben noch immer nichts los ist.

Drüben - das ist die "kleine Stube", jenseits des Vorraums.

Eigentlich ist sie gar nicht kleiner als die "grosse", nur nimmt der mächtige Ofen mit der breiten Schlafstelle oben fast die Hälfte ihres Raumes ein. Deshalb heisst sie "kleine Stube".

Auch die "kleine Stube" ist voller Menschen. Die ganze Familie Borkanuk ist da, sogar der Schwiegersohn aus dem Nachbardorf. Nur die jüngste Tochter Olena fehlt. Sie ist gestern mit dem Karren nach Huszt gefahren und wird erst spät nachts, vielleicht sogar erst morgen früh, wieder zurück sein. Sonst aber sind alle da, Sohn, Schwiegersohn, Vettern, Enkel, Neffen. Auch sie sitzen dicht gedrängt herum, auf den Bänken, auf der Schwelle, auf dem Boden; auch sie kauen an harten Maisfladen und zermahlen getrocknete Baumschwämme - aber sie streiten nicht. Stumm hocken sie da und starren zur Schlafstelle hinauf, wo der alte Iwan Borkanuk unter einem Berg von Lumpen und Säcken liegt.

Er ist heute früh, gleich beim ersten Schritt über die Schwelle

des Hauses, einem Geist begegnet. Tritt er da, noch vor dem Frühstück, hinaus vors Tor, um nachzuschauen, ob es immer noch regnet - und sieht auf einmal: dort auf der kleinen Bank unter dem Fenster sitzt jemand! Irgendein Geduckter, Zusammengeschrumpfter, der aussieht wie... ja, wie nur...?

Ivan Borkanuk steht da, glotzt hinüber:

Angestrengt denkt er nach: wem sieht der Mensch dort nur ähnlich?

Der Geduckte hebt die Hand, macht ein Zeichen. Da erkennt er ihn:

"Heilige Barbara, Grossmartyrerin - der Vater selig!"

Erkennen, kehrtmachen, ins Haus zurückstolpern - ist eins. Im Vorraum bleibt er eine Weile stehen, mit zugeschnürter Kehle, die Beine wie weggemäht unter den Knien. Dann gibt er sich einen Ruck, schüttelt sich und geht in die "kleine Stube". Dort klettert er auf die Schlafstelle und deckt sich mit allem zu, was oben herumliegt.

"Geh die Kinder holen", sagt er zu seinem Sohn Andrej, "sie sollen gleich mal kommen, ich mach's nicht mehr lang... Na, was stierst du mich an? Verstehst nicht? Ich mach's nicht mehr lang hier... ich kratzab, ich...Na, verstehst du denn noch immer nicht?!"

Nein, Andrej mit dem Wasserkopf auf dem viel zu dünnen Hals versteht noch immer nicht. Erst nachdem er die Geschichte von der Begegnung mit dem Geduckten zweimal haarklein erzählt bekommen hat, beginnt es in ihm zu dämmern. Schreiend läuft er die Dorfstrasse hinunter!

"A-a-aaaah, Hilfe! Hilfe! Der Teufel holt ihn! A-a-aaaah, a-a-aaaah...!"

Die Bauern kommen aus den Hütten herausgestolpert; rennen hinauf zur Borkanukhütte.

In der "kleinen Stube" brennt unter dem Heiligenbild in der Ecke eine Kerze. Auf der Ofenschlafstelle liegt - steif, die Hände um ein Kreuz gefaltet, - der alte Borkanuk.

"Wa...?"

Aber nein - er lebt!

Verdutzt stehen sie da, treten von einem Bein auf das andere, schweigen. Auch der Alte oben schweigt.

Endlich spuckt einer aus und sagt:

"Verdammt, Iwan Iwanitsch, was ist denn mit dir los? Willst du vielleicht...?"

Jawohl, das wolle er. Ganz bestimmt.

Sogar heute noch!

Sogar vor Mitternacht noch!

Und er berichtet über das Zusammentreffen mit dem verstorbenen Vater. Uebertreibt dabei - denn er fürchtet in diesem Augenblick ihren Unglauben fast mehr als den Geist, der ihm erschienen ist. An den Gedanken, dass ihn der Teufel holen wird, hat er sich schon einigermassen gewöhnt. Aber dass sie es nicht glauben könnten...

Doch die Bauern hören ernst zu, bekreuzigen sich, pflichten bei:

"Jaja. das ist ein untrügliches Zeichen!"

Dann beschliessen sie, dazubleiben. Ohnehin könne man wegen des Regens im Freien nicht arbeiten und dann...na, kurz und gut...

Da mischt sich der Alte ein:

"Wie? Was? Wie war das: man kann draussen nicht arbeiten und dann... was, dann"?!

"Oh, nichts! So nur..."

Aber Borkanuk hat sie schon durchschaut. Er weiss genau, was sie sich denken ("diese Lumpen!"). Sie denken sich, hoffentlich kratzt der Kerl schnell ab, bevor noch die Verwandten da sind - dann kann man wahrscheinlich etwas mitgehen lassen, Speck oder sonst was: sicher hat er irgendwo etwas versteckt... (Diese Lumpen! Wie sie jetzt schon in der Stube herumschielen...! Na, Gott sei Dank, das Zeug ist zu gut versteckt... und überhaupt soll'n sie sich das Maul abwischen, ohne was gefressen zu haben, diese Lumpenkerle!)"

Er sagt deshalb sehr freundlich - mit einer sanften Rührung in der Stimme:

"Das ist schön von Euch, Bauern, dass ihr dableiben wollt! Das ist sehr schön!"

Die Rührung wird so gross, dass seine Stimme ins Zittern kommt:

"Ich weiss gar nicht..Na, tausend Vergeltsgott einstweilen und die Heiligen werden es euch lohnen!"

Und er beginnt sie nacheinander aufzuzählen: Nikolaus, der Wundertäter, und Barbara, die Grossmartyrerin, und Georg, der Siegbringer, und...

Plötzlich unterbricht er sich:

Da rede er und habe ganz vergessen, dass es vielleicht noch eine hübsche Weile dauern werde bis... das heisst... also: sie würden vielleicht noch ziemlich lang warten müssen; ganz bestimmt sogar! - Ob es da nicht besser wäre... er meine nur... na, kurz und

gut: ob sie da nicht noch vorher einmal nach Hause wollten? Auf einen Sprung nur, sozusagen...?

Die Bauern schauen einander an, bewegen die Schultern, kratzen sich, husten, aber rühren sich nicht von der Stelle. Mikula Rác, der ganz nahe am Ofen, fast unter dem Kopf von Iwan Borkanuk steht, wendet sein Gesicht den anderen zu und grinst vielsagend. ("Aha, raus haben willst du uns! Da hast du dich aber geirrt, Freundchen! Daraus wird nichts!")

Dann sagt er, noch gerührter als Borkanuk:

"i wo denn, Iwan Iwanitsch, wir werden doch nicht...! Auf eine halbe Stunde kommt es uns doch nicht an!"

("Ech, ihr Aaskerle! Eine halbe Stunde...! Na, ihr sollt euch aber schneiden.")

Er muss erst ein paarmal schlucken, bevor die Flüche, die er auf der Zunge hat, hinunter sind. Dann sagt er leise:

"Na, wenn's nur nicht länger dauert?! Aber mir kann's ja schliesslich gleich sein. Setzt euch doch!"

Sie möchten es sich doch bequem machen! Leider könne er ihnen nichts anbieten-nicht einmal etwas zum Rauchen, es sei ein Jammer! - aber dafür werde ihnen die heilige Barbara... ("Sooo, da habt ihr's Fressäcke!")

Die Bauern lassen ihn mit der Aufzählung der Heiligen, die sie für das Nichtrauchen entschädigen sollen, nicht zu Ende kommen:

"Tut nichts, Iwan Iwanitsch, mach dir nur keine Sorgen! Dann rauchen wir eben erst bei der Totenfeier. Da wird's ja sicher was zu Rauchen geben!" ("Soo, da hast du's! Geiziger Ziegenbock!")

Eine Stunde lang messen sie einander mit lauernden Blicken. Nur ab und zu werden ein paar Worte gewechselt:

"Liegst du auch gut, Iwan Iwanitsch?"

"Wird es euch nicht zu lang, Bauern?"

Dann kommt der wasserköpfige Andrej zurück und bringt zwei Vettern und Mihal, den Schwiegersohn, mit. Iwan Iwanitsch hat den Kampf gewonnen! Er setzt sich, ganz lebendig geworden, mit einem Ruck auf und fletscht strahlend die Zähne - so, als ober einen Juden beim Handeln übers Ohr gehauen hätte. Sogar freigebig wird er in seinem Triumph:

"Geh, Andrej, ich hab' mich erinnert - es gibt doch noch etwas zum Rauchen bei uns. Geh, hol' eine Schachtel voll! Du weisst schon wo..."

Andrej geht hinaus und kommt nach einigen Minuten mit einer alten Konservenbüchse zurück:

"So, Bauern", sagt Iwan Iwanitsch, "da ist was für die Pfeifen. Greift nur tüchtig zu! Es ist ja genug da".

Seine trüben, verwaschenen Augen, halb versteckt unter dem Stirnknochen und den schrumpeligen, zu gross gewordenen Lidern, haben aus Schadenfreude etwas Glanz bekommen. In seiner Stimme sitzt das Kichern hinter jedem Wort auf der Lauer.

"Greift nur zu, es ist genug da!"

Jetzt sind es die Bauern, die zuerst ein paar Flüche hinunter-schlucken müssen bevor ihnen ein halbwegs verständliches "Vergeltsgott" gelingt. Dafür greifen aber so gründlich zu, dass in der Büchse nichts übrig-bleibt. Aber das verdirbt dem Alten nicht die Siegesfreude. Ganz im Gegenteil, er trumpft sogar auf. Andrej muss eine zweite Büchse voll "Kraut" holen und den Bauern auf den Tisch stellen - drüben, in der "grossen Stube", denn in der kleinen wird es allmählich zu eng, weil jetzt die Verwandten, einer nach dem andern, ankommen.

Die Bauern schieben sich in die "grosse Stube" hinüber. Eigentlich könnten sie jetzt ruhig nach Hause gehen, denn zu versäumen gibt es ja nichts mehr und überhaupt... Aber das tun sie nun gerade nicht. Der Alte soll sehen, dass auch sie verdammt hatte Schädel haben!

Sie bleiben also und schicken nur die paar Burschen, die ihren Vätern nachgekommen sind, ins Dorf hinunter: sie sollen den Frauen Bescheid sagen und etwas zu essen holen. ("Mit etwas Essbarem rückt der Geizkragen ja doch nicht heraus").

Dann machen sie es sich so bequem wie möglich:

"Weiss der Teufel, wie lang so etwas dauern kann!!"

Sie kommen zu dem Schluss, dass man sich auf ein langes Warten gefasst machen müsse.

"Iwan Iwanitsch ist ein verflucht zäher Knochen...!"

Sie qualmen.

Die Burschen kommen zurück, bringen Fladen und getrocknete Baumschwämme mit. Gierig machen sich die Bauern darüber her.

Dann rauchen sie wieder: sprechen über das Wetter und über Iwan Iwanitsch. Später beginnen sie zu streiten.

Zäh und träge wie ein dunkler Harztropfen rinnt die Zeit.

Es wird Mittag - Abend.

Iwan Iwanitsch liegt steif und starr auf seiner Schlafstelle und hat die Hände um ein Kruzifix gefaltet.

Er denkt nach:

"Es ist gut, dass Andrej und Mihal rechtzeitig gekommen sind! Die Kerls drüben sind ja..."

(Wie die Wölfe im Frühjahr sind sie! Man wird verflucht scharf aufpassen müssen dass sie nichts klauen --- nachher, bei der Switschina...!)*

Verdammt! Da plagt und plagt man sich mit den Schweinen, gönnt sich selbst keinen Bissen Fleisch und denkt nur immer: na, wenigstens hast du später was davon, wenn du zwei Schweine mätest; eins langt ohnehin nur für die Steuer und das Bisschen Petroleum, aber zwei, zwei langen auch noch für ein Paar neue Lederstiefel mit Hufeisen auf den Absätzen...!

Na, und dann - krach! - kommt einem plötzlich so eine dumme Sache dazwischen und man muss das eine Schwein für die Switschina abstecken, statt Stiefel dafür zu kaufen...!

Und dabei sind die alten Stiefel schon ganz durch!

Aber was?! - Hol der Teufel die Stiefel! Schliesslich und endlich brauch ich sie ja nicht mehr. Aber darum geht es auch gar nicht! Meinetwegen soll das Schwein flöten gehn - wenn nur das andere beisammen bleibt, die Kuh und die Vorräte und überhaupt...

Aber das ist es ja eben! Der Mihal hat eine leichte Ader, besonders wenn's nicht um sein Geld geht. Und das Mädchen, die Olena, stellt auch manchmal ganz verrückte Dinge an, und Andrej mit seinem Wasserkopf ist auch nicht der Richtige - es ist ein Kreuz mit den Kindern..!

Ja, wenn sie es wenigstens für sich selbst...! Aber so werden die andern fett davon..."

Bei diesem Gedanken wird er ganz wütend und beginnt unruhig hin und her zu rutschen.

"Was ist, Iwan Iwanitsch? Schon?" fragen die unten und treten an den Ofen heran.

Er knurrt sie an:

"Nichts! Gar nichts! Noch lange nicht!" - Sie sollten ihn in Ruhe lassen und sich vom Ofen fortscheren!

Sie setzen sich wieder und er denkt weiter nach:

"Wer weiss übrigens? Vielleicht lässt sich doch etwas tun? Zwar - um die Switschina wird nicht gut heranzukommen sein, wenn's auch der pure Leichtsinn ist... aber möglicherweise lässt es sich ohne Schwein abtun...? Mit ein paar Hennen zum Beispiel. Da ist die gesprenkelte, die nicht mehr recht legen will, und die weisse und..."

* Switschina - Totenfeier.

f. c. weiskopf

Aber das wird ja nicht gehen! Das werden die Kinder nicht machen wollen.

Und dann: wenn man schon das grösste Haus im Dorf hat, muss man auch...

"Was muss man?! Was muss man?! Verdammtes Hatz!"

Er wird wieder ganz wütend und muss den Körper, der sich abermals hin und her werfen will, mit Gewalt steif halten.

Endlich beruhigt er sich ein wenig:

"Na, da kann man eben nichts machen!"

Uebrigens - ihm kann es ja gleich sein, er sieht es ohnehin nicht mehr mit an...! aber immerhin, es ist doch schade um das Schwein, wenn es auch nur, selbstverständlich, das kleinere ist!

Ein paar Augenblicke lang überlässt er sich einer milden Trauer. Dann fährt es ihm plötzlich durch den Kopf:

"Das Schwein - gut! Aber was, wenn die Steuerbeamten unten in der Stadt Wind davon bekommen, dass er gestorben ist!"

Ganz kalt wird ihm bei diesem Gedanken, denn er erinnert sich, dass in Zbun neulich die Finanzer gekommen sind, kaum dass der Bauer tot war, und das Vieh weggetrieben haben: Erbschaftsteuer!

"Was, wenn die unten schon davon Wind bekommen haben und..."

Kälte presst ihm den Verstand so zusammen, dass er den Gedanken gar nicht zu Ende denken kann.

Das Vieh weg? Die Kuh? - Die einzige Kuh im ganzen Dorf!

Es verschlägt ihm den Atem.

Kuechend liegt er da und horcht hinaus. Rasselt es draussen nicht, als ob ein Wagen...?

Er drückt die Hände mit aller Kraft an die Schläfen, damit das Hämmern aufhört, dass ihn am deutlichen Hören hindert.

Da!

Ja...!

Wirklich!

Das Rasseln eines Wagens ist zu hören. Er ist noch ein gutes Stück entfernt, aber er kommt näher!

Mit einer jähen Bewegung setzt sich Iwan Iwanitsch auf. Die Verwandten springen hoch, drängen sich an ihn heran:

"Iwan Iwanitsch...! Alle Heiligen...!"

Die Tür wird aufgestossen, die Bauern aus der "grossen Stube" drängen sich herein.

norman macleod

"Heiliger Nikolaus, Wundertäter, bitt für ihn! Heiliger Georg, Siegbringer, bitt für ihn...!"

"Kusch!" schreit Iwan Iwanitsch erbost dazwischen, "haltet eure schmutzigen Mäuler!"

Sie prallen zurück.

Einen Augenblick lang ist es ganz still. Das Gerassel eines heranfahrenden Wagens wird deutlich hörbar.

"Da - sie kommen! Schafft das Vieh fort! Lasst mich hinaus!"

Und bevor sie noch ihr verdattertes "Wa-a-as?" hervorstottern können, ist er vom Ofen hinunter und drückt sich durch sie hindurch.

Sie wollen ihn aufhalten, aber er stösst ihre Hände zurück und drängt sich weiter vorwärts:

"Weg! Platz! Hört ihr denn nicht?! Steht nicht da wie die Klötze! - Die Finanzer kommen...! Das Vieh holen!"

Sie verstehen nicht und bleiben ihm - immer noch mit offenen Mündern und herausgekugelten Augen - im Weg stehen.

Da packt er die nächsten an den Schultern und schreit:

"Hinaus! Weg! Was steht ihr überhaupt, noch da?! Macht, dass ihr hinauskommt! Es wird nicht gestorben...!"

norman macleod

aus der jemez *

Weizen-blätter in einer gelben Dämmerung gemalt,
bronzen gegen den harten Wind,
der Weizen runzelt - - -

und die Erde trocken als Zeit in knorrigem Wetter.

Die Sonne wird in ihr' orangen Zirkel gehen,
und die Hügel werden auf die Ebene kriechen,
aber der Wind führt ein weites Geschrei

in die regungslosen Jahre,
die Jemez decken werden - - -

Und Weizen-blätter alle gelben.

(Uebersetzt von donal mckenzie)

* Anmerkung des Uebersetzers: Jemez heisst eine Region der wüsten Hochebene Neu Mexicos, U. S. A.

fernand jouan

**francis andré
paysan et poète**

Je sais un paysan quelquepart, dans les champs,
qui rêve quelquefois derrière sa charrue
à ses frères sans nombre, à la vie inconnue...

C'est Augustin Habaru, il y a trois ans, qui nous révéla sa présence "aux confins des Ardennes et de la Lorraine, dans un petit village d'une centaine d'habitants".

Et c'est Jean Tousseul, au début de cette année, qui nous donna le nom du hameau : FRATIN.

Entretiens, Francis André avait publié une plaquette de vers "Poèmes Paysans" (1) et des critiques, des romanciers, des poètes dit leur étonnement, leur joie, leurs espoirs, leur admiration aussi.

Nous achetâmes donc le petit bouquin et, du coup, nous fûmes littéralement "pris". - Nous étions en présence d'une poésie qui rendait un son que nous n'avions entendu qu'une fois ou deux jusqu'ici et notamment en Amérique, chez Walt Whitman.

Ohé! mes compagnons, mes autres compagnons,
Ohé! les bûcherons, les terrassiers, les vagabonds,
Ohé! vous qui buvez quelque part dans le monde,
Dans les tavernes, dans les chaumières,
Ohé! mes compagnons sans nombre,
Venez! je me sens plein de folie et d'amour.
Venez! je vois là-bas, là-bas d'où vient le jour,
Je vois monter vers nous, là-bas,
Un verre pour la soif de tous un verre immense!
Venez! nous briserons nos sales petits verres
Et nous boirons ensemble dans ce grand verre
Plein de goutte claire et de lumière
Qui vient de se poser sur la table du monde.

L'homme qui lança ce cri, un soir d'ivresse, du fond des Ardennes, n'est-il pas digne du géant newyorkais, lorsque celui-ci, par delà les Océans, nous envoya son "Appel au Monde"?

(1) Les Ecrivains réunis à Paris.

fernand jouan

Il nous faut remonter à une dizaine d'années, à l'époque (1917) où Jean Tousseul publia ses premières nouvelles pour rencontrer en Belgique tout au moins, un joyau littéraire semblable aux "Poèmes Paysans". - Si Jean Tousseul médita les pages étonnantes qu'il dédia aux pauvres gens de la vallée mosane en cassant des pierres "sous les hautes roches de son village", Francis André composa ses poèmes dans la plaine, face au soleil, en poussant sa charrue, parmi les paysans, ses pairs. - Car le poète est un paysan, non pas un de ces gentilhommes campagnards à la Francis Jammes, mais un solide gars qui cultive lui-même ses quinze hectares de terre, qui abat lui-même, de sa rude cognée les chênes nouveaux qui le préserveront, lui et les siens, des rigueurs de l'hiver ardennais, un homme qui communie, chaque jour avec la terre sur laquelle il vit, dont il vit, dont il comprend l'âme pathétique et sereine, dont il perçoit les moindres murmures.

Ecoutez comme il chante la plaine, la "belle plaine dorée" et son légitime orgueil de producteur :

Oui, c'est nous qui t'avons créée, belle plaine dorée,
Belle plaine mouvante, ensoleillée, vivante,
Qui déborde de nous, qui ondoie et qui chante!
C'est nous, ce sont nos mains, nos corps, nos coeurs fidèles
Qui ont lutté pour toi, qui ont veillé sur toi,
Et qui t'ont dégagée de l'hiver et des brumes.
C'est de nous que tu es sortie, de notre amour
Et du soleil qui s'est mêlé à nos efforts.
Pour te donner le sang, le souffle de la vie.
Oui, c'est nous qui t'avons créée, belle plaine mouvante,
Et notre orgueil est grand et puissant devant toi,
Et tous les chants, toutes les joies qui sont en toi
C'est notre joie à nous c'est notre triomphe!

Mais que vieune l'automne, que se dénude la plaine, que s'entassent, dans les fenils, les granges et les caves, les foin, les moissons, les récoltes, l'homme se sent triste. - Il soliloque :

Tu as travaillé dur tout au long de l'année,
portant le soleil sur tes reins, terrassant
avec tes genoux et tes mains, la glèbe.
Tu as travaillé de toutes tes forces,
avec ton cheval, ton boeuf, ta charrue,
petit paysan, sur ton coin de terre.

fernand jouan

.

Tu as bien travaillé, pour toi et pour les hommes
Tu as battu ton seigle, engraisé ton vieux boeuf
Et voici que déjà rodent autour de toi
Autour de ton labeur, de ton blé, de tes bêtes,
les trafiquants, les juifs rapaces, les marchands...
Voici, comme un vol noir sur les glèbes d'automne,
Les corbeaux sur ton champ, ta maisonet ton coeur...

Le pittoresque campagnard n'existe pas ici : il fait partie intégrante de la vie du poète qui ne le remarque même pas. - Mais les gens et les bêtes, le soleil, les nauges, le vent, les arbres, la forêt et toutes les choses qui peuplent l'horizon du cultivateur qui lutte avec la glèbe apparaissent en des strophes graves religieuses, où le Travail, l'Effort, la Miséricorde sont portés à la hauteur d'un Credo.

Nous pourrions multiplier les citations - les 23 poèmes qui composent le livre seraient à citer - et montrer le sens cosmique de cette poésie à résonnances uniques qui plonge ses racines au plus profond de l'âme paysanne. - Mais Francis André, le tout premier, rirait bien de nos savantés autant qu'inutiles explications, car cet isolé, si naturellement universel réalise, d'instinct, ce que Stéphan Zweig appelle "la loi profonde de l'harmonie que chacun de nous doit établir entre soi-même et le paysage pour pénétrer entièrement la nature et le monde."

Un dimanche d'août torride, nous sommes venu frapper à la porte de l'écrivain. L'homme qui ne nous connaissait pas, qui ne nous avait jamais vu, nous ouvrit bien grande sa maison et son coeur. - L'accueil qu'il nous réserva nous paya largement des fatigues qu'un voyage de 175 Km. en vélo, à travers les Ardennes nous avait valu.

Nous vécûmes trois jours sous son toit - qu'il restaurait lui-même, comme Bazalgette - au milieu des siens, dans une atmosphère de belle, saine, de franche camaraderie. - Pendant trois jours tant bien que mal - et plutôt mal que bien, quoique nous soyons un campagnard que la faim chassa au pays des usines voilà quelque vingt ans - nous partageâmes son rude labeur dans la plaine, sous le soleil flamboyant. - Nous connûmes aussi les gens les bêtes et les choses chantées par le poète : Son vieux père de septante ans "que la terre aimée, penche vers elle, un peu plus chaque jour"; sa mère "vieille femme au corps lourd comme un chêne, au visage ridé comme un labour d'automne"; la campagne cultivée qui quitta

constant de horizon

la grande ville cosmopolite pour partager la vie fruste et laborieuse qui donne le pain aux hommes; un amour de gosse et Mirette, le vieux cheval et Boudha, le bon chien, et les plaines, les forêts et tous les paysans avec qui, le dimanche soir, nous jouâmes aux quilles et bûmes la goutte "la bonne goutte rude qui balaye, comme un flot, le temps lourd hors du coeur".

Nous vécûmes là-bas trois jours qui nous rappellent délicieusement la beauté de notre petite enfance, trois jours dont le souvenir illumine encore l'atmosphère fumeuse de notre banlieue industrielle, trois jours pendant lesquels nous côtoyâmes un vrai poète, un brave homme et des braves gens.

constant de horizon

pluie

Il pleut...
Un grillage gris perle
se désarticule
en virgules
devant la fenêtre.

Trois séminaristes passent;
trois parapluies aussi,
sur des visages boutonneux.

Philosophie et commérages.
Ils sont vacances,
noirs comme le temps.
Parlent-ils en cadence
de la bonté du Dieu vivant ?

Sur le trottoir d'en face,
une femme passe
et glisse,
perverse,
sous l'averse
des yeux en coulisse...

Ni la pluie ni la robe ne servent la morale...

georges linze

poèmes

1.

Les villes approchent
une à une
comme tirée par leur horloge
- hélice lente -

Les vitres des magasins
sont d'étranges glaciers.

La machine sinue
dans avenir des tournants

sonde du vent
proue de vitesse
commencement de prophétie.

Avions autos
tueurs d'hirondelles
Ah! Ah! Ah!
simple pressentiment.

2.

Chaque mort
laisse l'univers
figé et sans visage.

La marée à beau presser
tendrement
les côtes

nos machines
franchir les nuages

les enfants
pendent
comme du lest

et l'on voit très bien
que le temps
est la tristesse
des arbres des maisons et des pierres.

eric b. hurel

3.

Caresse des avions
sur le ciel incliné.

La tendresse des maisons
arrive
en ondes douces.

Ce jour,
la vitesse purifie.

L'espace, sur notre vie,
glisse
automatique

et
les constellations
résumées
chauffent nos bibelots.

eric b. hurel

masque

Béant d'orgueil: être immuable et triste
un masque exale ses trois mauvais rêves
du bois une table au fond d'un tunnel
un oeil en verte de gris l'autre bleu pâle
et sa ficelle prête à pendre au clou
se tordait de ces désirs de la nuit.
Vide de passions, voire incorruptible
pourtant peut-être encore habité d'ombres
d'inessentiel et de regrets furtifs
du jeune passé d'un acteur enfui
il efforce sa voix sa cave chair
sa voix éteinte et l'ancienne grimace.
Il a bu le silence il est il fut
ses yeux perdus au mur horizontal.

forrest anderson

évènement aride

départ pour cela de ceux d'en bas
l'absence se nomme autrement
les noms ne font qu'un
mais ce que j'envoie pleure
de l'ombre une larme pour
couler au travers du branchage
innombrable un cil
délimite la mer les
jeuneaux ont du être
autre chose trois
dans une chambre était deux
était un personne de
ou sur cette chère chair
dont je me sers

frappez bas les mains - - - serrez les pendant que
rôdent des perspectives aussi violentes que vertes

il est un île, un monstre sensible auquel
la bonté donne l'assaut o vous
n'auriez jamais pu entraîner ainsi un matelot
s'il eut été en mer.

commentary

mike and other phenomena

There is nothing for the working man to do but organize and get the best terms he can. "There is no use bothering him with intellectual subtleties."

There is comparatively little sense in dilettante writers, sitting on the communette fringe, trying to pretend they are honest (or dishonest) working men.

If a writer is in fact a communist or syndicalist the obvious course for him is to organize *in his own syndicat* and attend to the affairs which concern writing as a function necessary to the concourse or aggregate of syndicates or the state.

There are certain topics which it is probably inexpedient to discuss in a workingman's paper. The plebs obviously has to supply the force and that force can probably best be supplied by conviction untempered with any uncertainty as to its direction (even if it doesn't know what the direction is).

I can not however believe it does any good to ANYone to feed the working man on bogie stories.

The intelligentsia has functioned in and before every revolution as an indispensable part of revolution. I doubt if it has ever functioned enough. If it had functioned more the word "revolution" wd. not now be so often used as a synonym for mere explosion.

Whatever benefits have accrued from the french revolution are due more to Voltaire than to Marat.

Whatever has been constructive in recent Russian history is due to Lenin's lucidity and not to Trotsky's rhetoric. No revolutionary movement has ever had enough intellect, let alone too much.

I do not believe that communism in America lies within the field of practical politics or that there is a "communist menace".

Until further proof is exhibited I shall continue to believe the American communette is incapable of running a government or a button factory or the sewage system or milk distribution of any town over 130,000 (say one hundred and thirty thousand) or any other number of inhabitants.

Hence my suggestion to Mr Gold, and such writers on the New Masses staff as have never carried a hod, and who have always had larger incomes than I have, that they shd. study a little more economics, and history and take a keener interest in current events before turning to the metaphysics and theology of their doctrines.

ezra pound

I can not believe that a more accurate and contemporary knowledge of current events, and a more searching analysis of same wd. do any harm either to that group of writers or to any group of writers or to the future working man in America or elsewhere or the present or past workin.. etc....

I have yet to see any adequate proof that the American "reds" have made any adequate study (or miraculously attained any adequate understanding) of contemporary economics.

I am not saying this behind Mr Gold's back. I trust the readers of *morada* read the New Masses. I have never yet seen an issue of it that did not contain something worth reading.

Mr Gold's "Jews without Money" is a distinct contribution to "the subject". Whether other authors succeed in lowering the tales of the "pore" to the level or nearly to the level of Harper-Scribner sob-stuff must be left to individual analysis. Mr Gold is infinitely better at realism about New York, which he knows, than in legends from Italy.

I think his paper wd. be more useful if it included a little simple economic instruction for his readers, re/the "problems" of credit power, credit distribution etc.

I can not see that a technical question as to whether the people be represented on geographic basis or on basis of unity of the product is a fundamental issue. Admitting that American democracy, starting in largely agricultural country, still uses a geographic basis, it can still be argued that an industrial community in which the industrial population (workers) *understood* anything whatever about economics would succeed in getting representatives into legislatures and into congress who wd. represent their interests. The trouble is, in great part, simple ignorance.

I do not believe that Lenin working in the U.S.A. wd. have proceeded in the same way that he proceeded against Czardom.

So far as the facts are available Lenin seems to have been an opportunist *with convictions*.

This type is the most effective. The convictionist without perceptions has perhaps less effect on events.

If a man does not intend to have some effect on events he had better stay at home and do plain sewing or fancy embroidery.

It is my firm conviction that the state can not exist without good literature. Good literature can however exist without the state, the writer may waste a good deal of time being annoyed with sonzofbitches, fools, knaves; Wilsons, Hardings, Coolidges, Smoots, snoots etc. but he may do a good job in between times.

ezra pound

The state goes to hell when the language gets wholly into the hands of such people, when the language is made a mess and no word retains a clear meaning.

///

Everybody, even Mr Morgan and Mr Stalin ought occasionally to read something they disagree with.

A factional paper (the New Masses is a factional paper, so is the very mild "new freeman" etc.) ought not only to have in its editorial office, but ought to manifest a clear knowledge of which of its beliefs belongs to its faction *alone* and which of its beliefs are held by the more intelligent men in all or in most other parties.

The last man I heard say anything about the evils of capitalism was a banker. He thought the Carnegie Endowment for Peace was an evil because it was a lien on workers.

I thought it wd. be justified if Nik Butler and co made some attempt to apply the proceeds to what Andy intended.

Research into the causes of war could be useful. It wd. employ not philologists but bright eyed chaps who cd. keep an eye on daily commerce and profits in specific and general war-goods, and so forth.

Concentration of capital is highly useful. Any party that does not recognize this fact is merely playing ostrich. In any simple democracy there is no reason why some sense of responsibility shd. not attach to those controlling a community's credit. The detail of mechanism and official title of the controllers is not the fundamental issue.

In the end it will depend on whether the Rat or the commissar or the senator or the director knows how to apply the credits at his disposal, and how to get credit in general distributed.

All this means a lot more brain work and is in general more tedious than running out yelling "SLOBODA FOR THE FISHES!"

There is to my mind no particular advantage in ascribing to Marx and Trotsky certain ideas already clearly presented by Thos. Jefferson, Adam Smith or Tom Paine.

Yes, our university system is mouldy. I have heard that the endowment of what used to be (and may be still) a fashionable ladies' college is contingent on their supporting the doctrine of protective tariff, etc. There is little effort to get active minds into college faculties. There are amiable and unamiable professors but the poor dears dont in most cases know anything about thought and in the language of I think Cervantes, you can not confer what you aint got. (aint equals are not, the purist wd. suggest here the phrase "aint got of")

ezra pound

Mr Gold, by the way, fails to dissociate a contempt for humanity from a radical disbelief that any vast mass of people will spontaneously combust into a perfectly ordered utopia, i.e. a certain scepticism as to the intensity and lucidity of the mass mind.

A people that lets an excellent system of government go to hell as the believers in Wilson, Harding and Coolidge have, lying flat on its belly and oozing flattery for these three nincompoops is not in condition to make a new better system ab initio.

(In America this crime has not been spread over a period of centuries, it has been done in the last twenty or 25 years, by the single generation of men, from 15 to 25 years older than I am, who have held the power through that slobbery period.)

The communist party in America small as it is is certainly to be prized above rubies and above Argentine bonds; it at any rate believes something better could exist and is vociferously aware of certain defects in the general organism.

Certain defects in its ideation cd. be ameliorated by use of C. H. Douglas and Veblen. You do not use an author by swallowing all of his doctrines in a lump. If you get six clear dissociations of ideas from sixty authors you are highly favoured by fortune.

Mr Shaw is quoted by the N.M. as saying that Marx made a man of him. The demonstration is lacking. Personally I shd. never have blamed Marx for the result by whatever title you call it. (We suppose it's like the prayers for the Prince of Wales).

///

The american university is of small use to contemporary thought. It keeps a lot of nice boys out of the labour market but this is not an ultimate good.

The intellectual business of the next thirty years may have to be done by pamphlet.

The greatest material obstacle to mental life in America is publishers' overhead.

The American publisher expects to keep up palatial offices on Fifth Ave and to support fat family and forty employees on proceeds of a few books. European publishers often issue their stuff from one room or from the print shop.

Difference of being able to print for 25 cents WHEN a few hundred people are ready, or of waiting till five thousand are ready to pay three dollars.

The net result is that America is twenty years behind Europe in every branch of thought save those expressed, often quite ably, by our dear friend Henry Ford.

ezra pound

Mr Ford is one of the very few american revolutionaries that excites any interest or respect in new Russia.

///

In a perfectly governed state there wd. be some effort to ascertain how much work was needed for the general comfort, and to distribute this work among all those capable of performing it.

Certain weekly papers wd. be more interesting if they printed a few statements re/ what work actually needs doing in America.

I am profoundly ignorant on this subject, save in so far as it concerns American mental operations. American mind seems to be working at about 3% of efficiency.

I believe that some city streets need sweeping and that in certain districts the housing problem etc....

Apart from distributing work and credit I shd. be grateful to Mr Gold for a clear statement of the aims of his party. Why, for example, is the dictatorship of an oligarchy of unskilled "workers" to be preferred to the dictatorship of any other oligarchy?

I dont even wish to imply that this question is unanswerable.

I shd. be happy to induce Mr Gold's "circle" to think, because I believe they are much more likely to think than any other crowd in America.

If whatever I value in civilization can not be given to the strata of the intelligentsia that is next to the bread line it will certainly go to hell, I mean it will be left as mere dust and museum pieces.

ezra pound

P.S. As to "prohibition", it may have been designed by fanatics but apart from every other abomination connected with it it has been favoured by scoundrels for the express purpose of gaining time and preventing thought about economics and the abuses under which labour suffers.

e. p.

solon r. barber

mexican notes

Let me tell you. I cannot write about this country as a traveling salesman would write home to the little woman in Grand Rapids. I cannot write about this country as the American schoolteacher taking a summer course at the National University would write home to her principal and her friend who teaches the 4th. grade. I am not interested in the friends of traveling salesmen and gradeschool teachers. I am interested in another side of the Mexican land. I am interested, just now, in Mexican street types and the way the people take their pleasure. I am interested in the bullring and the cockfights and the dancehalls.

I wish some of our Nordic painters would go down below the Rio Grande and put this country on canvas with colors as stubborn and flashy and strong as the colors of Mexico are! I wish they would paint those Indians, those beggars, those dancehall girls, those bulls and *toreros*. I would like to see what the salesmen and the schoolteachers would say when they saw the picture of the old legless leper begging for a *centavo*, or the blind boy playing his guitar and singing lovesongs at the side of the railroad track in a little Indian village 40 miles out of Mexico City.

I like to spend hours watching the people in the streets. These Mexicans build their houses flush with the street so they will not waste any time getting out into the streets. Their houses sell themselves cheap to the *calles*. Are they a very lonely people that they are so afraid of being alone?

The artartist raves about his "types". Here are these "types", all marked and labeled and classified. Exhibit A-- the old man sitting against a column of a *portale* selling little wax figures of the *Christo*. Exhibit B--- the big *ranchero* with the big *sombrero* riding into town for a night with the *senoritas*. Exhibit C--- the poor. O God, the Poor! Let us all get hot about the poor. Let us all talk at once--- until the cops break down the door. Hell. The Mexicans treat their beggars realistically. They actually give them something. The Nordics appoint a commission to do something about it. But when the commission desires to make a report, the Senate and the House suppress it.

I sat one early summer morning on a chair tilted back against the wall of a *cantina* in *Calle San Juan de Letran* in Mexico City and puffed a long, brown, cheap, native cigar. I sat there and thought about these people. The street was eternally alive with people--- those vital, colorful people who make Mexico City the most exciting city in the world. And if I could paint, I would have put down in black and white and steelblue the tall Indian in the white shirt, stiff,

solon r. barber

black *sombrero*, black *sarape*, who stood on a corner for 10 minutes without moving a muscle studying a picture of "We" Lindbergh, the "Lone Eagle". "Lone Eagle" hell!-- he was the "Lone Eagle". Four hundred years of exploitation by the Spaniards, the creoles, the rotten aristocracy of Mexico, by the *Gringos* had not got the better of him. He was a rawhide quirt, he was a steelpointed arrow, he was a grim, polished pistol blue with the promise of sudden death. He didn't spend his time psychoanalyzing himself. He knew what he wanted and he took it-- when he could.

The little leathery Aztec women were endlessly passing with tireless, nervous, quick trots. Some of them were worn out with age, disease, hunger, or childbearing, but not all. Mexicans from the *haciendas*, with pink shirts, yellow ties, and oversize straw hats or immense grey or black felt *sombreros*. Little brown and yellow and black fellows under their hats as tall as a mountain peak. Spoiled, decadent Mexican pimps, young men of the streets and the bordelos, the barrooms and the clubs. A big, blond German smoking a cigar, so obviously satisfied with himself that I wanted to tap him on the shoulder and say, "I congratulate you, sir". A couple of Americans pass. "Goddamn it, Fred, I don't want to leave this here Mexico City. Greatest little old city in the world, outside of Kansas City. Say, you remember that blond in Butch's place?" A slender little brown girl in a golden dress. Her eyes were like blobs of black paint high on her cheeks. A beautiful little thing, as delicate as one of those Mexican jonquils or a pale blue morningglory. Her precise little breasts were 2 lyrics by Altamiron. An old woman in black, wearing a flowing black veil, carrying a cluster of white carnations. A group of Mexicans from the ranches, reminiscent of the crisp words of rifles fired in gold-blue sunlight. Mexican women, made for bearing children, widehipped, heavy-breasted, full-lipped. And always the men kept coming on: urgent as commands, proud, alert, Mexican eagles. A people of a thousand urges and a million dreams. A people who will be hard to conquer.

They know how to live. Take the 3 beggars, old as the hills, that I saw every morning from my window. I would give them a few cents. The blind old man played a wrecked concertina. The somewhat younger blind woman held the ragged hat. The grey, tottering, old woman--- the only one of the trio who could see--- led them through the streets, to their little square of pavement where they sat all 3 in a row near the door of a saloon. The price of a few drinks in that place would keep them alive for a week. I see them crossing the street: the fagged, fragile old woman leading them like blind sheep. They walk one behind the other, holding to each others' arms. She takes a long time to decide whether to take a chance with the traffic or not. They seem to think that there is plenty of time when every tick of the clock sounds to me like tolling bells over

solon r. barber

a graveyard. Plenty of time, though, to sit in the street and wait for the big copper Mex. pennies to plop into the old hat. It's what they call *lo flamenco* down there and in the gypsy country of Spain. And children are scarcely weaned from their mothers' breasts before they must be suckled by hunger. They beg, sell lottery tickets, work when they can. They sell *dulces*, *phosphoros*, *puros*, *cigarros*. Their streets run to life like the hot blood spurting through arteries. You can't talk about this coolly, over a mint julep. I tell you, you can't write about Mexico as you would write about chamber music. This is life spouting hot and keen from the fiery, tossing fountain that feeds the world. This is the original spawn--- they don't know what it's about, and they don't give a damn. It's plenty to be alive. Take the grinning brown girls who stand all day in the dark hutches of the *Zocalo* and endlessly pat, pat, pat the flat *tortillas*. So don't expect me to talk about the pretty parks of Mexico City, the rich *Paseo de la Reforma* and its bronze statues, the swell cafes: *El Rhin*, *El Globo*, and the hundred more.

I tell you I am not interested in the American Colony when I remember the girl in the green dress one night at the second-class cabaret. I was sitting at a table near a window, smoking a *Monte Carlo*. It was still early, about 10:30 p. m. Not so many patrons there at the time. Just a few of us, just a few dark heads above the tables, when this green girl burst into the room--- said, "*buenas noches*", to the hatcheck girl and the cops standing near the door--- and went into the room marked "*senoritas*" to leave her hat and coat. She was one of the regular employees of the place. She worked there, danced, and that was her life and her place in life, she would get plenty of dances before the night was over. Then she came out and looked down the long dance-floor. And her chin snapped into the air and she took a long drag of the air like a Thoroughbred on the track. She laughed out loud. She walked down the dancefloor laughing. She stopped halfway down and stamped her foot and blurted out a big, strong HUH! This was her life. This was her place. This was her game. The music struck up one of those strange, staccato, Spanish dances you never hear played right north of the Rio Grande and our friend in the green dress was dancing.

And pretty soon I was buying *anis* for a Mexican girl with eyes like the waters of those black lakes they have in the craters down there. Her hair was very black and smelled of oranges. She could dance and she could drink. She drank a bacardi, a cognac, and 2 bottles of *Carta Blanca* and didn't show it by so much as a slipped word.

solon r. barber

a review

Unrest, the Rebel Poets' Anthology for 1930, edited with an introduction by Ralph Cheyney and Jack Conroy. "Studies Publications" (U.S.A.), 224 West Pacemont Rd., Columbus, Ohio. U. S. A. \$ 1.00

The American mind, swaddled in prejudice, comfortably bathed with the sweet oil of conformity, is monstrously restricted in its ability of comprehending a new therefore, dangerous, idea. Capitalism has benignantly played the part of wet nurse, ministering unto wails of pain and bewilderment, with the sweet oil of a prostitute press, literature directly or indirectly interested in the maintenance of the status quo, religion, and safe educational institutions. The infant has fallen for this christian science treatment, and with an amazing celerity, has accepted the fact that America is prosperous, that unemployment, starvation, the shooting of pickets and jailing of communists, are but imaginary pains. To this end, literature has played its not at all insignificant part. Even our so-called honest literature is basically but the substitution of individualistic aches and tremors for the more dangerous economic pains more and more certainly following in the trail of a capitalism developed to a dangerous point. In other words, we have become oriental mystics, contemplating navels of individualistic pain chiefly to forget our non-importance as individualists and the primary basic importance of economics. To penetrate into this mass-mind fixedly following its set orbit, is by no means an easy task, but it is being done on several fronts. To the proletarian artist, however, the most difficult task has been given that of making the mass mind aware of communism, revolt, labor quietly and desperately forging the links of a new social order to blossom over this tortured earth. It is being done in fiction, and it is being done in poetry. The present collection, astonishingly superior to its predecessor of 1929, is gratifyingly successful. In this book you have no single form of poetry, no attempt to found a school of new form with an old content, but an attempt to introduce a comparatively new content in many forms, which is far more important to a healthy condition of literature than a mere abortive childish play with technique. The poetry included maintains a quite consistent revolutionary ardor, and nearly all of it is informed by a proletarian ideology. The excellence of the poems, of course, varies, but is on the whole, of a very good average, with several striking poems. Most of the contributors to the 1929 collection are included with, if anything, better poetry, and several new poets are introduced. It is especially interesting and important, however, to remember that the bulk of the poetry has been written by proletarians, by clerks, waiters, farmers, hoboes, carpenters, autoworkers, lumberworkers, and others of that vast army "snuffing at the garbage-pails" of the rich, which is indicative of a future literature which we may well call proletarian.

anthonie donker

neue lyrik in holland

Die holländischen Künstler waren von jeher Maler und Lyriker. Sie sind es auch heute noch. Seit etwa 1880, als späte Wellen der Romantik an diese Küste schlugen, und die holländische Dichtung sich vollkommen erneuerte, bis jetzt hat sich hier die Lyrik, währenddem man sich seit dem Krieg überall in der Welt einigermaßen von ihr zu entfernen schien, fortwährend auf der gleichen Höhe behauptet. Um so merkwürdiger ist das, weil in Uebrigen unsere Literatur gar nicht gleichen Schritt mit dieser edlen Lyrik zu halten vermochte. Der Roman behielt hier einen zu lokalen Charakter, verrostete zum Teil auch in einem alten, beschränkten psychologischen Realismus, und erst in den letzten Jahren zeigten sich die ersten wertvollen Versuche in einer neuen Prosa, welche aber meistens noch im Experiment stecken blieben. In etwa fünf Jahren wird darüber wahrscheinlich Anderes und Erfreulicheres zu berichten sein. Holländische Dramatik ist spärlich und spärlicher noch sind hier die Aussichten auf eine Erneuerung. Eine mehr universelle Bedeutung hat zweifellos der holländische Essay, der im Literarischen und Philosophischen persönlich und wehrhaft, mit scharfer Skepsis untersuchend und manchmal auch leidenschaftlich wählend, sich bis zur Lebens- und Kulturkritik erhebt. Es seien hier die Namen *Huizinga*, *Bierens de Haan*, *Coster*, *Vermeulen*, *Ter Braak* genannt. Wäre nicht das holländische Sprachgebiet so beschränkt und eben die Lyrik fast unübertragbar, es würden die holländischen Lyriker des 20-ten Jahrhunderts, vor allem die vier grossen Dichter, welche die beiden ersten Dezennien beherrschen, *Henriette Roland Holst*, *P. C. Boutens*, *J. H. Leopold*, und *Karel van de Woestijne* auch eine weitere Welt mit den tiefen und neuen Worten des Dichters bereichert haben, nicht weniger als Rilke, Valéry oder Yeats. Weil eben die edelsten Aeusserungen des holländischen Geistes lyrisch sind, ist es fast unmöglich sich von dem eigentlichen Wert unserer Literatur einen Begriff zu machen. Und wenn man schon nicht beharrt im primitiven Märchen der Holzschuhe, welche jeder Holländer angeblich tragen soll, und der Windmühlen, welche man sich wohl auch in der Stadt an jeder Strassenecke träumt, auf andere und gefährlichere Art wird man hinsichtlich des Anteils von Holland am Geistesleben der Welt irre geleitet von den beiden zweifelhaften holländischen Erfolgen der letzten Jahren; *Dr. v. d. Velde* mit seiner sexuellen Heilslehre und *Jo van Ammers-Kulle* mit Ihren Romanen, die mit bequemer Gewandtheit für ein bequemes Publikum sogenannte Zeitbilder darstellen.

Die neue Lyrik in Holland fängt etwa 1918 an mit *M. Nijhoff*. In seiner Dichtung kündigte sich ein vollständig neuer Ton an, der sich inzwischen mit persönlichen Nuancen bei beinahe allen jüngeren Dichtern weiter entwickelt hat.

anthonie donker

Hatte die ältere, klassische Lyrik einen architektonischen Charakter, so gleicht die neue Lyrik der Alchemie. Sie kennzeichnet sich durch einen unmittelbaren Ton, der sich der schlichten Sprache nähert und trotzdem von einem geheimnisvollen, unfassbaren Timbre (dem poetischen Fluidum?) zauberhaft verwandelt wird in Poesie. Es ist eine Art "poesie parlante". *Boutens*, bei dem das stilisierte Gedicht seine Vollendung gefunden hat, hatte Dichten charakterisiert als ein sich Verstecken in einer schönen Findbarkeit. *Nijhoff*, und der neben ihm in einer neuen direkten, fast explosiven Plastik experimentierende *Herman v. d. Bergh*, versuchten das unmittelbare, nackte, offene Gedicht. Sie wollten Härte und Klarheit statt schimmernder Lieblichkeit, und *Nijhoff* gelang es diese Unmittelbarkeit zu verbinden mit der Beherrschung der formenden Plastik und sich zu hüten vor der Gefahr sprachlicher Ausschweifungen, der auch hier die (flämischen) Expressionisten nicht entkamen. Dieser neue, direkte Ton ist wohl das Hauptkennzeichen der heutigen Lyrik. Es ist zwar nicht ohne Gefahr, ja es ist sogar schwieriger eine prägnante Poesie parlante zu schreiben als zu stilisieren, denn währenddem mit technischer Gewandtheit im traditionell stilisierten Gedicht eine scheinbare Erhabenheit leicht zu erreichen ist, ist eine Poesie parlante, der das letzte Geheimnis der Wortalchemie fehlt, im voraus und offensichtlich verloren und wirkungslos.

Es hängt wohl dieser Drang nach konkreter und anschaulicher Unmittelbarkeit zusammen mit dem überall in der Welt aufsteigenden Willen, sich von dem der Erde entschwebenden romantischen Verlangen zurück zu wenden zur Wirklichkeit und eben das ewige Rätsel im Nahen und beinahe Greifbarm wieder zu finden. Wuchtiger und härter, von der Wirklichkeit gestählt, dringt aber doch das alte, unvertilgbare romantische Verlangen in dieser neuen Dichtung wieder durch. Es sind die jungen Dichter in Holland, in deren Lyrik man diese Kennzeichen stark ausgeprägt wieder findet: *Slauerhoff*, *Marsman*, *Den Doolaard*, und — man entschuldige das unvermeidliche Erwähnen — *Antonie Donker*. Es ist merkwürdig, dass die beste jüngere Lyrik Hollands von Dichtern geschrieben wird, deren Lebensanschauung durchaus romantisch-paganistisch ist. Alle vom Leben gerührt und besessen, lebenbejahend, skeptisch, nichts anerkennend als das Leben selbst, dessen rätselhafte, tausendfache Erscheinungsformen sie fortwährend inspirieren, beunruhigen und endlos verwundern, schöpfen sie immer aus dieser ewigen Quelle der Tragik und Lieblichkeit. Der Protestantismus, der im 17ten Jahrhundert hier seine grossen Dichter hatte, hat seitdem seine Stimme in der Lyrik verloren und nicht wieder gefunden. Katholische Dichter gibt es erst seit einigen Jahren wieder, diese Gruppe aber ist zwar sehr vital, jedoch in ihrer Dichtung kaum ausgeprägt katholisch. Die jüngere flämische Poesie stellt grössten Teils stark unter dem Einfluss des deutschen Expressionismus, sie singt von der Hoffnung einer neuen Menschheit und von der kommenden Bruderschaft

anthonie donker

der Menschen, muss aber vielmal einen Mangel an innerlicher Kraft mit lautem Pathos ergänzen. Eine starke Gestaltung findet man bei *Marnia Gijzen*, der eigentlich nichts anders tut als mit den einfachsten Mitteln alltägliche Anekdoten mit dem Glanz der Ewigkeit durchleuchten. Es folge hier sein "Geschenk meines Vaters":

Wir sassen zusammen beim Feuer
mein lieber Vater und ich,
schweigend nur.
Mit jedem Ticken der Uhr
kam seine Sterbestunde
näher und näher:

Er war ruhig und gut:
wie die Mutter,
die ihr Kind bis ans Kinn zudeckt
und fortgeht leichtbesehnt,
still und erfreut,
so wusste er sein Denken und Handeln liegen
unter Gottes warmer Barmherzigkeit.

Er stand langsam aus seinen Sessel auf,
so recht und stark, wie er gelebt.
Seine feine Hand
hat gebebt
auf meiner Hand:
ein Nebel über erwachendem Land.
Dann hat er sein letztes Werk vollbracht:
er gab mir seine Uhr,
einfach, ohne ein Wort
und murmelnd sagte er Gute-Nacht.

Doch, wie ich ihn leise ans Bett geleitet,
wusste ich,
dass singend ein Engel hinter uns schreitet.
Denn mutig hatte mein Vater
in meinen Händen
Abschied von Tat und Zeit genommen.
Stolz und weinend bin ich von ihm weggekommen.

Unter den Dichtern der starken, unabhängigen Gruppe in Holland ist *Marsman* derjenige gewesen, der zuerst weitgehende moderne Experimente versuchte. Seine erste, schwer zugängliche Lyrik war daher viel umstritten. Es ist aber in seiner Lyrik etwas da, das unsere Zeit vor allem verlangt und bewundert: Feuer und Schwung. *Marsmans* Lebensanschauung ist sein Lebenstempo, seine Weisheit ist ein Sprung, ein Essay über ihn sollte ein Geschwindigkeitsmesser sein. Aber wie bei anderen Dichtern findet man auch bei ihm das romantische Heimweh nach verllorener Grösse, vergangenem Glück, und wenn er auch die Erde mit einer Heftigkeit ohnegleichen begrüsst, auch er setzt sich nie zur Ruhe in den engen Winkeln des vergänglichen Lebens aber sucht sich auf Lebenszeit einen himmlischen Ausweg.

anthonie donker

Heimweh,

Die Zeiten sind schwarz.
wir sind Jahrhunderte zu spät geboren.
von einem Engel - in seinen Mantel gefüllt -
auf blitzender Durchfahrt verloren
und von dem unzerstörbaren Heimweh erfüllt
den König zu sehen für den ich wollte streiten,
schreite ich in den Tod -
und der ein Krieger wollte sein
in den heftigsten aller Zeiten,
muss jetzt in späten, verwilderten Worten erwähnen
der Taten, die düstern und flammend gähnen
in den gedenkenden Malen
der Kreuzzüge und Kathedralen.

Es ist das atemlose Tempo seiner Schneestürme und Saltonfortalen, das seine Dichtung so heftig modern und prächtig originell macht. Es hat seine Lyrik auch andere Seiten aber das stürmisch Vitale ist wohl ihr stärkstes Kennzeichen.

Slauerhoff, der Schiffsarzt ist und lange in Indien und China war, ist besessen von der ewigen Unruhe des Wanderers, der nach allen Küsten der Erde, nach den äussersten Enden der Welt hingelockt wird und überall erfahren muss, an jeder Küste, in jedem Hafen, in allen Augen, auf jedem Mund, dass er etwas Anderes gesucht hat. Das Meer ist das Element seiner Unruhe. Auf dem Lande wird das Herz, das er auf sovielen Reisen vergebens abzuhärteten versucht hat, zu schmerzlich verletzt von aller Einsamkeit, allem Entbehren, brennenden Erinnerungen und unbefriedigtem Verlangen der Menschen. Auf den Meere ist die Einsamkeit dieses Lebens ihm am erträglichsten, weil sie dort am vollkommensten ist und sich nicht versteckt hinter der scheinbaren, gebrechlichen Vertraulichkeit der Menschen, die sich doch immer Fremde bleiben.

Afrikanische Elegie

Er sitzt auf dem Plattform seiner Faktorei.
Der gelbe Kongo plätschert trüg vorbei
die unaufhörlich gurgelnden Gewalten.
Unter des Bambusbodens jähe Spalten
treibt jetzt ein Baumstamm, dann ein Krokodill.
Er sagt sich bitter: "Das ist mein Idyll.
's ist in Europa Sonntag überall,
in Brest, Bordeaux, auf jedem Hafenwall.
Und in den Städten, zart besonnte Strassen
sind unbefahren, liegen still verlassen.
In allen Kirchen Sang von sanften Chören,
Auch Draussenstehende können Psalmen hören.
Heut Abend tanzt des Schiffes trunkner Gast
mit seiner Barmaid, bis er satt geprasst,
und ich sitz hier vor meinem Glase toddy,
sechs Jahre Tropen-müde ist my body.
Schon seit vergangener Woche fehlt der Sinn
in der Umarmung meiner Negerin,
die mir die Ess- und Liebeslust verbürgt
und mich wahrscheinlich eines Nachts erwürgt,
um ihrem Bruder meine Stirn zu köchen,
sie hat es ihm, als ich sie kauft, versprochen.

anthonie donker

Da kreischte sie ein Wort, ich hab's vergessen,
von dem die Fieberträume mir besessen."
Und dreimal schiesst er den Revolver ab.
Ein Affe fällt von seinem Baum hinab
ins Grab, das gähnt im Schlamm als Krokodill,
das gleich darauf vielleicht dem Schlaf verfiel.
Dann läuft ein heiser schreiend Grammophon.
Ein Twostep hallt - verzweifelt monoton -
Aus dem Gebüsch des Ufers surrt ein Pfeil:
Er hoffte kurz auf seinen Tod, sein Heil,
so wie ein Kind, sieht's fallen einen Stern,
den Herzwunsch hastig stammelt, aber fern
dem Ziel verbebt des Mordzeugs tödliche Gewalt.
Beirrtes Knacken schleicht sich in den Wald ...

Den Doolaard ist ein heftig romantischer Abenteurer. In seinen Gedichten spannt sich ein starker, unersättlicher Lebensdrang. Von der Romantik, die sich vom heillosen Leben ins himmlische Heimweh rettet, will er nichts wissen. Die beschwingte Schnelligkeit seiner Gedichte will er nur irdischer Training verdanken. Blind will er das Leben lieben. Durch seine Lyrik wandern Toreadore und Bergsteiger, Wikinge, Matrosen und Goldsucher. Er sucht sich seine Gestalten in den Symbolen höchster Vitalität: Titanen, Achilleus, Simson. Seine Freunde sind die Landstreicher, die nie Ruhe fanden, nie ein Dach beehrten und im Freien nah an der Erde schliefen. Eine andere, sachliche, stürmische Romantik erhebt sich in seiner Lyrik aufs neue. Seine Gedichte sind rau und hart wie unreife Früchte, aber stark und lebendig.

Eine beinahe vollendete Schlichtheit erreichte in der Poesie parlante in einigen Gedichten *Roel Howwink* von denen hier ein Beispiel folgt.

Anatomische Stunde

Das weisse Laken
ist abgeglitten
von den kleinen Brüsten
die nicht liebten
von den Händen die auseinanderfielen
ohne Nutz.
Langsam durchdringt das Messer
die weisse Ruhe
des Körpers.
Um das zarte schlanke Wunder
ihres Schosses
funkeln die Brillengläser
wie ein Lichtkranz
um das Haupt einer Heiligen.

Abwechselnd finster und feurig findet man in der jungen holländischen Lyrik einen stolzen, lebenbejahenden Ton, eine Kraft die sich fest hinpflanzt der verwirrenden und oft verbitternden Realität gegenüber, die unser heutiges Leben darstellt.

anthonie donker

Anmerkung: Alle hier zitierten Gedichte sind dem Buche "Niederland", Brücke-Verlag, Duisburg, einer Sammlung holländischer Dichtung in deutscher Uebersetzung von Rudolf Lonnes, entnommen.

ernst kammerer

georgische kunst

Weit hinter der Türkei, am schwarzen Meer liegt Georgien. Grenzland zwischen Europa und Asien. Auf dem Bahnhof der Hauptstadt Tiflis steht ein Panzerzug der Sowjets. Denn in Georgien gibt es eine junge nationale Bewegung, deren Ziel die Loslösung des Vaterlandes aus dem Verband der Sowjetrepubliken ist. Das ist alles, was ich von Georgien wusste, als ich die Ausstellung georgischer Kunst, die gegenwärtig durch Deutschlands grosse Städte reist, betrat. Jetzt weiss ich ausserdem, dass dieses fernste europäische Land als Gleicher unter Gleichen eine Epoche der europäischen Kunst mitschaffen half, die von der Gegenwart mühsam aus den Schlaf eines halben Jahrtausends geweckt wird und nun seltsam hineinleuchtet in den Kampf unserer Tage.

So bedeutsam kann das Ergebnis einer Ausstellung nur dann sein, wenn sie von allem Wesentlichen einen gültigen Vertreter enthält. Und darum ist zunächst der deutschen Gesellschaft zum Studium Osteuropas und den Volksbildungskommissariat der S. S. R. Georgien hohes Lob zu zollen für ihre sorgfältige Arbeit bei Zusammenstellung von Originalen, mustergültigen Kopien und instruierenden Photos. Man sieht Architektur, den Zentralbau mit der Kuppel und schwache Ansätze zur Basilika, sieht Freskomalereien romanischen Stiles vom vierten bis zum achtzehnten Jahrhundert, Silbertreibikonen voll Schönheit und Mass, kostbare Nadelmalereien und Miniaturalereien, die den Erzeugnissen der abendländischen Klöster ebenbürtig sind. Das erste Gefühl des Beschauers ist ein negatives. Man erwartet vielleicht persische, indische oder mongolische Einflüsse, man erwartet Exotik in Thema und Ausführung und ist verwundert ausschliesslich christliche Kunst anzutreffen. Christliche Kunst romanischer Haltung, wie sie am Anfang der deutschen, italienischen, französischen und englischen Kunstübung steht, christliche Kunst, die sich nie mit einem weltlichen Thema befasst, die sogar den Fürsten nur als Stifter einer Kirche oder eines Altarbildes darstellt. Dann ersetzt man angesichts der repräsentativen Gehaltenheit der unkörperlichen Figuren und ihrer schmalnasigen, grossäugigen, ovalschlanken Köpfe das Stilwort "romanisch" durch das orientalischer "byzantinisch" und Berührung zwischen dem Beschauer und dem Objekt setzt ein. Giotto, der Maler der tragisch schweren Körper, und Duccio, der Maler der mystischen Gebärde, stehen in der Erinnerung auf, Künstler des italienischen Trecento, und man gesteht sich mit einem hohen Erschrecken über die Tatsache eines allerorten, ohne äussere Verständigung spontan aufbrechenden Kunstwillens, dass man ihre Sprache bei den frühen Georgiern vernimmt. Es ist in der Kunstgeschichte nicht so wunderbar zugegangen, dass die Künstler Georgiens in völliger Abschneidung von

den in unserem Bewusstsein lebendigen abendländischen Künstlern eine Kunst erfunden hätten, die zufällig in ihrem Erfassen der absoluten malerischen Werte, in ihrer erlesenen Würde, für die das Wort Dekoration anzuwenden Banalisierung wäre, und in ihrer mystischen Seelenhaltung der abendländischen Kunst gleichlautend gewesen wäre bis auf wenige Abweichungen nationalen Dialekts. Es gab vielmehr ein goldenes Horn, aus dem über die ganze abendländische Welt die Lehren und Formen jener Kunst ausgeschüttet wurden, die wir in der Arena-kapelle zu Padua ebensogut antreffen wie in den Bamberger Evangeliaren der deutschen Kaiser des Mittelalters und nunmehr auch in der Kathedrale von Mzechetha in Georgien. Das goldene Horn war Byzanz und der repräsentative und jenseitige Stil, den Byzanz dem frühmittelalterlichen Europa anbot, wird "Manniera Byzantina" genannt. Das Wunderbare, Ergreifende und zu Bedenkende ist, dass dieser Stil überall als die anerkannte, geglaubte und allgemeine Kunst angenommen wurde. Er muss etwas in sich getragen haben, wofür die Seelen seiner fernsten Gemeinde besonders bereitet waren, sonst hätte er sie nicht entzünden können von den Säulen des Herkules bis an den Rand Asiens, bis nach Georgien. Und die Kraft, die das grandiose Aufblühen dieses Stils befeuerte, war so stark, dass sie mancherorts bis an die Schwelle des achtzehnten Jahrhunderts wirkte. So bemühten sich die Westler unter den russischen Ikonenmalern vergeblich den aus Frankreich kommenden Barock auf die Ikonen anzuwenden. Eine, wenn auch in tausend Jahren müde gewordene Jenseitigkeit, macht ihren modischen Willen zunichte. So auch hat Georgien nie einen anderen Stilwillen gehabt als den seiner Anfänge. Wenn auf den späteren Freskogemälden die Falte und das, was an Tiefenraum vorrenaissancehafter Art in ihnen enthalten ist, verschwindet, um vom fünfzehnten bis zum achtzehnten Jahrhundert einem flächigen, mit romanischen Ornamenten belebten Gewand und scheibenhaften Figuren Platz zu machen, ja, wenn in der Architektur sogar persisch glitzernde Ornamente an Stellen zweiten Ranges erscheinen dürfen, so ist das ein in sich Zurücksinken des byzantinischen Stils, ein Müdewerden, aber keine Verwandlung.

Das nichtrussische Europa hat alle Formen des byzantinischen Stils durchschritten, dann aber blieb es nicht stehen wie Russland und Georgien. Russland und Georgien wiederholten feierlich, behutsam und voll Achtung, was die Väter hinterliessen. Das nichtrussische Europa verwandelte sich, die Renaissance wurde geboren, ein Stil, dem die neueren Gelehrten gern einen anderen Namen geben möchten, weil sie immer lebhafter erkennen, dass er nicht Wiedergeburt der Antike schlechthin, sondern Neugeburt bedeutet, die sich in der Zeit ihres Anfangs in ostentativer Abwendung von Byzanz auf die Antike bezog. Rechnet man jedoch die einundneinhalb tausend Jahre zwischen der Antike und der Renaissance, rechnet man die Umwälzung der Welt durch das Christentum ein, so ergibt sich trotz allem eine tiefe, gesinnungsmässige Verwandtschaft, die sich ausdrückt in

der freudigen Bejahung des Diesseits. Sieht man für einen Augenblick von der durch die schöne, anregende, aber missverstehende Begeisterung des neunzehnten Jahrhunderts schon länger wieder in die Achtung der Welt eingesetzten Gotik ab, deren Verhältnis zur Kunst von Byzanz vielleicht eines Tages ebenso wie das des Barock zur Renaissance als Differenzierung und höchste Konsequenz eines einfachen Anfangs gedeutet werden wird, so muss man zugeben, dass es für die Kunst zwischen Antike und Renaissance, für das, was "nicht mehr antik", aber "noch nicht Renaissance" ist, keine so klare und zusammengefasste Vorstellung gibt, wie für die beiden grossen diesseitigen Kunstzeitalter. Aber da durchwandert eine Ausstellung der fremden, fernen und heiligen georgischen Kunst die grossen Städte Deutschlands und erzählt, dass sie aus dem gleichen Mutterschooss geboren wurde wie alle frühchristliche abendländische Kunst und mit einem Mal werden Verbindungen im Bewusstsein geschlagen, ein Jahrtausend rückt zusammen, Gründe werden sichtbar, wo vorher nur Erscheinungen waren, ein Leib steht mächtig auf und versammelt seine Glieder, von denen eines Georgien ist, und dieser Leib hat einen Namen: er ist die jenseitige christliche Kunst. Es ist einfach, liegt in der Luft und deswegen scheut man sich es auszusprechen. Trotzdem und in der Hoffnung einen Segen zu stiften, sei es gewagt: auf dem Boden Europas sind drei grosse Kunstgesinnungen gewesen, die diesseitige Kunstgesinnung der Antike, die diesseitige Kunstgesinnung der Renaissance und die jenseitige christliche Kunstgesinnung des Mittelalters, die in dem, was die Kunst ausmacht, in der Erregung des menschlichen Gemüts, gleichberechtigt neben ihren Schwestern steht. Es ist ein Unrecht, dass man ihnen grossen Namen immer noch verschweigt. Denn alle Anerkennung der Teile rechtfertigt nichts, solange man nicht gesteht, dass die Teile Glieder des einen Organismus sind. Die Ausstellung georgischer Kunst hat mächtig für die Grösse dieses einen Organismus gezeugt, indem sie uns lehrte, dass die Spuren seiner Füsse bis an den Kaukasus reichen und dass die Sprache seines Mundes noch bis ins achtzehnte Jahrhundert erklingen ist.

ernst kammerer.

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